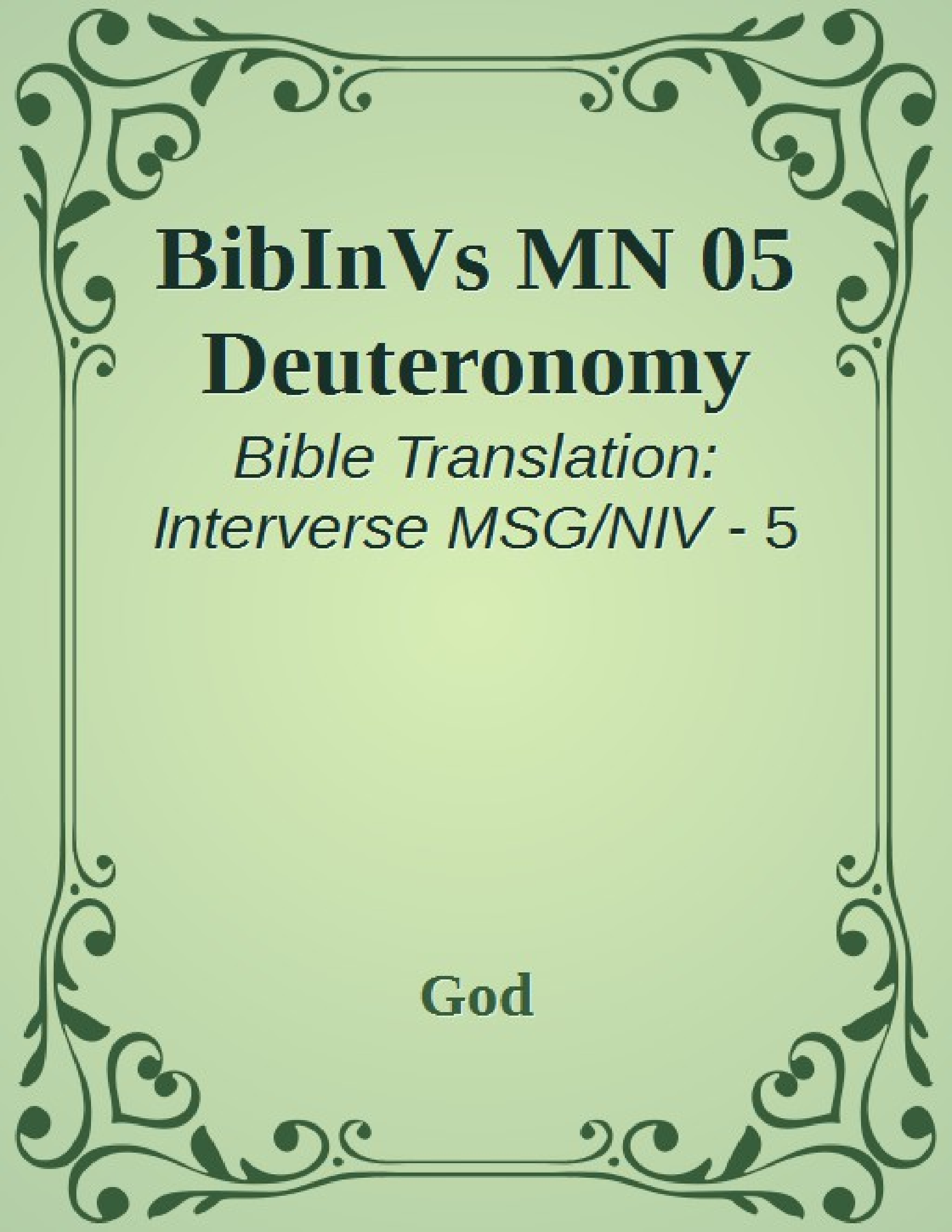


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 05

Deuteronomy

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 5*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Deuteronomy

Deuteronomy 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the sermons Moses preached to all Israel when they were east of the Jordan River in the Arabah Wilderness, opposite Suph, in the vicinity of Paran, Tophel, Laban, Hazeroth, and Dizahab.
- 1 These are the words Moses spoke to all Israel in the desert east of the Jordan--that is, in the Arabah--opposite Suph, between Paran and Tophel, Laban, Hazeroth and Dizahab.
- 2 It takes eleven days to travel from Horeb to Kadesh Barnea following the Mount Seir route.
- 2 (It takes eleven days to go from Horeb to Kadesh Barnea by the Mount Seir road.)
- 3 It was on the first day of the eleventh month of the fortieth year when Moses addressed the People of Israel, telling them everything GOD had commanded him concerning them.
- 3 In the fortieth year, on the first day of the eleventh month, Moses proclaimed to the Israelites all that the LORD had commanded him concerning them.
- 4 This came after he had defeated Sihon king of the Amorites, who ruled from Heshbon, and Og king of Bashan, who ruled from Ashtaroth in Edrei.
- 4 This was after he had defeated Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, and at Edrei had defeated Og king of Bashan, who reigned in Ashtaroth.
- 5 It was east of the Jordan in the land of Moab that Moses set out to explain this Revelation. He said:
- 5 East of the Jordan in the territory of Moab, Moses began to expound this law, saying:

- 6 Back at Horeb, GOD, our God, spoke to us: "You've stayed long enough at this mountain.
- 6 The LORD our God said to us at Horeb, "You have stayed long enough at this mountain.
- 7 On your way now. Get moving. Head for the Amorite hills, wherever people are living in the Arabah, the mountains, the foothills, the Negev, the seashore--the Canaanite country and the Lebanon all the way to the big river, the Euphrates.
- 7 Break camp and advance into the hill country of the Amorites; go to all the neighboring peoples in the Arabah, in the mountains, in the western foothills, in the Negev and along the coast, to the land of the Canaanites and to Lebanon, as far as the great river, the Euphrates.
- 8 Look, I've given you this land. Now go in and take it. It's the land GOD promised to give your ancestors Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob and their children after them."
- 8 See, I have given you this land. Go in and take possession of the land that the LORD swore he would give to your fathers--to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob--and to their descendants after them."
- 9 At the time I told you, "I can't do this, can't carry you all by myself.
- 9 At that time I said to you, "You are too heavy a burden for me to carry alone.
- 10 GOD, your God, has multiplied your numbers. Why, look at you--you rival the stars in the sky!
- 10 The LORD your God has increased your numbers so that today you are as many as the stars in the sky.
- 11 And may GOD, the God-of-Your-Fathers, keep it up and multiply you another thousand times, bless you just as he promised.
- 11 May the LORD, the God of your fathers, increase you a thousand times and bless you as he has promised!
- 12 But how can I carry, all by myself, your troubles and burdens and quarrels?
- 12 But how can I bear your problems and your burdens and your disputes all by myself?
- 13 So select some wise, understanding, and seasoned men from your tribes, and I will commission them as your leaders."

- 13 Choose some wise, understanding and respected men from each of your tribes, and I will set them over you."
- 14 You answered me, "Good! A good solution."
- 14 You answered me, "What you propose to do is good."
- 15 So I went ahead and took the top men of your tribes, wise and seasoned, and made them your leaders--leaders of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens, officials adequate for each of your tribes.
- 15 So I took the leading men of your tribes, wise and respected men, and appointed them to have authority over you--as commanders of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties and of tens and as tribal officials.
- 16 At the same time I gave orders to your judges: "Listen carefully to complaints and accusations between your fellow Israelites. Judge fairly between each person and his fellow or foreigner.
- 16 And I charged your judges at that time: Hear the disputes between your brothers and judge fairly, whether the case is between brother Israelites or between one of them and an alien.
- 17 Don't play favorites; treat the little and the big alike; listen carefully to each. Don't be impressed by big names. This is God's judgment you're dealing with. Hard cases you can bring to me; I'll deal with them."
- 17 Do not show partiality in judging; hear both small and great alike. Do not be afraid of any man, for judgment belongs to God. Bring me any case too hard for you, and I will hear it.
- 18 I issued orders to you at that time regarding everything you would have to deal with.
- 18 And at that time I told you everything you were to do.
- 19 Then we set out from Horeb and headed for the Amorite hill country, going through that huge and frightening wilderness that you've had more than an eyeful of by now--all under the command of GOD, our God--and finally arrived at Kadesh Barnea.
- 19 Then, as the LORD our God commanded us, we set out from Horeb and went toward the hill country of the Amorites through all that vast and dreadful desert that you have seen, and so we reached Kadesh Barnea.
- 20 There I told you, "You've made it to the Amorite hill country that GOD, our God, is giving us.
- 20 Then I said to you, "You have reached the hill country of the Amorites, which the LORD our God is giving us.

- 21 Look, GOD, your God, has placed this land as a gift before you. Go ahead and take it now. GOD, the God-of-Your-Fathers, promised it to you. Don't be afraid. Don't lose heart."
- 21 See, the LORD your God has given you the land. Go up and take possession of it as the LORD, the God of your fathers, told you. Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged."
- 22 But then you all came to me and said, "Let's send some men on ahead to scout out the land for us and bring back a report on the best route to take and the kinds of towns we can expect to find."
- 22 Then all of you came to me and said, "Let us send men ahead to spy out the land for us and bring back a report about the route we are to take and the towns we will come to."
- 23 That seemed like a good idea to me, so I picked twelve men, one from each tribe.
- 23 The idea seemed good to me; so I selected twelve of you, one man from each tribe.
- 24 They set out, climbing through the hills. They came to the Eshcol Valley and looked it over.
- 24 They left and went up into the hill country, and came to the Valley of Eshcol and explored it.
- 25 They took samples of the produce of the land and brought them back to us, saying, "It's a good land that GOD, our God, is giving us!"
- 25 Taking with them some of the fruit of the land, they brought it down to us and reported, "It is a good land that the LORD our God is giving us."
- 26 But then you weren't willing to go up. You rebelled against GOD, your God's plain word.
- 26 But you were unwilling to go up; you rebelled against the command of the LORD your God.
- 27 You complained in your tents: "GOD hates us. He hauled us out of Egypt in order to dump us among the Amorites--a death sentence for sure!"
- 27 You grumbled in your tents and said, "The LORD hates us; so he brought us out of Egypt to deliver us into the hands of the Amorites to destroy us.
- 28 How can we go up? We're trapped in a dead end. Our brothers took all the wind out of our sails, telling us, 'The people are bigger and stronger

than we are; their cities are huge, their defenses massive--we even saw Anakite giants there!"

28 Where can we go? Our brothers have made us lose heart. They say, 'The people are stronger and taller than we are; the cities are large, with walls up to the sky. We even saw the Anakites there.' "

29 I tried to relieve your fears: "Don't be terrified of them.

29 Then I said to you, "Do not be terrified; do not be afraid of them.

30 GOD, your God, is leading the way; he's fighting for you. You saw with your own eyes what he did for you in Egypt;

30 The LORD your God, who is going before you, will fight for you, as he did for you in Egypt, before your very eyes,

31 you saw what he did in the wilderness, how GOD, your God, carried you as a father carries his child, carried you the whole way until you arrived here.

31 and in the desert. There you saw how the LORD your God carried you, as a father carries his son, all the way you went until you reached this place."

32 But now that you're here, you won't trust GOD, your God--

32 In spite of this, you did not trust in the LORD your God,

33 this same GOD who goes ahead of you in your travels to scout out a place to pitch camp, a fire by night and a cloud by day to show you the way to go."

33 who went ahead of you on your journey, in fire by night and in a cloud by day, to search out places for you to camp and to show you the way you should go.

34 When GOD heard what you said, he exploded in anger. He swore,

34 When the LORD heard what you said, he was angry and solemnly swore:

35 "Not a single person of this evil generation is going to get so much as a look at the good land that I promised to give to your parents. Not one--

35 Not a man of this evil generation shall see the good land I swore to give your forefathers,

36 except for Caleb son of Jephunneh. He'll see it. I'll give him and his descendants the land he walked on because he was all for following GOD, heart and soul."

- 36 except Caleb son of Jephunneh. He will see it, and I will give him and his descendants the land he set his feet on, because he followed the LORD wholeheartedly."
- 37 But I also got it. Because of you GOD's anger spilled over onto me. He said, "You aren't getting in either.
- 37 Because of you the LORD became angry with me also and said, "You shall not enter it, either.
- 38 Your assistant, Joshua son of Nun, will go in. Build up his courage. He's the one who will claim the inheritance for Israel.
- 38 But your assistant, Joshua son of Nun, will enter it. Encourage him, because he will lead Israel to inherit it.
- 39 And your babies of whom you said, 'They'll be grabbed for plunder,' and all these little kids who right now don't even know right from wrong--they'll get in. I'll give it to them. Yes, they'll be the new owners.
- 39 And the little ones that you said would be taken captive, your children who do not yet know good from bad--they will enter the land. I will give it to them and they will take possession of it.
- 40 But not you. Turn around and head back into the wilderness following the route to the Red Sea."
- 40 But as for you, turn around and set out toward the desert along the route to the Red Sea. "
- 41 You spoke up, "We've sinned against GOD. We'll go up and fight, following all the orders that GOD, our God, has commanded." You took your weapons and dressed for battle--you thought it would be so easy going into those hills!
- 41 Then you replied, "We have sinned against the LORD. We will go up and fight, as the LORD our God commanded us." So every one of you put on his weapons, thinking it easy to go up into the hill country.
- 42 But GOD told me, "Tell them, 'Don't do it; don't go up to fight--I'm not with you in this. Your enemies will waste you.'"
- 42 But the LORD said to me, "Tell them, 'Do not go up and fight, because I will not be with you. You will be defeated by your enemies.' "
- 43 I told you but you wouldn't listen. You rebelled at the plain word of GOD. You threw out your chests and strutted into the hills.
- 43 So I told you, but you would not listen. You rebelled against the LORD's command and in your arrogance you marched up into the hill

country.

- 44 And those Amorites, who had lived in those hills all their lives, swarmed all over you like a hive of bees, chasing you from Seir all the way to Hormah, a stinging defeat.
- 44 The Amorites who lived in those hills came out against you; they chased you like a swarm of bees and beat you down from Seir all the way to Hormah.
- 45 You came back and wept in the presence of GOD, but he didn't pay a bit of attention to you; GOD didn't give you the time of day.
- 45 You came back and wept before the LORD, but he paid no attention to your weeping and turned a deaf ear to you.
- 46 You stayed there in Kadesh a long time, about as long as you had stayed there earlier.
- 46 And so you stayed in Kadesh many days--all the time you spent there.

Deuteronomy 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then we turned around and went back into the wilderness following the route to the Red Sea, as GOD had instructed me. We worked our way in and around the hills of Seir for a long, long time.
- 1 Then we turned back and set out toward the desert along the route to the Red Sea, as the LORD had directed me. For a long time we made our way around the hill country of Seir.
- 2 Then GOD said,
- 2 Then the LORD said to me,
- 3 "You've been going around in circles in these hills long enough; go north.
- 3 You have made your way around this hill country long enough; now turn north.
- 4 Command the people, You're about to cut through the land belonging to your relatives, the People of Esau who settled in Seir. They are terrified of you, but restrain yourselves.
- 4 Give the people these orders: 'You are about to pass through the territory of your brothers the descendants of Esau, who live in Seir. They will be afraid of you, but be very careful.

- 5 Don't try and start a fight. I am not giving you so much as a square inch of their land. I've already given all the hill country of Seir to Esau--he owns it all.
- 5 Do not provoke them to war, for I will not give you any of their land, not even enough to put your foot on. I have given Esau the hill country of Seir as his own.
- 6 Pay them up front for any food or water you get from them."
- 6 You are to pay them in silver for the food you eat and the water you drink.' "
- 7 GOD, your God, has blessed you in everything you have done. He has guarded you in your travels through this immense wilderness. For forty years now, GOD, your God, has been right here with you. You haven't lacked one thing.
- 7 The LORD your God has blessed you in all the work of your hands. He has watched over your journey through this vast desert. These forty years the LORD your God has been with you, and you have not lacked anything.
- 8 So we detoured around our brothers, the People of Esau who live in Seir, avoiding the Arabah Road that comes up from Elath and Ezion Geber; instead we used the road through the Wilderness of Moab.
- 8 So we went on past our brothers the descendants of Esau, who live in Seir. We turned from the Arabah road, which comes up from Elath and Ezion Geber, and traveled along the desert road of Moab.
- 9 GOD told me, "And don't try to pick a fight with the Moabites. I am not giving you any of their land. I've given ownership of Ar to the People of Lot."
- 9 Then the LORD said to me, "Do not harass the Moabites or provoke them to war, for I will not give you any part of their land. I have given Ar to the descendants of Lot as a possession."
- 10 The Emites (Monsters) used to live there--mobs of hulking giants, like Anakites.
- 10 (The Emites used to live there--a people strong and numerous, and as tall as the Anakites.
- 11 Along with the Anakites they were lumped in with the Rephaites (Ghosts) but in Moab they were called Emites.

- 11 Like the Anakites, they too were considered Rephaites, but the Moabites called them Emites.
- 12 Horites also used to live in Seir, but the descendants of Esau took over and destroyed them, the same as Israel did in the land GOD gave them to possess.
- 12 Horites used to live in Seir, but the descendants of Esau drove them out. They destroyed the Horites from before them and settled in their place, just as Israel did in the land the LORD gave them as their possession.)
- 13 GOD said, "It's time now to cross the Brook Zered." So we crossed the Brook Zered.
- 13 And the LORD said, "Now get up and cross the Zered Valley." So we crossed the valley.
- 14 It took us thirty-eight years to get from Kadesh Barnea to the Brook Zered. That's how long it took for the entire generation of soldiers from the camp to die off, as GOD had sworn they would.
- 14 Thirty-eight years passed from the time we left Kadesh Barnea until we crossed the Zered Valley. By then, that entire generation of fighting men had perished from the camp, as the LORD had sworn to them.
- 15 GOD was relentless against them until the last one was gone from the camp.
- 15 The LORD's hand was against them until he had completely eliminated them from the camp.
- 16 When the last of these soldiers had died,
- 16 Now when the last of these fighting men among the people had died,
- 17 GOD said to me,
- 17 the LORD said to me,
- 18 "This is the day you cut across the territory of Moab, at Ar.
- 18 Today you are to pass by the region of Moab at Ar.
- 19 When you approach the People of Ammon, don't try and pick a fight with them because I'm not giving you any of the land of the People of Ammon for yourselves--I've already given it to the People of Lot."
- 19 When you come to the Ammonites, do not harass them or provoke them to war, for I will not give you possession of any land belonging to the Ammonites. I have given it as a possession to the descendants of Lot."
- 20 It is also considered to have once been the land of the Rephaites. Rephaites lived there long ago--the Ammonites called them

Zamzummites (Barbarians)--

- 20 (That too was considered a land of the Rephaites, who used to live there; but the Ammonites called them Zamzummites.
- 21 huge mobs of them, giants like the Anakites. GOD destroyed them and the Ammonites moved in and took over.
- 21 They were a people strong and numerous, and as tall as the Anakites. The LORD destroyed them from before the Ammonites, who drove them out and settled in their place.
- 22 It was the same with the People of Esau who live in Seir--GOD got rid of the Horites who lived there earlier and they moved in and took over, as you can see.
- 22 The LORD had done the same for the descendants of Esau, who lived in Seir, when he destroyed the Horites from before them. They drove them out and have lived in their place to this day.
- 23 Regarding the Avvites who lived in villages as far as Gaza, the Caphtorites who came from Caphtor (Crete) wiped them out and moved in.
- 23 And as for the Avvites who lived in villages as far as Gaza, the Caphtorites coming out from Caphtor destroyed them and settled in their place.)
- 24 "On your feet now. Get started. Cross the Brook Arnon. Look: Here's Sihon the Amorite king of Heshbon and his land. I'm handing it over to you--it's all yours. Go ahead take it. Go to war with him.
- 24 Set out now and cross the Arnon Gorge. See, I have given into your hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his country. Begin to take possession of it and engage him in battle.
- 25 Before the day is out, I'll make sure that all the people around here are thoroughly terrified. Rumors of you are going to spread like wildfire; they'll totally panic."
- 25 This very day I will begin to put the terror and fear of you on all the nations under heaven. They will hear reports of you and will tremble and be in anguish because of you."
- 26 From the Wilderness of Kedemoth, I sent messengers to Sihon, king of Heshbon. They carried a friendly message:
- 26 From the desert of Kedemoth I sent messengers to Sihon king of Heshbon offering peace and saying,

27 "Let me cross through your land on the highway. I'll stay right on the highway; I won't trespass right or left.

27 Let us pass through your country. We will stay on the main road; we will not turn aside to the right or to the left.

28 I'll pay you for any food or water we might need. Let me walk through.

28 Sell us food to eat and water to drink for their price in silver. Only let us pass through on foot--

29 "The People of Esau who live in Seir and the Moabites who live in Ar did this, helping me on my way until I can cross the Jordan and enter the land that GOD, our God, is giving us."

29 as the descendants of Esau, who live in Seir, and the Moabites, who live in Ar, did for us--until we cross the Jordan into the land the LORD our God is giving us."

30 But Sihon king of Heshbon wouldn't let us cross his land. GOD, your God, turned his spirit mean and his heart hard so he could hand him over to you, as you can see that he has done.

30 But Sihon king of Heshbon refused to let us pass through. For the LORD your God had made his spirit stubborn and his heart obstinate in order to give him into your hands, as he has now done.

31 Then GOD said to me, "Look, I've got the ball rolling--Sihon and his land are soon yours. Go ahead. Take it. It's practically yours!"

31 The LORD said to me, "See, I have begun to deliver Sihon and his country over to you. Now begin to conquer and possess his land."

32 So Sihon and his entire army confronted us in battle at Jahaz.

32 When Sihon and all his army came out to meet us in battle at Jahaz,

33 GOD handed him, his sons, and his entire army over to us and we utterly crushed them.

33 the LORD our God delivered him over to us and we struck him down, together with his sons and his whole army.

34 While we were at it we captured all his towns and totally destroyed them, a holy destruction--men, women, and children. No survivors.

34 At that time we took all his towns and completely destroyed them--men, women and children. We left no survivors.

35 We took the livestock and the plunder from the towns we had captured and carried them off for ourselves.

- 35 But the livestock and the plunder from the towns we had captured we carried off for ourselves.
- 36 From Aroer on the edge of the Brook Arnon and the town in the gorge, as far as Gilead, not a single town proved too much for us; GOD, our God, gave every last one of them to us.
- 36 From Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Gorge, and from the town in the gorge, even as far as Gilead, not one town was too strong for us. The LORD our God gave us all of them.
- 37 The only land you didn't take, obeying GOD's command, was the land of the People of Ammon, the land along the Jabbok and around the cities in the hills.
- 37 But in accordance with the command of the LORD our God, you did not encroach on any of the land of the Ammonites, neither the land along the course of the Jabbok nor that around the towns in the hills.

Deuteronomy 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then we turned north and took the road to Bashan. Og king of Bashan, he and all his people, came out to meet us in battle at Edrei.
- 1 Next we turned and went up along the road toward Bashan, and Og king of Bashan with his whole army marched out to meet us in battle at Edrei.
- 2 GOD said to me, "Don't be afraid of him; I'm turning him over to you, along with his whole army and his land. Treat him the way you treated Sihon king of the Amorites who ruled from Heshbon."
- 2 The LORD said to me, "Do not be afraid of him, for I have handed him over to you with his whole army and his land. Do to him what you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon."
- 3 So GOD, our God, also handed Og king of Bashan over to us--Og and all his people--and we utterly crushed them. Again, no survivors.
- 3 So the LORD our God also gave into our hands Og king of Bashan and all his army. We struck them down, leaving no survivors.
- 4 At the same time we took all his cities. There wasn't one of the sixty cities that we didn't take--the whole region of Argob, Og's kingdom in Bashan.

- 4 At that time we took all his cities. There was not one of the sixty cities that we did not take from them--the whole region of Argob, Og's kingdom in Bashan.
- 5 All these cities were fortress cities with high walls and barred gates. There were also numerous unwallled villages.
- 5 All these cities were fortified with high walls and with gates and bars, and there were also a great many unwallled villages.
- 6 We totally destroyed them--a holy destruction. It was the same treatment we gave to Sihon king of Heshbon, a holy destruction of every city, man, woman, and child.
- 6 We completely destroyed them, as we had done with Sihon king of Heshbon, destroying every city--men, women and children.
- 7 But all the livestock and plunder from the cities we took for ourselves.
- 7 But all the livestock and the plunder from their cities we carried off for ourselves.
- 8 Throughout that time we took the land from under the control of the two kings of the Amorites who ruled the country east of the Jordan, all the way from the Brook Arnon to Mount Hermon.
- 8 So at that time we took from these two kings of the Amorites the territory east of the Jordan, from the Arnon Gorge as far as Mount Hermon.
- 9 (Sirion is the name given Hermon by the Sidonians; the Amorites call it Senir.)
- 9 (Hermon is called Sirion by the Sidonians; the Amorites call it Senir.)
- 10 We took all the towns of the plateau, everything in Gilead, everything in Bashan, as far as Salecah and Edrei, the border towns of Bashan, Og's kingdom.
- 10 We took all the towns on the plateau, and all Gilead, and all Bashan as far as Salecah and Edrei, towns of Og's kingdom in Bashan.
- 11 Og king of Bashan was the last remaining Rephaite. His bed, made of iron, was over thirteen feet long and six wide. You can still see it on display in Rabbah of the People of Ammon.
- 11 (Only Og king of Bashan was left of the remnant of the Rephaites. His bed was made of iron and was more than thirteen feet long and six feet wide. It is still in Rabbah of the Ammonites.)
- 12 Of the land that we possessed at that time, I gave the Reubenites and the Gadites the territory north of Aroer along the Brook Arnon and half the

- hill country of Gilead with its towns.
- 12 Of the land that we took over at that time, I gave the Reubenites and the Gadites the territory north of Aroer by the Arnon Gorge, including half the hill country of Gilead, together with its towns.
- 13 I gave the half-tribe of Manasseh the rest of Gilead and all of Bashan, Og's kingdom--all the region of Argob, which takes in all of Bashan. This used to be known as the Land of the Rephaites.
- 13 The rest of Gilead and also all of Bashan, the kingdom of Og, I gave to the half tribe of Manasseh. (The whole region of Argob in Bashan used to be known as a land of the Rephaites.
- 14 Jair, a son of Manasseh, got the region of Argob to the borders of the Geshurites and Maacathites. He named the Bashan villages after himself, Havvoth Jair (Jair's Tent-Villages). They're still called that.
- 14 Jair, a descendant of Manasseh, took the whole region of Argob as far as the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites; it was named after him, so that to this day Bashan is called Havvoth Jair.)
- 15 I gave Gilead to Makir.
- 15 And I gave Gilead to Makir.
- 16 I gave the Reubenites and Gadites the land from Gilead down to the Brook Arnon, whose middle was the boundary, and as far as the Jabbok River, the boundary line of the People of Ammon.
- 16 But to the Reubenites and the Gadites I gave the territory extending from Gilead down to the Arnon Gorge (the middle of the gorge being the border) and out to the Jabbok River, which is the border of the Ammonites.
- 17 The western boundary was the Jordan River in the Arabah all the way from the Kinnereth (the Sea of Galilee) to the Sea of the Arabah (the Salt Sea or Dead Sea) at the base of the slopes of Mount Pisgah on the east.
- 17 Its western border was the Jordan in the Arabah, from Kinnereth to the Sea of the Arabah (the Salt Sea), below the slopes of Pisgah.
- 18 I commanded you at that time, "GOD, your God, has given you this land to possess. Your men, fit and armed for the fight, are to cross the river in advance of their brothers, the People of Israel.
- 18 I commanded you at that time: "The LORD your God has given you this land to take possession of it. But all your able-bodied men, armed for battle, must cross over ahead of your brother Israelites.

- 19 Only your wives, children, and livestock (I know you have much livestock) may go ahead and settle down in the towns I have already given you
- 19 However, your wives, your children and your livestock (I know you have much livestock) may stay in the towns I have given you,
- 20 until GOD secures living space for your brothers as he has for you and they have taken possession of the country west of the Jordan that GOD, your God, is giving them. After that, each man may return to the land I've given you here."
- 20 until the LORD gives rest to your brothers as he has to you, and they too have taken over the land that the LORD your God is giving them, across the Jordan. After that, each of you may go back to the possession I have given you."
- 21 I commanded Joshua at that time, "You've seen with your own two eyes everything GOD, your God, has done to these two kings. GOD is going to do the same thing to all the kingdoms over there across the river where you're headed.
- 21 At that time I commanded Joshua: "You have seen with your own eyes all that the LORD your God has done to these two kings. The LORD will do the same to all the kingdoms over there where you are going.
- 22 Don't be afraid of them. GOD, your God, --he's fighting for you."
- 22 Do not be afraid of them; the LORD your God himself will fight for you."
- 23 At that same time, I begged GOD:
- 23 At that time I pleaded with the LORD:
- 24 "GOD, my Master, you let me in on the beginnings, you let me see your greatness, you let me see your might--what god in Heaven or Earth can do anything like what you've done!
- 24 O Sovereign LORD, you have begun to show to your servant your greatness and your strong hand. For what god is there in heaven or on earth who can do the deeds and mighty works you do?
- 25 Please, let me in also on the endings, let me cross the river and see the good land over the Jordan, the lush hills, the Lebanon mountains."
- 25 Let me go over and see the good land beyond the Jordan--that fine hill country and Lebanon."

- 26 But GOD was still angry with me because of you. He wouldn't listen. He said, "Enough of that. Not another word from you on this.
- 26 But because of you the LORD was angry with me and would not listen to me. "That is enough," the LORD said. "Do not speak to me anymore about this matter.
- 27 Climb to the top of Mount Pisgah and look around: look west, north, south, east. Take in the land with your own eyes. Take a good look because you're not going to cross this Jordan.
- 27 Go up to the top of Pisgah and look west and north and south and east. Look at the land with your own eyes, since you are not going to cross this Jordan.
- 28 "Then command Joshua: Give him courage. Give him strength. Single-handed he will lead this people across the river. Single-handed he'll cause them to inherit the land at which you can only look."
- 28 But commission Joshua, and encourage and strengthen him, for he will lead this people across and will cause them to inherit the land that you will see."
- 29 That's why we have stayed in this valley near Beth Peor.
- 29 So we stayed in the valley near Beth Peor.

Deuteronomy 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Now listen, Israel, listen carefully to the rules and regulations that I am teaching you to follow so that you may live and enter and take possession of the land that GOD, the God-of-Your-Fathers, is giving to you.
- 1 Hear now, O Israel, the decrees and laws I am about to teach you. Follow them so that you may live and may go in and take possession of the land that the LORD, the God of your fathers, is giving you.
- 2 Don't add a word to what I command you, and don't remove a word from it. Keep the commands of GOD, your God, that I am commanding you.
- 2 Do not add to what I command you and do not subtract from it, but keep the commands of the LORD your God that I give you.

- 3 You saw with your own eyes what GOD did at Baal Peor, how GOD destroyed from among you every man who joined in the Baal Peor orgies.
- 3 You saw with your own eyes what the LORD did at Baal Peor. The LORD your God destroyed from among you everyone who followed the Baal of Peor,
- 4 But you, the ones who held tight to GOD, your God, are alive and well, every one of you, today.
- 4 but all of you who held fast to the LORD your God are still alive today.
- 5 Pay attention: I'm teaching you the rules and regulations that GOD commanded me, so that you may live by them in the land you are entering to take up ownership.
- 5 See, I have taught you decrees and laws as the LORD my God commanded me, so that you may follow them in the land you are entering to take possession of it.
- 6 Keep them. Practice them. You'll become wise and understanding. When people hear and see what's going on, they'll say, "What a great nation! So wise, so understanding! We've never seen anything like it."
- 6 Observe them carefully, for this will show your wisdom and understanding to the nations, who will hear about all these decrees and say, "Surely this great nation is a wise and understanding people."
- 7 Yes. What other great nation has gods that are intimate with them the way GOD, our God, is with us, always ready to listen to us?
- 7 What other nation is so great as to have their gods near them the way the LORD our God is near us whenever we pray to him?
- 8 And what other great nation has rules and regulations as good and fair as this Revelation that I'm setting before you today?
- 8 And what other nation is so great as to have such righteous decrees and laws as this body of laws I am setting before you today?
- 9 Just make sure you stay alert. Keep close watch over yourselves. Don't forget anything of what you've seen. Don't let your heart wander off. Stay vigilant as long as you live. Teach what you've seen and heard to your children and grandchildren.
- 9 Only be careful, and watch yourselves closely so that you do not forget the things your eyes have seen or let them slip from your heart as long as you live. Teach them to your children and to their children after them.

- 10 That day when you stood before GOD, your God, at Horeb, GOD said to me, "Assemble the people in my presence to listen to my words so that they will learn to fear me in holy fear for as long as they live on the land, and then they will teach these same words to their children."
- 10 Remember the day you stood before the LORD your God at Horeb, when he said to me, "Assemble the people before me to hear my words so that they may learn to revere me as long as they live in the land and may teach them to their children."
- 11 You gathered. You stood in the shadow of the mountain. The mountain was ablaze with fire, blazing high into the very heart of Heaven. You stood in deep darkness and thick clouds.
- 11 You came near and stood at the foot of the mountain while it blazed with fire to the very heavens, with black clouds and deep darkness.
- 12 GOD spoke to you out of the fire. You heard the sound of words but you saw nothing--no form, only a voice.
- 12 Then the LORD spoke to you out of the fire. You heard the sound of words but saw no form; there was only a voice.
- 13 He announced his covenant, the Ten Words, by which he commanded you to live. Then he wrote them down on two slabs of stone.
- 13 He declared to you his covenant, the Ten Commandments, which he commanded you to follow and then wrote them on two stone tablets.
- 14 And GOD commanded me at that time to teach you the rules and regulations that you are to live by in the land which you are crossing over the Jordan to possess.
- 14 And the LORD directed me at that time to teach you the decrees and laws you are to follow in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess.
- 15 You saw no form on the day GOD spoke to you at Horeb from out of the fire. Remember that. Carefully guard yourselves
- 15 You saw no form of any kind the day the LORD spoke to you at Horeb out of the fire. Therefore watch yourselves very carefully,
- 16 so that you don't turn corrupt and make a form, carving a figure
- 16 so that you do not become corrupt and make for yourselves an idol, an image of any shape, whether formed like a man or a woman,
- 17 that looks male or female, or looks like a prowling animal or a flying bird

- 17 or like any animal on earth or any bird that flies in the air,
18 or a slithering snake or a fish in a stream.
18 or like any creature that moves along the ground or any fish in the waters below.
- 19 And also carefully guard yourselves so that you don't look up into the skies and see the sun and moon and stars, all the constellations of the skies, and be seduced into worshiping and serving them. GOD set them out for everybody's benefit, everywhere.
- 19 And when you look up to the sky and see the sun, the moon and the stars--all the heavenly array--do not be enticed into bowing down to them and worshiping things the LORD your God has apportioned to all the nations under heaven.
- 20 But you--GOD took you right out of the iron furnace, out of Egypt, to become the people of his inheritance--and that's what you are this very day.
- 20 But as for you, the LORD took you and brought you out of the iron-smelting furnace, out of Egypt, to be the people of his inheritance, as you now are.
- 21 But GOD was angry with me because of you and the things you said. He swore that I'd never cross the Jordan, never get to enter the good land that GOD, your God, is giving you as an inheritance.
- 21 The LORD was angry with me because of you, and he solemnly swore that I would not cross the Jordan and enter the good land the LORD your God is giving you as your inheritance.
- 22 This means that I am going to die here. I'm not crossing the Jordan. But you will cross; you'll possess the good land.
- 22 I will die in this land; I will not cross the Jordan; but you are about to cross over and take possession of that good land.
- 23 So stay alert. Don't for a minute forget the covenant which GOD, your God, made with you. And don't take up with any carved images, no forms of any kind--GOD, your God, issued clear commands on that.
- 23 Be careful not to forget the covenant of the LORD your God that he made with you; do not make for yourselves an idol in the form of anything the LORD your God has forbidden.
- 24 GOD, your God, is not to be trifled with--he's a consuming fire, a jealous God.

- 24 For the LORD your God is a consuming fire, a jealous God.
- 25 When the time comes that you have children and grandchildren, put on years, and start taking things for granted, if you then become corrupt and make any carved images, no matter what their form, by doing what is sheer evil in GOD's eyes and provoking his anger--
- 25 After you have had children and grandchildren and have lived in the land a long time--if you then become corrupt and make any kind of idol, doing evil in the eyes of the LORD your God and provoking him to anger,
- 26 I can tell you right now, with Heaven and Earth as witnesses, that it will be all over for you. You'll be kicked off the land that you're about to cross over the Jordan to possess. Believe me, you'll have a very short stay there. You'll be ruined, completely ruined.
- 26 I call heaven and earth as witnesses against you this day that you will quickly perish from the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess. You will not live there long but will certainly be destroyed.
- 27 GOD will scatter you far and wide; a few of you will survive here and there in the nations where GOD will drive you.
- 27 The LORD will scatter you among the peoples, and only a few of you will survive among the nations to which the LORD will drive you.
- 28 There you can worship your homemade gods to your hearts' content, your wonderful gods of wood and stone that can't see or hear or eat or smell.
- 28 There you will worship man-made gods of wood and stone, which cannot see or hear or eat or smell.
- 29 But even there, if you seek GOD, your God, you'll be able to find him if you're serious, looking for him with your whole heart and soul.
- 29 But if from there you seek the LORD your God, you will find him if you look for him with all your heart and with all your soul.
- 30 When troubles come and all these awful things happen to you, in future days you will come back to GOD, your God, and listen obediently to what he says.
- 30 When you are in distress and all these things have happened to you, then in later days you will return to the LORD your God and obey him.
- 31 GOD, your God, is above all a compassionate God. In the end he will not abandon you, he won't bring you to ruin, he won't forget the

covenant with your ancestors which he swore to them.

- 31 For the LORD your God is a merciful God; he will not abandon or destroy you or forget the covenant with your forefathers, which he confirmed to them by oath.
- 32 Ask questions. Find out what has been going on all these years before you were born. From the day God created man and woman on this Earth, and from the horizon in the east to the horizon in the west--as far back as you can imagine and as far away as you can imagine--has as great a thing as this ever happened? Has anyone ever heard of such a thing?
- 32 Ask now about the former days, long before your time, from the day God created man on the earth; ask from one end of the heavens to the other. Has anything so great as this ever happened, or has anything like it ever been heard of?
- 33 Has a people ever heard, as you did, a god speaking out of the middle of the fire and lived to tell the story?
- 33 Has any other people heard the voice of God speaking out of fire, as you have, and lived?
- 34 Or has a god ever tried to select for himself a nation from within a nation using trials, miracles, and war, putting his strong hand in, reaching his long arm out, a spectacle awesome and staggering, the way GOD, your God, did it for you in Egypt while you stood right there and watched?
- 34 Has any god ever tried to take for himself one nation out of another nation, by testings, by miraculous signs and wonders, by war, by a mighty hand and an outstretched arm, or by great and awesome deeds, like all the things the LORD your God did for you in Egypt before your very eyes?
- 35 You were shown all this so that you would know that GOD is, well, God. He's the only God there is. He's it.
- 35 You were shown these things so that you might know that the LORD is God; besides him there is no other.
- 36 He made it possible for you to hear his voice out of Heaven to discipline you. Down on Earth, he showed you the big fire and again you heard his words, this time out of the fire.
- 36 From heaven he made you hear his voice to discipline you. On earth he showed you his great fire, and you heard his words from out of the fire.

37 He loved your ancestors and chose to work with their children. He personally and powerfully brought you out of Egypt

37 Because he loved your forefathers and chose their descendants after them, he brought you out of Egypt by his Presence and his great strength,

38 in order to displace bigger and stronger and older nations with you, bringing you out and turning their land over to you as an inheritance. And now it's happening. This very day.

38 to drive out before you nations greater and stronger than you and to bring you into their land to give it to you for your inheritance, as it is today.

39 Know this well, then. Take it to heart right now: GOD is in Heaven above; GOD is on Earth below. He's the only God there is.

39 Acknowledge and take to heart this day that the LORD is God in heaven above and on the earth below. There is no other.

40 Obediently live by his rules and commands which I'm giving you today so that you'll live well and your children after you--oh, you'll live a long time in the land that GOD, your God, is giving you.

40 Keep his decrees and commands, which I am giving you today, so that it may go well with you and your children after you and that you may live long in the land the LORD your God gives you for all time.

41 Then Moses set aside three towns in the country on the east side of the Jordan

41 Then Moses set aside three cities east of the Jordan,

42 to which someone who had unintentionally killed a person could flee and find refuge. If the murder was unintentional and there was no history of bad blood, the murderer could flee to one of these cities and save his life:

42 to which anyone who had killed a person could flee if he had unintentionally killed his neighbor without malice aforethought. He could flee into one of these cities and save his life.

43 Bezer in the wilderness on the tableland for the Reubenites, Ramoth in Gilead for the Gadites, and Golan in Bashan for the Manassites.

43 The cities were these: Bezer in the desert plateau, for the Reubenites; Ramoth in Gilead, for the Gadites; and Golan in Bashan, for the Manassites.

44 This is the Revelation that Moses presented to the People of Israel.
 44 This is the law Moses set before the Israelites.
 45 These are the testimonies, the rules and regulations Moses spoke to the People of Israel after their exodus from Egypt
 45 These are the stipulations, decrees and laws Moses gave them when they came out of Egypt
 46 and arrival on the east side of the Jordan in the valley near Beth Peor. It was the country of Sihon king of the Amorites who ruled from Heshbon. Moses and the People of Israel fought and beat him after they left Egypt
 46 and were in the valley near Beth Peor east of the Jordan, in the land of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon and was defeated by Moses and the Israelites as they came out of Egypt.
 47 and took his land. They also took the land of Og king of Bashan. The two Amorite kings held the country on the east of the Jordan
 47 They took possession of his land and the land of Og king of Bashan, the two Amorite kings east of the Jordan.
 48 from Aroer on the bank of the Brook Arnon as far north as Mount Siyon, that is, Mount Hermon,
 48 This land extended from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Gorge to Mount Siyon (that is, Hermon),
 49 all the Arabah plain east of the Jordan, and as far south as the Sea of the Arabah (the Dead Sea) beneath the slopes of Mount Pisgah.
 49 and included all the Arabah east of the Jordan, as far as the Sea of the Arabah, below the slopes of Pisgah.

Deuteronomy 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses called all Israel together. He said to them, Attention, Israel. Listen obediently to the rules and regulations I am delivering to your listening ears today. Learn them. Live them.
- 1 Moses summoned all Israel and said: Hear, O Israel, the decrees and laws I declare in your hearing today. Learn them and be sure to follow them.
- 2 GOD, our God, made a covenant with us at Horeb.
- 2 The LORD our God made a covenant with us at Horeb.

- 3 GOD didn't just make this covenant with our parents; he made it also with us, with all of us who are alive right now.
- 3 It was not with our fathers that the LORD made this covenant, but with us, with all of us who are alive here today.
- 4 GOD spoke to you personally out of the fire on the mountain.
- 4 The LORD spoke to you face to face out of the fire on the mountain.
- 5 At the time I stood between GOD and you, to tell you what GOD said. You were afraid, remember, of the fire and wouldn't climb the mountain. He said:
- 5 (At that time I stood between the LORD and you to declare to you the word of the LORD, because you were afraid of the fire and did not go up the mountain.) And he said:
- 6 I am GOD, your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of a house of slaves.
- 6 I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery.
- 7 No other gods, only me.
- 7 You shall have no other gods before me.
- 8 No carved gods of any size, shape, or form of anything whatever, whether of things that fly or walk or swim.
- 8 You shall not make for yourself an idol in the form of anything in heaven above or on the earth beneath or in the waters below.
- 9 Don't bow down to them and don't serve them because I am GOD, your God, and I'm a most jealous God. I hold parents responsible for any sins they pass on to their children to the third, and yes, even to the fourth generation.
- 9 You shall not bow down to them or worship them; for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, punishing the children for the sin of the fathers to the third and fourth generation of those who hate me,
- 10 But I'm lovingly loyal to the thousands who love me and keep my commandments.
- 10 but showing love to a thousand generations of those who love me and keep my commandments.
- 11 No using the name of GOD, your God, in curses or silly banter; GOD won't put up with the irreverent use of his name.

- 11 You shall not misuse the name of the LORD your God, for the LORD will not hold anyone guiltless who misuses his name.
- 12 No working on the Sabbath; keep it holy just as GOD, your God, commanded you.
- 12 Observe the Sabbath day by keeping it holy, as the LORD your God has commanded you.
- 13 Work six days, doing everything you have to do,
- 13 Six days you shall labor and do all your work,
- 14 but the seventh day is a Sabbath, a Rest Day--no work: not you, your son, your daughter, your servant, your maid, your ox, your donkey (or any of your animals), and not even the foreigner visiting your town. That way your servants and maids will get the same rest as you.
- 14 but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God. On it you shall not do any work, neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your manservant or maidservant, nor your ox, your donkey or any of your animals, nor the alien within your gates, so that your manservant and maidservant may rest, as you do.
- 15 Don't ever forget that you were slaves in Egypt and GOD, your God, got you out of there in a powerful show of strength. That's why GOD, your God, commands you to observe the day of Sabbath rest.
- 15 Remember that you were slaves in Egypt and that the LORD your God brought you out of there with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm. Therefore the LORD your God has commanded you to observe the Sabbath day.
- 16 Respect your father and mother--GOD, your God, commands it! You'll have a long life; the land that God is giving you will treat you well.
- 16 Honor your father and your mother, as the LORD your God has commanded you, so that you may live long and that it may go well with you in the land the LORD your God is giving you.
- 17 No murder.
- 17 You shall not murder.
- 18 No adultery.
- 18 You shall not commit adultery.
- 19 No stealing.
- 19 You shall not steal.
- 20 No lies about your neighbor.

- 20 You shall not give false testimony against your neighbor.
- 21 No coveting your neighbor's wife. And no lusting for his house, field, servant, maid, ox, or donkey either--nothing that belongs to your neighbor!
- 21 You shall not covet your neighbor's wife. You shall not set your desire on your neighbor's house or land, his manservant or maidservant, his ox or donkey, or anything that belongs to your neighbor.
- 22 These are the words that GOD spoke to the whole congregation at the mountain. He spoke in a tremendous voice from the fire and cloud and dark mist. And that was it. No more words. Then he wrote them on two slabs of stone and gave them to me.
- 22 These are the commandments the LORD proclaimed in a loud voice to your whole assembly there on the mountain from out of the fire, the cloud and the deep darkness; and he added nothing more. Then he wrote them on two stone tablets and gave them to me.
- 23 As it turned out, when you heard the Voice out of that dark cloud and saw the mountain on fire, you approached me, all the heads of your tribes and your leaders,
- 23 When you heard the voice out of the darkness, while the mountain was ablaze with fire, all the leading men of your tribes and your elders came to me.
- 24 and said, "Our GOD has revealed to us his glory and greatness. We've heard him speak from the fire today! We've seen that God can speak to humans and they can still live.
- 24 And you said, "The LORD our God has shown us his glory and his majesty, and we have heard his voice from the fire. Today we have seen that a man can live even if God speaks with him.
- 25 But why risk it further? This huge fire will devour us if we stay around any longer. If we hear GOD's voice anymore, we'll die for sure.
- 25 But now, why should we die? This great fire will consume us, and we will die if we hear the voice of the LORD our God any longer.
- 26 Has anyone ever known of anyone who has heard the Voice of GOD the way we have and lived to tell the story?
- 26 For what mortal man has ever heard the voice of the living God speaking out of fire, as we have, and survived?

- 27 "From now on, you go and listen to what GOD, our God, says and then tell us what GOD tells you. We'll listen and we'll do it."
- 27 Go near and listen to all that the LORD our God says. Then tell us whatever the LORD our God tells you. We will listen and obey."
- 28 GOD heard what you said to me and told me, "I've heard what the people said to you. They're right--good and true words.
- 28 The LORD heard you when you spoke to me and the LORD said to me, "I have heard what this people said to you. Everything they said was good.
- 29 What I wouldn't give if they'd always feel this way, continuing to revere me and always keep all my commands; they'd have a good life forever, they and their children!
- 29 Oh, that their hearts would be inclined to fear me and keep all my commands always, so that it might go well with them and their children forever!
- 30 "Go ahead and tell them to go home to their tents.
- 30 Go, tell them to return to their tents.
- 31 But you, you stay here with me so I can tell you every commandment and all the rules and regulations that you must teach them so they'll know how to live in the land that I'm giving them as their own."
- 31 But you stay here with me so that I may give you all the commands, decrees and laws you are to teach them to follow in the land I am giving them to possess."
- 32 So be very careful to act exactly as GOD commands you. Don't veer off to the right or the left.
- 32 So be careful to do what the LORD your God has commanded you; do not turn aside to the right or to the left.
- 33 Walk straight down the road GOD commands so that you'll have a good life and live a long time in the land that you're about to possess.
- 33 Walk in all the way that the LORD your God has commanded you, so that you may live and prosper and prolong your days in the land that you will possess.

Deuteronomy 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 This is the commandment, the rules and regulations, that GOD, your God, commanded me to teach you to live out in the land you're about to cross into to possess.
- 1 These are the commands, decrees and laws the LORD your God directed me to teach you to observe in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess,
- 2 This is so that you'll live in deep reverence before GOD lifelong, observing all his rules and regulations that I'm commanding you, you and your children and your grandchildren, living good long lives.
- 2 so that you, your children and their children after them may fear the LORD your God as long as you live by keeping all his decrees and commands that I give you, and so that you may enjoy long life.
- 3 Listen obediently, Israel. Do what you're told so that you'll have a good life, a life of abundance and bounty, just as GOD promised, in a land abounding in milk and honey.
- 3 Hear, O Israel, and be careful to obey so that it may go well with you and that you may increase greatly in a land flowing with milk and honey, just as the LORD, the God of your fathers, promised you.
- 4 Attention, Israel! GOD, our God! GOD the one and only!
- 4 Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is one.
- 5 Love GOD, your God, with your whole heart: love him with all that's in you, love him with all you've got!
- 5 Love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your strength.
- 6 Write these commandments that I've given you today on your hearts. Get them inside of you
- 6 These commandments that I give you today are to be upon your hearts.
- 7 and then get them inside your children. Talk about them wherever you are, sitting at home or walking in the street; talk about them from the time you get up in the morning to when you fall into bed at night.
- 7 Impress them on your children. Talk about them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road, when you lie down and when you get up.
- 8 Tie them on your hands and foreheads as a reminder;
- 8 Tie them as symbols on your hands and bind them on your foreheads.

- 9 inscribe them on the doorposts of your homes and on your city gates.
- 9 Write them on the doorframes of your houses and on your gates.
- 10 When GOD, your God, ushers you into the land he promised through your ancestors Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob to give you, you're going to walk into large, bustling cities you didn't build,
- 10 When the LORD your God brings you into the land he swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, to give you--a land with large, flourishing cities you did not build,
- 11 well-furnished houses you didn't buy, come upon wells you didn't dig, vineyards and olive orchards you didn't plant. When you take it all in and settle down, pleased and content,
- 11 houses filled with all kinds of good things you did not provide, wells you did not dig, and vineyards and olive groves you did not plant--then when you eat and are satisfied,
- 12 make sure you don't forget how you got there--GOD brought you out of slavery in Egypt.
- 12 be careful that you do not forget the LORD, who brought you out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery.
- 13 Deeply respect GOD, your God. Serve and worship him exclusively. Back up your promises with his name only.
- 13 Fear the LORD your God, serve him only and take your oaths in his name.
- 14 Don't fool around with other gods, the gods of your neighbors,
- 14 Do not follow other gods, the gods of the peoples around you;
- 15 because GOD, your God, who is alive among you is a jealous God. Don't provoke him, igniting his hot anger that would burn you right off the face of the Earth.
- 15 for the LORD your God, who is among you, is a jealous God and his anger will burn against you, and he will destroy you from the face of the land.
- 16 Don't push GOD, your God, to the wall as you did that day at Massah, the Testing-Place.
- 16 Do not test the LORD your God as you did at Massah.
- 17 Carefully keep the commands of GOD, your God, all the requirements and regulations he gave you.

17 Be sure to keep the commands of the LORD your God and the stipulations and decrees he has given you.

18 Do what is right; do what is good in GOD's sight so you'll live a good life and be able to march in and take this pleasant land that GOD so solemnly promised through your ancestors,

18 Do what is right and good in the LORD's sight, so that it may go well with you and you may go in and take over the good land that the LORD promised on oath to your forefathers,

19 throwing out your enemies left and right--exactly as GOD said.

19 thrusting out all your enemies before you, as the LORD said.

20 The next time your child asks you, "What do these requirements and regulations and rules that GOD, our God, has commanded mean?"

20 In the future, when your son asks you, "What is the meaning of the stipulations, decrees and laws the LORD our God has commanded you?"

21 tell your child, "We were slaves to Pharaoh in Egypt and GOD powerfully intervened and got us out of that country.

21 tell him: "We were slaves of Pharaoh in Egypt, but the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand.

22 We stood there and watched as GOD delivered miracle-signs, great wonders, and evil-visitations on Egypt, on Pharaoh and his household.

22 Before our eyes the LORD sent miraculous signs and wonders--great and terrible-- upon Egypt and Pharaoh and his whole household.

23 He pulled us out of there so he could bring us here and give us the land he so solemnly promised to our ancestors.

23 But he brought us out from there to bring us in and give us the land that he promised on oath to our forefathers.

24 That's why GOD commanded us to follow all these rules, so that we would live reverently before GOD, our God, as he gives us this good life, keeping us alive for a long time to come.

24 The LORD commanded us to obey all these decrees and to fear the LORD our God, so that we might always prosper and be kept alive, as is the case today.

25 "It will be a set-right and put-together life for us if we make sure that we do this entire commandment in the Presence of GOD, our God, just as he commanded us to do."

25 And if we are careful to obey all this law before the LORD our God, as he has commanded us, that will be our righteousness."

Deuteronomy 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 When GOD, your God, brings you into the country that you are about to enter and take over, he will clear out the superpowers that were there before you: the Hittite, the Girgashite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite. Those seven nations are all bigger and stronger than you are.
- 1 When the LORD your God brings you into the land you are entering to possess and drives out before you many nations--the Hittites, Girgashites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites, seven nations larger and stronger than you--
- 2 GOD, your God, will turn them over to you and you will conquer them. You must completely destroy them, offering them up as a holy destruction to GOD. Don't make a treaty with them. Don't let them off in any way.
- 2 and when the LORD your God has delivered them over to you and you have defeated them, then you must destroy them totally. Make no treaty with them, and show them no mercy.
- 3 Don't marry them: Don't give your daughters to their sons and don't take their daughters for your sons--
- 3 Do not intermarry with them. Do not give your daughters to their sons or take their daughters for your sons,
- 4 before you know it they'd involve you in worshiping their gods, and GOD would explode in anger, putting a quick end to you.
- 4 for they will turn your sons away from following me to serve other gods, and the LORD's anger will burn against you and will quickly destroy you.
- 5 Here's what you are to do: Tear apart their altars stone by stone, smash their phallic pillars, chop down their sex-and-religion Asherah groves, set fire to their carved god-images.

- 5 This is what you are to do to them: Break down their altars, smash their sacred stones, cut down their Asherah poles and burn their idols in the fire.
- 6 Do this because you are a people set apart as holy to GOD, your God. GOD, your God, chose you out of all the people on Earth for himself as a cherished, personal treasure.
- 6 For you are a people holy to the LORD your God. The LORD your God has chosen you out of all the peoples on the face of the earth to be his people, his treasured possession.
- 7 GOD wasn't attracted to you and didn't choose you because you were big and important--the fact is, there was almost nothing to you.
- 7 The LORD did not set his affection on you and choose you because you were more numerous than other peoples, for you were the fewest of all peoples.
- 8 He did it out of sheer love, keeping the promise he made to your ancestors. GOD stepped in and mightily bought you back out of that world of slavery, freed you from the iron grip of Pharaoh king of Egypt.
- 8 But it was because the LORD loved you and kept the oath he swore to your forefathers that he brought you out with a mighty hand and redeemed you from the land of slavery, from the power of Pharaoh king of Egypt.
- 9 Know this: GOD, your God, is God indeed, a God you can depend upon. He keeps his covenant of loyal love with those who love him and observe his commandments for a thousand generations.
- 9 Know therefore that the LORD your God is God; he is the faithful God, keeping his covenant of love to a thousand generations of those who love him and keep his commands.
- 10 But he also pays back those who hate him, pays them the wages of death; he isn't slow to pay them off--those who hate him, he pays right on time.
- 10 But those who hate him he will repay to their face by destruction; he will not be slow to repay to their face those who hate him.
- 11 So keep the command and the rules and regulations that I command you today. Do them.
- 11 Therefore, take care to follow the commands, decrees and laws I give you today.

- 12 And this is what will happen: When you, on your part, will obey these directives, keeping and following them, GOD, on his part, will keep the covenant of loyal love that he made with your ancestors:
- 12 If you pay attention to these laws and are careful to follow them, then the LORD your God will keep his covenant of love with you, as he swore to your forefathers.
- 13 He will love you, he will bless you, he will increase you. He will bless the babies from your womb and the harvest of grain, new wine, and oil from your fields; he'll bless the calves from your herds and lambs from your flocks in the country he promised your ancestors that he'd give you.
- 13 He will love you and bless you and increase your numbers. He will bless the fruit of your womb, the crops of your land--your grain, new wine and oil--the calves of your herds and the lambs of your flocks in the land that he swore to your forefathers to give you.
- 14 You'll be blessed beyond all other peoples: no sterility or barrenness in you or your animals.
- 14 You will be blessed more than any other people; none of your men or women will be childless, nor any of your livestock without young.
- 15 GOD will get rid of all sickness. And all the evil afflictions you experienced in Egypt he'll put not on you but on those who hate you.
- 15 The LORD will keep you free from every disease. He will not inflict on you the horrible diseases you knew in Egypt, but he will inflict them on all who hate you.
- 16 You'll make mincemeat of all the peoples that GOD, your God, hands over to you. Don't feel sorry for them. And don't worship their gods--they'll trap you for sure.
- 16 You must destroy all the peoples the LORD your God gives over to you. Do not look on them with pity and do not serve their gods, for that will be a snare to you.
- 17 You're going to think to yourselves, "Oh! We're outnumbered ten to one by these nations! We'll never even make a dent in them!"
- 17 You may say to yourselves, "These nations are stronger than we are. How can we drive them out?"
- 18 But I'm telling you, Don't be afraid. Remember, yes, remember in detail what GOD, your God, did to Pharaoh and all Egypt.

- 18 But do not be afraid of them; remember well what the LORD your God did to Pharaoh and to all Egypt.
- 19 Remember the great contests to which you were eyewitnesses: the miracle-signs, the wonders, GOD's mighty hand as he stretched out his arm and took you out of there. GOD, your God, is going to do the same thing to these people you're now so afraid of.
- 19 You saw with your own eyes the great trials, the miraculous signs and wonders, the mighty hand and outstretched arm, with which the LORD your God brought you out. The LORD your God will do the same to all the peoples you now fear.
- 20 And to top it off, the Hornet. GOD will unleash the Hornet on them until every survivor-in-hiding is dead.
- 20 Moreover, the LORD your God will send the hornet among them until even the survivors who hide from you have perished.
- 21 So don't be intimidated by them. GOD, your God, is among you--GOD majestic, GOD awesome.
- 21 Do not be terrified by them, for the LORD your God, who is among you, is a great and awesome God.
- 22 GOD, your God, will get rid of these nations, bit by bit. You won't be permitted to wipe them out all at once lest the wild animals take over and overwhelm you.
- 22 The LORD your God will drive out those nations before you, little by little. You will not be allowed to eliminate them all at once, or the wild animals will multiply around you.
- 23 But GOD, your God, will move them out of your way--he'll throw them into a huge panic until there's nothing left of them.
- 23 But the LORD your God will deliver them over to you, throwing them into great confusion until they are destroyed.
- 24 He'll turn their kings over to you and you'll remove all trace of them under Heaven. Not one person will be able to stand up to you; you'll put an end to them all.
- 24 He will give their kings into your hand, and you will wipe out their names from under heaven. No one will be able to stand up against you; you will destroy them.
- 25 Make sure you set fire to their carved gods. Don't get greedy for the veneer of silver and gold on them and take it for yourselves--you'll get

trapped by it for sure. GOD hates it; it's an abomination to GOD, your God.

- 25 The images of their gods you are to burn in the fire. Do not covet the silver and gold on them, and do not take it for yourselves, or you will be ensnared by it, for it is detestable to the LORD your God.
- 26 And don't dare bring one of these abominations home or you'll end up just like it, burned up as a holy destruction. No: It is forbidden! Hate it. Abominate it. Destroy it and preserve GOD's holiness.
- 26 Do not bring a detestable thing into your house or you, like it, will be set apart for destruction. Utterly abhor and detest it, for it is set apart for destruction.

Deuteronomy 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 Keep and live out the entire commandment that I'm commanding you today so that you'll live and prosper and enter and own the land that GOD promised to your ancestors.
- 1 Be careful to follow every command I am giving you today, so that you may live and increase and may enter and possess the land that the LORD promised on oath to your forefathers.
- 2 Remember every road that GOD led you on for those forty years in the wilderness, pushing you to your limits, testing you so that he would know what you were made of, whether you would keep his commandments or not.
- 2 Remember how the LORD your God led you all the way in the desert these forty years, to humble you and to test you in order to know what was in your heart, whether or not you would keep his commands.
- 3 He put you through hard times. He made you go hungry. Then he fed you with manna, something neither you nor your parents knew anything about, so you would learn that men and women don't live by bread only; we live by every word that comes from GOD's mouth.
- 3 He humbled you, causing you to hunger and then feeding you with manna, which neither you nor your fathers had known, to teach you that

man does not live on bread alone but on every word that comes from the mouth of the LORD.

- 4 Your clothes didn't wear out and your feet didn't blister those forty years.
- 4 Your clothes did not wear out and your feet did not swell during these forty years.
- 5 You learned deep in your heart that GOD disciplines you in the same ways a father disciplines his child.
- 5 Know then in your heart that as a man disciplines his son, so the LORD your God disciplines you.
- 6 So it's paramount that you keep the commandments of GOD, your God, walk down the roads he shows you and reverently respect him.
- 6 Observe the commands of the LORD your God, walking in his ways and revering him.
- 7 GOD is about to bring you into a good land, a land with brooks and rivers, springs and lakes, streams out of the hills and through the valleys.
- 7 For the LORD your God is bringing you into a good land--a land with streams and pools of water, with springs flowing in the valleys and hills;
- 8 It's a land of wheat and barley, of vines and figs and pomegranates, of olives, oil, and honey.
- 8 a land with wheat and barley, vines and fig trees, pomegranates, olive oil and honey;
- 9 It's land where you'll never go hungry--always food on the table and a roof over your head. It's a land where you'll get iron out of rocks and mine copper from the hills.
- 9 a land where bread will not be scarce and you will lack nothing; a land where the rocks are iron and you can dig copper out of the hills.
- 10 After a meal, satisfied, bless GOD, your God, for the good land he has given you.
- 10 When you have eaten and are satisfied, praise the LORD your God for the good land he has given you.
- 11 Make sure you don't forget GOD, your God, by not keeping his commandments, his rules and regulations that I command you today
- 11 Be careful that you do not forget the LORD your God, failing to observe his commands, his laws and his decrees that I am giving you this day.
- 12 Make sure that when you eat and are satisfied, build pleasant houses and settle in,

- 12 Otherwise, when you eat and are satisfied, when you build fine houses and settle down,
- 13 see your herds and flocks flourish and more and more money come in, watch your standard of living going up and up--
- 13 and when your herds and flocks grow large and your silver and gold increase and all you have is multiplied,
- 14 make sure you don't become so full of yourself and your things that you forget GOD, your God, the God who delivered you from Egyptian slavery;
- 14 then your heart will become proud and you will forget the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery.
- 15 the God who led you through that huge and fearsome wilderness, those desolate, arid badlands crawling with fiery snakes and scorpions; the God who gave you water gushing from hard rock;
- 15 He led you through the vast and dreadful desert, that thirsty and waterless land, with its venomous snakes and scorpions. He brought you water out of hard rock.
- 16 the God who gave you manna to eat in the wilderness, something your ancestors had never heard of, in order to give you a taste of the hard life, to test you so that you would be prepared to live well in the days ahead of you.
- 16 He gave you manna to eat in the desert, something your fathers had never known, to humble and to test you so that in the end it might go well with you.
- 17 If you start thinking to yourselves, "I did all this. And all by myself. I'm rich. It's all mine!"--
- 17 You may say to yourself, "My power and the strength of my hands have produced this wealth for me."
- 18 well, think again. Remember that GOD, your God, gave you the strength to produce all this wealth so as to confirm the covenant that he promised to your ancestors--as it is today.
- 18 But remember the LORD your God, for it is he who gives you the ability to produce wealth, and so confirms his covenant, which he swore to your forefathers, as it is today.
- 19 If you forget, forget GOD, your God, and start taking up with other gods, serving and worshiping them, I'm on record right now as giving

- you firm warning: that will be the end of you; I mean it--destruction.
- 19 If you ever forget the LORD your God and follow other gods and worship and bow down to them, I testify against you today that you will surely be destroyed.
- 20 You'll go to your doom--the same as the nations GOD is destroying before you; doom because you wouldn't obey the Voice of GOD, your God.
- 20 Like the nations the LORD destroyed before you, so you will be destroyed for not obeying the LORD your God.

Deuteronomy 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Attention, Israel! This very day you are crossing the Jordan to enter the land and dispossess nations that are much bigger and stronger than you are. You're going to find huge cities with sky-high fortress-walls and
- 1 Hear, O Israel. You are now about to cross the Jordan to go in and dispossess nations greater and stronger than you, with large cities that have walls up to the sky.
- 2 gigantic people, descendants of the Anakites--you've heard all about them; you've heard the saying, "No one can stand up to an Anakite."
- 2 The people are strong and tall--Anakites! You know about them and have heard it said: "Who can stand up against the Anakites?"
- 3 Today know this: GOD, your God, is crossing the river ahead of you--he's a consuming fire. He will destroy the nations, he will put them under your power. You will dispossess them and very quickly wipe them out, just as GOD promised you would.
- 3 But be assured today that the LORD your God is the one who goes across ahead of you like a devouring fire. He will destroy them; he will subdue them before you. And you will drive them out and annihilate them quickly, as the LORD has promised you.
- 4 But when GOD pushes them out ahead of you, don't start thinking to yourselves, "It's because of all the good I've done that GOD has brought me in here to dispossess these nations." Actually it's because of all the evil these nations have done.

- 4 After the LORD your God has driven them out before you, do not say to yourself, "The LORD has brought me here to take possession of this land because of my righteousness." No, it is on account of the wickedness of these nations that the LORD is going to drive them out before you.
- 5 No, it's nothing good that you've done, no record for decency that you've built up, that got you here; it's because of the vile wickedness of these nations that GOD, your God, is dispossessing them before you so that he can keep his promised word to your ancestors, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.
- 5 It is not because of your righteousness or your integrity that you are going in to take possession of their land; but on account of the wickedness of these nations, the LORD your God will drive them out before you, to accomplish what he swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob.
- 6 Know this and don't ever forget it: It's not because of any good that you've done that GOD is giving you this good land to own. Anything but! You're stubborn as mules.
- 6 Understand, then, that it is not because of your righteousness that the LORD your God is giving you this good land to possess, for you are a stiff-necked people.
- 7 Keep in mind and don't ever forget how angry you made GOD, your God, in the wilderness. You've kicked and screamed against GOD from the day you left Egypt until you got to this place, rebels all the way.
- 7 Remember this and never forget how you provoked the LORD your God to anger in the desert. From the day you left Egypt until you arrived here, you have been rebellious against the LORD.
- 8 You made GOD angry at Horeb, made him so angry that he wanted to destroy you.
- 8 At Horeb you aroused the LORD's wrath so that he was angry enough to destroy you.
- 9 When I climbed the mountain to receive the slabs of stone, the tablets of the covenant that GOD made with you, I stayed there on the mountain forty days and nights: I ate no food; I drank no water.
- 9 When I went up on the mountain to receive the tablets of stone, the tablets of the covenant that the LORD had made with you, I stayed on

the mountain forty days and forty nights; I ate no bread and drank no water.

10 Then GOD gave me the two slabs of stone, engraved with the finger of God. They contained word for word everything that GOD spoke to you on the mountain out of the fire, on the day of the assembly.

10 The LORD gave me two stone tablets inscribed by the finger of God. On them were all the commandments the LORD proclaimed to you on the mountain out of the fire, on the day of the assembly.

11 It was at the end of the forty days and nights that GOD gave me the two slabs of stone, the tablets of the covenant.

11 At the end of the forty days and forty nights, the LORD gave me the two stone tablets, the tablets of the covenant.

12 GOD said to me, "Get going, and quickly. Get down there, because your people whom you led out of Egypt have ruined everything. In almost no time at all they have left the road that I laid out for them and gone off and made for themselves a cast god."

12 Then the LORD told me, "Go down from here at once, because your people whom you brought out of Egypt have become corrupt. They have turned away quickly from what I commanded them and have made a cast idol for themselves."

13 GOD said, "I look at this people and all I see are hardheaded, hardhearted rebels.

13 And the LORD said to me, "I have seen this people, and they are a stiff-necked people indeed!

14 Get out of my way now so I can destroy them. I'm going to wipe them off the face of the map. Then I'll start over with you to make a nation far better and bigger than they could ever be."

14 Let me alone, so that I may destroy them and blot out their name from under heaven. And I will make you into a nation stronger and more numerous than they."

15 I turned around and started down the mountain--by now the mountain was blazing with fire--carrying the two tablets of the covenant in my two arms.

15 So I turned and went down from the mountain while it was ablaze with fire. And the two tablets of the covenant were in my hands.

- 16 That's when I saw it: There you were, sinning against GOD, your God--you had made yourselves a cast god in the shape of a calf! So soon you had left the road that GOD had commanded you to walk on.
- 16 When I looked, I saw that you had sinned against the LORD your God; you had made for yourselves an idol cast in the shape of a calf. You had turned aside quickly from the way that the LORD had commanded you.
- 17 I held the two stone slabs high and threw them down, smashing them to bits as you watched.
- 17 So I took the two tablets and threw them out of my hands, breaking them to pieces before your eyes.
- 18 Then I prostrated myself before GOD, just as I had at the beginning of the forty days and nights. I ate no food; I drank no water. I did this because of you, all your sins, sinning against GOD, doing what is evil in GOD's eyes and making him angry.
- 18 Then once again I fell prostrate before the LORD for forty days and forty nights; I ate no bread and drank no water, because of all the sin you had committed, doing what was evil in the LORD's sight and so provoking him to anger.
- 19 I was terrified of GOD's furious anger, his blazing anger. I was sure he would destroy you. But once again GOD listened to me.
- 19 I feared the anger and wrath of the LORD, for he was angry enough with you to destroy you. But again the LORD listened to me.
- 20 And Aaron! How furious he was with Aaron--ready to destroy him. But I prayed also for Aaron at that same time.
- 20 And the LORD was angry enough with Aaron to destroy him, but at that time I prayed for Aaron too.
- 21 But that sin-thing that you made, that calf-god, I took and burned in the fire, pounded and ground it until it was crushed into a fine powder, then threw it into the stream that comes down the mountain.
- 21 Also I took that sinful thing of yours, the calf you had made, and burned it in the fire. Then I crushed it and ground it to powder as fine as dust and threw the dust into a stream that flowed down the mountain.
- 22 And then there was Camp Taberah (Blaze), Massah (Testing-Place), and Camp Kibroth Hattaavah (Graves-of-the-Craving)--more occasions when you made God furious with you.

- 22 You also made the LORD angry at Taberah, at Massah and at Kibroth Hattaavah.
- 23 The most recent was when GOD sent you out from Kadesh Barnea, ordering you: "Go. Possess the land that I'm giving you." And what did you do? You rebelled. Rebelled against the clear orders of GOD, your God. Refused to trust him. Wouldn't obey him.
- 23 And when the LORD sent you out from Kadesh Barnea, he said, "Go up and take possession of the land I have given you." But you rebelled against the command of the LORD your God. You did not trust him or obey him.
- 24 You've been rebels against GOD from the first day I knew you.
- 24 You have been rebellious against the LORD ever since I have known you.
- 25 When I was on my face, prostrate before GOD those forty days and nights after GOD said he would destroy you,
- 25 I lay prostrate before the LORD those forty days and forty nights because the LORD had said he would destroy you.
- 26 I prayed to GOD for you, "My Master, GOD, don't destroy your people, your inheritance whom, in your immense generosity, you redeemed, using your enormous strength to get them out of Egypt.
- 26 I prayed to the LORD and said, "O Sovereign LORD, do not destroy your people, your own inheritance that you redeemed by your great power and brought out of Egypt with a mighty hand.
- 27 "Remember your servants Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob; don't make too much of the stubbornness of this people, their evil and their sin,
- 27 Remember your servants Abraham, Isaac and Jacob. Overlook the stubbornness of this people, their wickedness and their sin.
- 28 lest the Egyptians from whom you rescued them say, 'GOD couldn't do it; he got tired and wasn't able to take them to the land he promised them. He ended up hating them and dumped them in the wilderness to die.'
- 28 Otherwise, the country from which you brought us will say, 'Because the LORD was not able to take them into the land he had promised them, and because he hated them, he brought them out to put them to death in the desert.'
- 29 "They are your people still, your inheritance whom you powerfully and sovereignly rescued."

29 But they are your people, your inheritance that you brought out by your great power and your outstretched arm."

Deuteronomy 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD responded. He said, "Shape two slabs of stone similar to the first ones. Climb the mountain and meet me. Also make yourself a wooden chest.
- 1 At that time the LORD said to me, "Chisel out two stone tablets like the first ones and come up to me on the mountain. Also make a wooden chest.
- 2 I will engrave the stone slabs with the words that were on the first ones, the ones you smashed. Then you will put them in the Chest."
- 2 I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets, which you broke. Then you are to put them in the chest."
- 3 So I made a chest out of acacia wood, shaped two slabs of stone, just like the first ones, and climbed the mountain with the two slabs in my arms.
- 3 So I made the ark out of acacia wood and chiseled out two stone tablets like the first ones, and I went up on the mountain with the two tablets in my hands.
- 4 He engraved the stone slabs the same as he had the first ones, the Ten Words that he addressed to you on the mountain out of the fire on the day of the assembly. Then GOD gave them to me.
- 4 The LORD wrote on these tablets what he had written before, the Ten Commandments he had proclaimed to you on the mountain, out of the fire, on the day of the assembly. And the LORD gave them to me.
- 5 I turned around and came down the mountain. I put the stone slabs in the Chest that I made and they've been there ever since, just as GOD commanded me.
- 5 Then I came back down the mountain and put the tablets in the ark I had made, as the LORD commanded me, and they are there now.
- 6 The People of Israel went from the wells of the Jaakanites to Moserah. Aaron died there and was buried. His son Eleazar succeeded him as priest.

- 6 (The Israelites traveled from the wells of the Jaakanites to Moserah. There Aaron died and was buried, and Eleazar his son succeeded him as priest.
- 7 From there they went to Gudgodah, and then to Jotbathah, a land of streams of water.
- 7 From there they traveled to Gudgodah and on to Jotbathah, a land with streams of water.
- 8 That's when GOD set apart the tribe of Levi to carry GOD's Covenant Chest, to be on duty in the Presence of GOD, to serve him, and to bless in his name, as they continue to do today.
- 8 At that time the LORD set apart the tribe of Levi to carry the ark of the covenant of the LORD, to stand before the LORD to minister and to pronounce blessings in his name, as they still do today.
- 9 And that's why Levites don't have a piece of inherited land as their kinsmen do. GOD is their inheritance, as GOD, your God, promised them.
- 9 That is why the Levites have no share or inheritance among their brothers; the LORD is their inheritance, as the LORD your God told them.)
- 10 I stayed there on the mountain forty days and nights, just as I did the first time. And GOD listened to me, just as he did the first time: GOD decided not to destroy you.
- 10 Now I had stayed on the mountain forty days and nights, as I did the first time, and the LORD listened to me at this time also. It was not his will to destroy you.
- 11 GOD told me, "Now get going. Lead your people as they resume the journey to take possession of the land that I promised their ancestors that I'd give to them."
- 11 Go, the LORD said to me, "and lead the people on their way, so that they may enter and possess the land that I swore to their fathers to give them."
- 12 So now Israel, what do you think GOD expects from you? Just this: Live in his presence in holy reverence, follow the road he sets out for you, love him, serve GOD, your God, with everything you have in you,
- 12 And now, O Israel, what does the LORD your God ask of you but to fear the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways, to love him, to serve

- the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul,
- 13 obey the commandments and regulations of GOD that I'm commanding you today--live a good life.
- 13 and to observe the LORD's commands and decrees that I am giving you today for your own good?
- 14 Look around you: Everything you see is GOD's--the heavens above and beyond, the Earth, and everything on it.
- 14 To the LORD your God belong the heavens, even the highest heavens, the earth and everything in it.
- 15 But it was your ancestors that GOD fell in love with; he picked their children--that's you!--out of all the other peoples. That's where we are right now.
- 15 Yet the LORD set his affection on your forefathers and loved them, and he chose you, their descendants, above all the nations, as it is today.
- 16 So cut away the thick calluses from your heart and stop being so willfully hardheaded.
- 16 Circumcise your hearts, therefore, and do not be stiff-necked any longer.
- 17 GOD, your God, is the God of all gods, he's the Master of all masters, a God immense and powerful and awesome. He doesn't play favorites, takes no bribes,
- 17 For the LORD your God is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great God, mighty and awesome, who shows no partiality and accepts no bribes.
- 18 makes sure orphans and widows are treated fairly, takes loving care of foreigners by seeing that they get food and clothing.
- 18 He defends the cause of the fatherless and the widow, and loves the alien, giving him food and clothing.
- 19 You must treat foreigners with the same loving care-- remember, you were once foreigners in Egypt.
- 19 And you are to love those who are aliens, for you yourselves were aliens in Egypt.
- 20 Reverently respect GOD, your God, serve him, hold tight to him, back up your promises with the authority of his name.
- 20 Fear the LORD your God and serve him. Hold fast to him and take your oaths in his name.

- 21 He's your praise! He's your God! He did all these tremendous, these staggering things that you saw with your own eyes.
- 21 He is your praise; he is your God, who performed for you those great and awesome wonders you saw with your own eyes.
- 22 When your ancestors entered Egypt, they numbered a mere seventy souls. And now look at you--you look more like the stars in the night skies in number. And your GOD did it.
- 22 Your forefathers who went down into Egypt were seventy in all, and now the LORD your God has made you as numerous as the stars in the sky.

Deuteronomy 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 So love GOD, your God; guard well his rules and regulations; obey his commandments for the rest of time.
- 1 Love the LORD your God and keep his requirements, his decrees, his laws and his commands always.
- 2 Today it's very clear that it isn't your children who are front and center here: They weren't in on what GOD did, didn't see the acts, didn't experience the discipline, didn't marvel at his greatness, the way he displayed his power in the miracle-signs and deeds
- 2 Remember today that your children were not the ones who saw and experienced the discipline of the LORD your God: his majesty, his mighty hand, his outstretched arm;
- 3 that he let loose in Egypt on Pharaoh king of Egypt and all his land,
- 3 the signs he performed and the things he did in the heart of Egypt, both to Pharaoh king of Egypt and to his whole country;
- 4 the way he took care of the Egyptian army, its horses and chariots, burying them in the waters of the Red Sea as they pursued you. GOD drowned them. And you're standing here today alive.
- 4 what he did to the Egyptian army, to its horses and chariots, how he overwhelmed them with the waters of the Red Sea as they were pursuing you, and how the LORD brought lasting ruin on them.

- 5 Nor was it your children who saw how GOD took care of you in the wilderness up until the time you arrived here,
- 5 It was not your children who saw what he did for you in the desert until you arrived at this place,
- 6 what he did to Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab son of Reuben, how the Earth opened its jaws and swallowed them with their families--their tents, and everything around them--right out of the middle of Israel.
- 6 and what he did to Dathan and Abiram, sons of Eliab the Reubenite, when the earth opened its mouth right in the middle of all Israel and swallowed them up with their households, their tents and every living thing that belonged to them.
- 7 Yes, it was you--your eyes--that saw every great thing that GOD did.
- 7 But it was your own eyes that saw all these great things the LORD has done.
- 8 So it's you who are in charge of keeping the entire commandment that I command you today so that you'll have the strength to invade and possess the land that you are crossing the river to make your own.
- 8 Observe therefore all the commands I am giving you today, so that you may have the strength to go in and take over the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess,
- 9 Your obedience will give you a long life on the soil that GOD promised to give your ancestors and their children, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 9 and so that you may live long in the land that the LORD swore to your forefathers to give to them and their descendants, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 10 The land you are entering to take up ownership isn't like Egypt, the land you left, where you had to plant your own seed and water it yourselves as in a vegetable garden.
- 10 The land you are entering to take over is not like the land of Egypt, from which you have come, where you planted your seed and irrigated it by foot as in a vegetable garden.
- 11 But the land you are about to cross the river and take for your own is a land of mountains and valleys; it drinks water that rains from the sky.
- 11 But the land you are crossing the Jordan to take possession of is a land of mountains and valleys that drinks rain from heaven.

- 12 It's a land that GOD, your God, personally tends--he's the gardener--he alone keeps his eye on it all year long.
- 12 It is a land the LORD your God cares for; the eyes of the LORD your God are continually on it from the beginning of the year to its end.
- 13 From now on if you listen obediently to the commandments that I am commanding you today, love GOD, your God, and serve him with everything you have within you,
- 13 So if you faithfully obey the commands I am giving you today--to love the LORD your God and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul--
- 14 he'll take charge of sending the rain at the right time, both autumn and spring rains, so that you'll be able to harvest your grain, your grapes, your olives.
- 14 then I will send rain on your land in its season, both autumn and spring rains, so that you may gather in your grain, new wine and oil.
- 15 He'll make sure there's plenty of grass for your animals. You'll have plenty to eat.
- 15 I will provide grass in the fields for your cattle, and you will eat and be satisfied.
- 16 But be vigilant, lest you be seduced away and end up serving and worshiping other gods
- 16 Be careful, or you will be enticed to turn away and worship other gods and bow down to them.
- 17 and GOD erupts in anger and shuts down Heaven so there's no rain and nothing grows in the fields, and in no time at all you're starved out--not a trace of you left on the good land that GOD is giving you.
- 17 Then the LORD's anger will burn against you, and he will shut the heavens so that it will not rain and the ground will yield no produce, and you will soon perish from the good land the LORD is giving you.
- 18 Place these words on your hearts. Get them deep inside you. Tie them on your hands and foreheads as a reminder.
- 18 Fix these words of mine in your hearts and minds; tie them as symbols on your hands and bind them on your foreheads.
- 19 Teach them to your children. Talk about them wherever you are, sitting at home or walking in the street; talk about them from the time you get up in the morning until you fall into bed at night.

- 19 Teach them to your children, talking about them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road, when you lie down and when you get up.
- 20 Inscribe them on the doorposts and gates of your cities
- 20 Write them on the doorframes of your houses and on your gates,
- 21 so that you'll live a long time, and your children with you, on the soil that GOD promised to give your ancestors for as long as there is a sky over the Earth.
- 21 so that your days and the days of your children may be many in the land that the LORD swore to give your forefathers, as many as the days that the heavens are above the earth.
- 22 That's right. If you diligently keep all this commandment that I command you to obey--love GOD, your God, do what he tells you, stick close to him--
- 22 If you carefully observe all these commands I am giving you to follow--to love the LORD your God, to walk in all his ways and to hold fast to him--
- 23 GOD on his part will drive out all these nations that stand in your way. Yes, he'll drive out nations much bigger and stronger than you.
- 23 then the LORD will drive out all these nations before you, and you will dispossess nations larger and stronger than you.
- 24 Every square inch on which you place your foot will be yours. Your borders will stretch from the wilderness to the mountains of Lebanon, from the Euphrates River to the Mediterranean Sea.
- 24 Every place where you set your foot will be yours: Your territory will extend from the desert to Lebanon, and from the Euphrates River to the western sea.
- 25 No one will be able to stand in your way. Everywhere you go, GOD-sent fear and trembling will precede you, just as he promised.
- 25 No man will be able to stand against you. The LORD your God, as he promised you, will put the terror and fear of you on the whole land, wherever you go.
- 26 I've brought you today to the crossroads of Blessing and Curse.
- 26 See, I am setting before you today a blessing and a curse--
- 27 The Blessing: if you listen obediently to the commandments of GOD, your God, which I command you today.

- 27 the blessing if you obey the commands of the LORD your God that I am giving you today;
- 28 The Curse: if you don't pay attention to the commandments of GOD, your God, but leave the road that I command you today, following other gods of which you know nothing.
- 28 the curse if you disobey the commands of the LORD your God and turn from the way that I command you today by following other gods, which you have not known.
- 29 Here's what comes next: When GOD, your God, brings you into the land you are going into to make your own, you are to give out the Blessing from Mount Gerizim and the Curse from Mount Ebal.
- 29 When the LORD your God has brought you into the land you are entering to possess, you are to proclaim on Mount Gerizim the blessings, and on Mount Ebal the curses.
- 30 After you cross the Jordan River, follow the road to the west through Canaanite settlements in the valley near Gilgal and the Oaks of Moreh.
- 30 As you know, these mountains are across the Jordan, west of the road, toward the setting sun, near the great trees of Moreh, in the territory of those Canaanites living in the Arabah in the vicinity of Gilgal.
- 31 You are crossing the Jordan River to invade and take the land that GOD, your God, is giving you.
- 31 You are about to cross the Jordan to enter and take possession of the land the LORD your God is giving you. When you have taken it over and are living there,
- 32 Be vigilant. Observe all the regulations and rules I am setting before you today.
- 32 be sure that you obey all the decrees and laws I am setting before you today.

Deuteronomy 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the rules and regulations that you must diligently observe for as long as you live in this country that GOD, the God-of-Your-Fathers, has given you to possess.

- 1 These are the decrees and laws you must be careful to follow in the land that the LORD, the God of your fathers, has given you to possess--as long as you live in the land.
- 2 Ruthlessly demolish all the sacred shrines where the nations that you're driving out worship their gods--wherever you find them, on hills and mountains or in groves of green trees.
- 2 Destroy completely all the places on the high mountains and on the hills and under every spreading tree where the nations you are dispossessing worship their gods.
- 3 Tear apart their altars. Smash their phallic pillars. Burn their sex-and-religion Asherah shrines. Break up their carved gods. Obliterate the names of those god sites.
- 3 Break down their altars, smash their sacred stones and burn their Asherah poles in the fire; cut down the idols of their gods and wipe out their names from those places.
- 4 Stay clear of those places--don't let what went on there contaminate the worship of GOD, your God.
- 4 You must not worship the LORD your God in their way.
- 5 Instead find the site that GOD, your God, will choose and mark it with his name as a common center for all the tribes of Israel. Assemble there.
- 5 But you are to seek the place the LORD your God will choose from among all your tribes to put his Name there for his dwelling. To that place you must go;
- 6 Bring to that place your Absolution-Offerings and sacrifices, your tithes and Tribute-Offerings, your Vow-Offerings, your Freewill-Offerings, and the firstborn of your herds and flocks.
- 6 there bring your burnt offerings and sacrifices, your tithes and special gifts, what you have vowed to give and your freewill offerings, and the firstborn of your herds and flocks.
- 7 Feast there in the Presence of GOD, your God. Celebrate everything that you and your families have accomplished under the blessing of GOD, your God.
- 7 There, in the presence of the LORD your God, you and your families shall eat and shall rejoice in everything you have put your hand to, because the LORD your God has blessed you.

- 8 Don't continue doing things the way we're doing them at present, each of us doing as we wish.
- 8 You are not to do as we do here today, everyone as he sees fit,
- 9 Until now you haven't arrived at the goal, the resting place, the inheritance that GOD, your God, is giving you.
- 9 since you have not yet reached the resting place and the inheritance the LORD your God is giving you.
- 10 But the minute you cross the Jordan River and settle into the land GOD, your God, is enabling you to inherit, he'll give you rest from all your surrounding enemies. You'll be able to settle down and live in safety.
- 10 But you will cross the Jordan and settle in the land the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, and he will give you rest from all your enemies around you so that you will live in safety.
- 11 From then on, at the place that GOD, your God, chooses to mark with his name as the place where you can meet him, bring everything that I command you: your Absolution-Offerings and sacrifices, tithes and Tribute-Offerings, and the best of your Vow-Offerings that you vow to GOD.
- 11 Then to the place the LORD your God will choose as a dwelling for his Name--there you are to bring everything I command you: your burnt offerings and sacrifices, your tithes and special gifts, and all the choice possessions you have vowed to the LORD.
- 12 Celebrate there in the Presence of GOD, your God, you and your sons and daughters, your servants and maids, including the Levite living in your neighborhood because he has no place of his own in your inheritance.
- 12 And there rejoice before the LORD your God, you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levites from your towns, who have no allotment or inheritance of their own.
- 13 Be extra careful: Don't offer your Absolution-Offerings just any place that strikes your fancy.
- 13 Be careful not to sacrifice your burnt offerings anywhere you please.
- 14 Offer your Absolution-Offerings only in the place that GOD chooses in one of your tribal regions. There and only there are you to bring all that I command you.

- 14 Offer them only at the place the LORD will choose in one of your tribes, and there observe everything I command you.
- 15 It's permissible to slaughter your nonsacrificial animals like gazelle and deer in your towns and eat all you want from them with the blessing of GOD, your God. Both the ritually clean and unclean may eat.
- 15 Nevertheless, you may slaughter your animals in any of your towns and eat as much of the meat as you want, as if it were gazelle or deer, according to the blessing the LORD your God gives you. Both the ceremonially unclean and the clean may eat it.
- 16 But you may not eat the blood. Pour the blood out on the ground like water.
- 16 But you must not eat the blood; pour it out on the ground like water.
- 17 Nor may you eat there the tithe of your grain, new wine, or olive oil; nor the firstborn of your herds and flocks; nor any of the Vow-Offerings that you vow; nor your Freewill-Offerings and Tribute-Offerings.
- 17 You must not eat in your own towns the tithe of your grain and new wine and oil, or the firstborn of your herds and flocks, or whatever you have vowed to give, or your freewill offerings or special gifts.
- 18 All these you must eat in the Presence of GOD, your God, in the place GOD, your God, chooses--you, your son and daughter, your servant and maid, and the Levite who lives in your neighborhood. You are to celebrate in the Presence of GOD, your God, all the things you've been able to accomplish.
- 18 Instead, you are to eat them in the presence of the LORD your God at the place the LORD your God will choose--you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levites from your towns--and you are to rejoice before the LORD your God in everything you put your hand to.
- 19 And make sure that for as long as you live on your land you never, never neglect the Levite.
- 19 Be careful not to neglect the Levites as long as you live in your land.
- 20 When GOD, your God, expands your territory as he promised he would do, and you say, "I'm hungry for meat," because you happen to be craving meat at the time, go ahead and eat as much meat as you want.
- 20 When the LORD your God has enlarged your territory as he promised you, and you crave meat and say, "I would like some meat," then you

may eat as much of it as you want.

- 21 If you're too far away from the place that GOD, your God, has marked with his name, it's all right to slaughter animals from your herds and flocks that GOD has given you, as I've commanded you. In your own towns you may eat as much of them as you want.
- 21 If the place where the LORD your God chooses to put his Name is too far away from you, you may slaughter animals from the herds and flocks the LORD has given you, as I have commanded you, and in your own towns you may eat as much of them as you want.
- 22 Just as the nonsacrificial animals like the gazelle and deer are eaten, you may eat them; the ritually unclean and clean may eat them at the same table.
- 22 Eat them as you would gazelle or deer. Both the ceremonially unclean and the clean may eat.
- 23 Only this: Absolutely no blood. Don't eat the blood. Blood is life; don't eat the life with the meat.
- 23 But be sure you do not eat the blood, because the blood is the life, and you must not eat the life with the meat.
- 24 Don't eat it; pour it out on the ground like water.
- 24 You must not eat the blood; pour it out on the ground like water.
- 25 Don't eat it; then you'll have a good life, you and your children after you. By all means, do the right thing in GOD's eyes.
- 25 Do not eat it, so that it may go well with you and your children after you, because you will be doing what is right in the eyes of the LORD.
- 26 And this: Lift high your Holy-Offerings and your Vow-Offerings and bring them to the place GOD designates.
- 26 But take your consecrated things and whatever you have vowed to give, and go to the place the LORD will choose.
- 27 Sacrifice your Absolution-Offerings, the meat and blood, on the Altar of GOD, your God; pour out the blood of the Absolution-Offering on the Altar of GOD, your God; then you can go ahead and eat the meat.
- 27 Present your burnt offerings on the altar of the LORD your God, both the meat and the blood. The blood of your sacrifices must be poured beside the altar of the LORD your God, but you may eat the meat.
- 28 Be vigilant, listen obediently to these words that I command you so that you'll have a good life, you and your children, for a long, long time,

- doing what is good and right in the eyes of GOD, your God.
- 28 Be careful to obey all these regulations I am giving you, so that it may always go well with you and your children after you, because you will be doing what is good and right in the eyes of the LORD your God.
- 29 When GOD, your God, cuts off the nations whose land you are invading, shoves them out of your way so that you displace them and settle in their land,
- 29 The LORD your God will cut off before you the nations you are about to invade and dispossess. But when you have driven them out and settled in their land,
- 30 be careful that you don't get curious about them after they've been destroyed before you. Don't get fascinated with their gods, thinking, "I wonder what it was like for them, worshiping their gods. I'd like to try that myself."
- 30 and after they have been destroyed before you, be careful not to be ensnared by inquiring about their gods, saying, "How do these nations serve their gods? We will do the same."
- 31 Don't do this to GOD, your God. They commit every imaginable abomination with their gods. GOD hates it all with a passion. Why, they even set their children on fire as offerings to their gods!
- 31 You must not worship the LORD your God in their way, because in worshiping their gods, they do all kinds of detestable things the LORD hates. They even burn their sons and daughters in the fire as sacrifices to their gods.
- 32 Diligently do everything I command you, the way I command you: don't add to it; don't subtract from it.
- 32 See that you do all I command you; do not add to it or take away from it.

Deuteronomy 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 When a prophet or visionary gets up in your community and gives out a miracle-sign or wonder,

- 1 If a prophet, or one who foretells by dreams, appears among you and announces to you a miraculous sign or wonder,
- 2 and the miracle-sign or wonder that he gave out happens and he says, "Let's follow other gods" (these are gods you know nothing about), "let's worship them,"
- 2 and if the sign or wonder of which he has spoken takes place, and he says, "Let us follow other gods" (gods you have not known) "and let us worship them,"
- 3 don't pay any attention to what that prophet or visionary says. GOD, your God, is testing you to find out if you totally love him with everything you have in you.
- 3 you must not listen to the words of that prophet or dreamer. The LORD your God is testing you to find out whether you love him with all your heart and with all your soul.
- 4 You are to follow only GOD, your God, hold him in deep reverence, keep his commandments, listen obediently to what he says, serve him--hold on to him for dear life!
- 4 It is the LORD your God you must follow, and him you must revere. Keep his commands and obey him; serve him and hold fast to him.
- 5 And that prophet or visionary must be put to death. He has urged mutiny against GOD, your God, who rescued you from Egypt, who redeemed you from a world of slavery and put you on the road on which GOD, your God, has commanded you to walk. Purge the evil from your company.
- 5 That prophet or dreamer must be put to death, because he preached rebellion against the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt and redeemed you from the land of slavery; he has tried to turn you from the way the LORD your God commanded you to follow. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 6 And when your brother or son or daughter, or even your dear wife or lifelong friend, comes to you in secret and whispers, "Let's go and worship some other gods" (gods that you know nothing about, neither you nor your ancestors,
- 6 If your very own brother, or your son or daughter, or the wife you love, or your closest friend secretly entices you, saying, "Let us go and worship other gods" (gods that neither you nor your fathers have known,

- 7 the gods of the peoples around you near and far, from one end of the Earth to the other),
- 7 gods of the peoples around you, whether near or far, from one end of the land to the other),
- 8 don't go along with him; shut your ears. Don't feel sorry for him and don't make excuses for him.
- 8 do not yield to him or listen to him. Show him no pity. Do not spare him or shield him.
- 9 Kill him. That's right, kill him. You throw the first stone. Take action at once and swiftly with everybody in the community getting in on it at the end.
- 9 You must certainly put him to death. Your hand must be the first in putting him to death, and then the hands of all the people.
- 10 Stone him with stones so that he dies. He tried to turn you traitor against GOD, your God, the one who got you out of Egypt and the world of slavery.
- 10 Stone him to death, because he tried to turn you away from the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery.
- 11 Every man, woman, and child in Israel will hear what's been done and be in awe. No one will dare to do an evil thing like this again.
- 11 Then all Israel will hear and be afraid, and no one among you will do such an evil thing again.
- 12 When word comes in from one of your cities that GOD, your God, is giving you to live in,
- 12 If you hear it said about one of the towns the LORD your God is giving you to live in
- 13 reporting that evil men have gotten together with some of the citizens of the city and have broken away, saying, "Let's go and worship other gods" (gods you know nothing about),
- 13 that wicked men have arisen among you and have led the people of their town astray, saying, "Let us go and worship other gods" (gods you have not known),
- 14 then you must conduct a careful examination. Ask questions, investigate. If it turns out that the report is true and this abomination did in fact take place in your community,

- 14 then you must inquire, probe and investigate it thoroughly. And if it is true and it has been proved that this detestable thing has been done among you,
- 15 you must execute the citizens of that town. Kill them, setting that city apart for holy destruction: the city and everything in it including its animals.
- 15 you must certainly put to the sword all who live in that town. Destroy it completely, both its people and its livestock.
- 16 Gather the plunder in the middle of the town square and burn it all--town and plunder together up in smoke, a holy sacrifice to GOD, your God. Leave it there, ashes and ruins. Don't build on that site again.
- 16 Gather all the plunder of the town into the middle of the public square and completely burn the town and all its plunder as a whole burnt offering to the LORD your God. It is to remain a ruin forever, never to be rebuilt.
- 17 And don't let any of the plunder devoted to holy destruction stick to your fingers. Get rid of it so that GOD may turn from anger to compassion, generously making you prosper, just as he promised your ancestors.
- 17 None of those condemned things shall be found in your hands, so that the LORD will turn from his fierce anger; he will show you mercy, have compassion on you, and increase your numbers, as he promised on oath to your forefathers,
- 18 Yes. Obediently listen to GOD, your God. Keep all his commands that I am giving you today. Do the right thing in the eyes of GOD, your God.
- 18 because you obey the LORD your God, keeping all his commands that I am giving you today and doing what is right in his eyes.

Deuteronomy 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 You are children of GOD, your God, so don't mutilate your bodies or shave your heads in funeral rites for the dead.
- 1 You are the children of the LORD your God. Do not cut yourselves or shave the front of your heads for the dead,

- 2 You only are a people holy to GOD, your God; GOD chose you out of all the people on Earth as his cherished personal treasure.
- 2 for you are a people holy to the LORD your God. Out of all the peoples on the face of the earth, the LORD has chosen you to be his treasured possession.
- 3 Don't eat anything abominable.
- 3 Do not eat any detestable thing.
- 4 These are the animals you may eat: ox, sheep, goat,
- 4 These are the animals you may eat: the ox, the sheep, the goat,
- 5 deer, gazelle, roebuck, wild goat, ibex, antelope, mountain sheep--
- 5 the deer, the gazelle, the roe deer, the wild goat, the ibex, the antelope and the mountain sheep.
- 6 any animal that has a cloven hoof and chews the cud.
- 6 You may eat any animal that has a split hoof divided in two and that chews the cud.
- 7 But you may not eat camels, rabbits, and rock badgers because they chew the cud but they don't have a cloven hoof--that makes them ritually unclean.
- 7 However, of those that chew the cud or that have a split hoof completely divided you may not eat the camel, the rabbit or the coney. Although they chew the cud, they do not have a split hoof; they are ceremonially unclean for you.
- 8 And pigs: Don't eat pigs--they have a cloven hoof but don't chew the cud, which makes them ritually unclean. Don't even touch a pig's carcass.
- 8 The pig is also unclean; although it has a split hoof, it does not chew the cud. You are not to eat their meat or touch their carcasses.
- 9 This is what you may eat from the water: anything that has fins and scales.
- 9 Of all the creatures living in the water, you may eat any that has fins and scales.
- 10 But if it doesn't have fins or scales, you may not eat it. It's ritually unclean.
- 10 But anything that does not have fins and scales you may not eat; for you it is unclean.
- 11 You may eat any ritually clean bird.
- 11 You may eat any clean bird.

- 12 These are the exceptions, so don't eat these: eagle, vulture, black vulture,
- 12 But these you may not eat: the eagle, the vulture, the black vulture,
- 13 kite, falcon, the buzzard family,
- 13 the red kite, the black kite, any kind of falcon,
- 14 the raven family,
- 14 any kind of raven,
- 15 ostrich, nighthawk, the hawk family,
- 15 the horned owl, the screech owl, the gull, any kind of hawk,
- 16 little owl, great owl, white owl,
- 16 the little owl, the great owl, the white owl,
- 17 pelican, osprey, cormorant,
- 17 the desert owl, the osprey, the cormorant,
- 18 stork, the heron family, hoopoe, bat.
- 18 the stork, any kind of heron, the hoopoe and the bat.
- 19 Winged insects are ritually unclean; don't eat them.
- 19 All flying insects that swarm are unclean to you; do not eat them.
- 20 But ritually clean winged creatures are permitted.
- 20 But any winged creature that is clean you may eat.
- 21 Because you are a people holy to GOD, your God, don't eat anything that you find dead. You can, though, give it to a foreigner in your neighborhood for a meal or sell it to a foreigner. Don't boil a kid in its mother's milk.
- 21 Do not eat anything you find already dead. You may give it to an alien living in any of your towns, and he may eat it, or you may sell it to a foreigner. But you are a people holy to the LORD your God. Do not cook a young goat in its mother's milk.
- 22 Make an offering of ten percent, a tithe, of all the produce which grows in your fields year after year.
- 22 Be sure to set aside a tenth of all that your fields produce each year.
- 23 Bring this into the Presence of GOD, your God, at the place he designates for worship and there eat the tithe from your grain, wine, and oil and the firstborn from your herds and flocks. In this way you will learn to live in deep reverence before GOD, your God, as long as you live.

- 23 Eat the tithe of your grain, new wine and oil, and the firstborn of your herds and flocks in the presence of the LORD your God at the place he will choose as a dwelling for his Name, so that you may learn to revere the LORD your God always.
- 24 But if the place GOD, your God, designates for worship is too far away and you can't carry your tithe that far, GOD, your God, will still bless you:
- 24 But if that place is too distant and you have been blessed by the LORD your God and cannot carry your tithe (because the place where the LORD will choose to put his Name is so far away),
- 25 exchange your tithe for money and take the money to the place GOD, your God, has chosen to be worshiped.
- 25 then exchange your tithe for silver, and take the silver with you and go to the place the LORD your God will choose.
- 26 Use the money to buy anything you want: cattle, sheep, wine, or beer--anything that looks good to you. You and your family can then feast in the Presence of GOD, your God, and have a good time.
- 26 Use the silver to buy whatever you like: cattle, sheep, wine or other fermented drink, or anything you wish. Then you and your household shall eat there in the presence of the LORD your God and rejoice.
- 27 Meanwhile, don't forget to take good care of the Levites who live in your towns; they won't get any property or inheritance of their own as you will.
- 27 And do not neglect the Levites living in your towns, for they have no allotment or inheritance of their own.
- 28 At the end of every third year, gather the tithe from all your produce of that year and put it aside in storage.
- 28 At the end of every three years, bring all the tithes of that year's produce and store it in your towns,
- 29 Keep it in reserve for the Levite who won't get any property or inheritance as you will, and for the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow who live in your neighborhood. That way they'll have plenty to eat and GOD, your God, will bless you in all your work.
- 29 so that the Levites (who have no allotment or inheritance of their own) and the aliens, the fatherless and the widows who live in your towns may

come and eat and be satisfied, and so that the LORD your God may bless you in all the work of your hands.

Deuteronomy 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 At the end of every seventh year, cancel all debts.
- 1 At the end of every seven years you must cancel debts.
- 2 This is the procedure: Everyone who has lent money to a neighbor writes it off. You must not press your neighbor or his brother for payment: All-Debts-Are-Canceled--GOD says so.
- 2 This is how it is to be done: Every creditor shall cancel the loan he has made to his fellow Israelite. He shall not require payment from his fellow Israelite or brother, because the LORD's time for canceling debts has been proclaimed.
- 3 You may collect payment from foreigners, but whatever you have lent to your fellow Israelite you must write off.
- 3 You may require payment from a foreigner, but you must cancel any debt your brother owes you.
- 4 There must be no poor people among you because GOD is going to bless you lavishly in this land that GOD, your God, is giving you as an inheritance, your very own land.
- 4 However, there should be no poor among you, for in the land the LORD your God is giving you to possess as your inheritance, he will richly bless you,
- 5 But only if you listen obediently to the Voice of GOD, your God, diligently observing every commandment that I command you today.
- 5 if only you fully obey the LORD your God and are careful to follow all these commands I am giving you today.
- 6 Oh yes--GOD, your God, will bless you just as he promised. You will lend to many nations but won't borrow from any; you'll rule over many nations but none will rule over you.
- 6 For the LORD your God will bless you as he has promised, and you will lend to many nations but will borrow from none. You will rule over many nations but none will rule over you.

- 7 When you happen on someone who's in trouble or needs help among your people with whom you live in this land that GOD, your God, is giving you, don't look the other way pretending you don't see him. Don't keep a tight grip on your purse.
- 7 If there is a poor man among your brothers in any of the towns of the land that the LORD your God is giving you, do not be hardhearted or tightfisted toward your poor brother.
- 8 No. Look at him, open your purse, lend whatever and as much as he needs.
- 8 Rather be openhanded and freely lend him whatever he needs.
- 9 Don't count the cost. Don't listen to that selfish voice saying, "It's almost the seventh year, the year of All-Debts-Are-Canceled," and turn aside and leave your needy neighbor in the lurch, refusing to help him. He'll call GOD's attention to you and your blatant sin.
- 9 Be careful not to harbor this wicked thought: "The seventh year, the year for canceling debts, is near," so that you do not show ill will toward your needy brother and give him nothing. He may then appeal to the LORD against you, and you will be found guilty of sin.
- 10 Give freely and spontaneously. Don't have a stingy heart. The way you handle matters like this triggers GOD, your God's, blessing in everything you do, all your work and ventures.
- 10 Give generously to him and do so without a grudging heart; then because of this the LORD your God will bless you in all your work and in everything you put your hand to.
- 11 There are always going to be poor and needy people among you. So I command you: Always be generous, open purse and hands, give to your neighbors in trouble, your poor and hurting neighbors.
- 11 There will always be poor people in the land. Therefore I command you to be openhanded toward your brothers and toward the poor and needy in your land.
- 12 If a Hebrew man or Hebrew woman was sold to you and has served you for six years, in the seventh year you must set him or her free, released into a free life.
- 12 If a fellow Hebrew, a man or a woman, sells himself to you and serves you six years, in the seventh year you must let him go free.
- 13 And when you set them free don't send them off empty-handed.

- 13 And when you release him, do not send him away empty-handed.
- 14 Provide them with some animals, plenty of bread and wine and oil. Load them with provisions from all the blessings with which GOD, your God, has blessed you.
- 14 Supply him liberally from your flock, your threshing floor and your winepress. Give to him as the LORD your God has blessed you.
- 15 Don't for a minute forget that you were once slaves in Egypt and GOD, your God, redeemed you from that slave world. For that reason, this day I command you to do this.
- 15 Remember that you were slaves in Egypt and the LORD your God redeemed you. That is why I give you this command today.
- 16 But if your slave, because he loves you and your family and has a good life with you, says, "I don't want to leave you,"
- 16 But if your servant says to you, "I do not want to leave you," because he loves you and your family and is well off with you,
- 17 then take an awl and pierce through his earlobe into the doorpost, marking him as your slave forever. Do the same with your women slaves who want to stay with you.
- 17 then take an awl and push it through his ear lobe into the door, and he will become your servant for life. Do the same for your maidservant.
- 18 Don't consider this an unreasonable hardship, this setting your slave free. After all, he's worked six years for you at half the cost of a hired hand. Believe me, GOD, your God, will bless you in everything you do.
- 18 Do not consider it a hardship to set your servant free, because his service to you these six years has been worth twice as much as that of a hired hand. And the LORD your God will bless you in everything you do.
- 19 Consecrate to GOD, your God, all the firstborn males in your herds and flocks. Don't use the firstborn from your herds as work animals; don't shear the firstborn from your flocks.
- 19 Set apart for the LORD your God every firstborn male of your herds and flocks. Do not put the firstborn of your oxen to work, and do not shear the firstborn of your sheep.
- 20 These are for you to eat every year, you and your family, in the Presence of GOD, your God, at the place that GOD designates for worship.

- 20 Each year you and your family are to eat them in the presence of the LORD your God at the place he will choose.
- 21 If the animal is defective, lame, say, or blind--anything wrong with it--don't slaughter it as a sacrifice to GOD, your God.
- 21 If an animal has a defect, is lame or blind, or has any serious flaw, you must not sacrifice it to the LORD your God.
- 22 Stay at home and eat it there. Both the ritually clean and unclean may eat it, the same as with a gazelle or a deer.
- 22 You are to eat it in your own towns. Both the ceremonially unclean and the clean may eat it, as if it were gazelle or deer.
- 23 Only you must not eat its blood. Pour the blood out on the ground like water.
- 23 But you must not eat the blood; pour it out on the ground like water.

Deuteronomy 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Observe the month of Abib by celebrating the Passover to GOD, your God. It was in the month of Abib that GOD, your God, delivered you by night from Egypt.
- 1 Observe the month of Abib and celebrate the Passover of the LORD your God, because in the month of Abib he brought you out of Egypt by night.
- 2 Offer the Passover-Sacrifice to GOD, your God, at the place GOD chooses to be worshiped by establishing his name there.
- 2 Sacrifice as the Passover to the LORD your God an animal from your flock or herd at the place the LORD will choose as a dwelling for his Name.
- 3 Don't eat yeast bread with it; for seven days eat it with unraised bread, hard-times bread, because you left Egypt in a hurry--that bread will keep the memory fresh of how you left Egypt for as long as you live.
- 3 Do not eat it with bread made with yeast, but for seven days eat unleavened bread, the bread of affliction, because you left Egypt in haste--so that all the days of your life you may remember the time of your departure from Egypt.

- 4 There is to be no sign of yeast anywhere for seven days. And don't let any of the meat that you sacrifice in the evening be left over until morning.
- 4 Let no yeast be found in your possession in all your land for seven days. Do not let any of the meat you sacrifice on the evening of the first day remain until morning.
- 5 Don't sacrifice the Passover in any of the towns that GOD, your God, gives you
- 5 You must not sacrifice the Passover in any town the LORD your God gives you
- 6 other than the one GOD, your God, designates for worship; there and there only you will offer the Passover-Sacrifice at evening as the sun goes down, marking the time that you left Egypt.
- 6 except in the place he will choose as a dwelling for his Name. There you must sacrifice the Passover in the evening, when the sun goes down, on the anniversary of your departure from Egypt.
- 7 Boil and eat it at the place designated by GOD, your God. Then, at daybreak, turn around and go home.
- 7 Roast it and eat it at the place the LORD your God will choose. Then in the morning return to your tents.
- 8 Eat unraised bread for six days. Set aside the seventh day as a holiday; don't do any work.
- 8 For six days eat unleavened bread and on the seventh day hold an assembly to the LORD your God and do no work.
- 9 Starting from the day you put the sickle to the ripe grain, count out seven weeks.
- 9 Count off seven weeks from the time you begin to put the sickle to the standing grain.
- 10 Celebrate the Feast-of-Weeks to GOD, your God, by bringing your Freewill-Offering--give as generously as GOD, your God, has blessed you.
- 10 Then celebrate the Feast of Weeks to the LORD your God by giving a freewill offering in proportion to the blessings the LORD your God has given you.
- 11 Rejoice in the Presence of GOD, your God: you, your son, your daughter, your servant, your maid, the Levite who lives in your

- neighborhood, the foreigner, the orphan and widow among you; rejoice at the place GOD, your God, will set aside to be worshiped.
- 11 And rejoice before the LORD your God at the place he will choose as a dwelling for his Name-- you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, the Levites in your towns, and the aliens, the fatherless and the widows living among you.
- 12 Don't forget that you were once a slave in Egypt. So be diligent in observing these regulations.
- 12 Remember that you were slaves in Egypt, and follow carefully these decrees.
- 13 Observe the Feast-of-Booths for seven days when you gather the harvest from your threshing-floor and your wine-vat.
- 13 Celebrate the Feast of Tabernacles for seven days after you have gathered the produce of your threshing floor and your winepress.
- 14 Rejoice at your festival: you, your son, your daughter, your servant, your maid, the Levite, the foreigner, and the orphans and widows who live in your neighborhood.
- 14 Be joyful at your Feast--you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levites, the aliens, the fatherless and the widows who live in your towns.
- 15 Celebrate the Feast to GOD, your God, for seven days at the place GOD designates. GOD, your God, has been blessing you in your harvest and in all your work, so make a day of it--really celebrate!
- 15 For seven days celebrate the Feast to the LORD your God at the place the LORD will choose. For the LORD your God will bless you in all your harvest and in all the work of your hands, and your joy will be complete.
- 16 All your men must appear before GOD, your God, three times each year at the place he designates: at the Feast-of-Unraised-Bread (Passover), at the Feast-of-Weeks, and at the Feast-of-Booths. No one is to show up in the Presence of GOD empty-handed;
- 16 Three times a year all your men must appear before the LORD your God at the place he will choose: at the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the Feast of Weeks and the Feast of Tabernacles. No man should appear before the LORD empty-handed:

- 17 each man must bring as much as he can manage, giving generously in response to the blessings of GOD, your God.
- 17 Each of you must bring a gift in proportion to the way the LORD your God has blessed you.
- 18 Appoint judges and officers, organized by tribes, in all the towns that GOD, your God, is giving you. They are to judge the people fairly and honestly.
- 18 Appoint judges and officials for each of your tribes in every town the LORD your God is giving you, and they shall judge the people fairly.
- 19 Don't twist the law. Don't play favorites. Don't take a bribe--a bribe blinds even a wise person; it undermines the intentions of the best of people.
- 19 Do not pervert justice or show partiality. Do not accept a bribe, for a bribe blinds the eyes of the wise and twists the words of the righteous.
- 20 The right! The right! Pursue only what's right! It's the only way you can really live and possess the land that GOD, your God, is giving you.
- 20 Follow justice and justice alone, so that you may live and possess the land the LORD your God is giving you.
- 21 Don't plant fertility Asherah trees alongside the Altar of GOD, your God, that you build.
- 21 Do not set up any wooden Asherah pole beside the altar you build to the LORD your God,
- 22 Don't set up phallic sex pillars--GOD, your God, hates them.
- 22 and do not erect a sacred stone, for these the LORD your God hates.

Deuteronomy 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 And don't sacrifice to GOD, your God, an ox or sheep that is defective or has anything at all wrong with it. That's an abomination, an insult to GOD, your God.
- 1 Do not sacrifice to the LORD your God an ox or a sheep that has any defect or flaw in it, for that would be detestable to him.
- 2 If you find anyone within the towns that GOD, your God, is giving you doing what is wrong in GOD's eyes, breaking his covenant

- 2 If a man or woman living among you in one of the towns the LORD gives you is found doing evil in the eyes of the LORD your God in violation of his covenant,
- 3 by going off to worship other gods, bowing down to them--the sun, say, or the moon, or any rebel sky-gods--
- 3 and contrary to my command has worshiped other gods, bowing down to them or to the sun or the moon or the stars of the sky,
- 4 look at the evidence and investigate carefully. If you find that it is true, that, in fact, an abomination has been committed in Israel,
- 4 and this has been brought to your attention, then you must investigate it thoroughly. If it is true and it has been proved that this detestable thing has been done in Israel,
- 5 then you are to take the man or woman who did this evil thing outside your city gates and stone the man or the woman. Hurl stones at the person until dead.
- 5 take the man or woman who has done this evil deed to your city gate and stone that person to death.
- 6 But only on the testimony of two or three witnesses may a person be put to death. No one may be put to death on the testimony of one witness.
- 6 On the testimony of two or three witnesses a man shall be put to death, but no one shall be put to death on the testimony of only one witness.
- 7 The witnesses must throw the first stones in the execution, then the rest of the community joins in. You have to purge the evil from your community.
- 7 The hands of the witnesses must be the first in putting him to death, and then the hands of all the people. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 8 When matters of justice come up that are too much for you--hard cases regarding homicides, legal disputes, fights--take them up to the central place of worship that GOD, your God, has designated.
- 8 If cases come before your courts that are too difficult for you to judge--whether bloodshed, lawsuits or assaults--take them to the place the LORD your God will choose.
- 9 Bring them to the Levitical priests and the judge who is in office at the time. Consult them and they will hand down the decision for you.

- 9 Go to the priests, who are Levites, and to the judge who is in office at that time. Inquire of them and they will give you the verdict.
- 10 Then carry out their verdict at the place designated by GOD, your God. Do what they tell you, in exactly the way they tell you.
- 10 You must act according to the decisions they give you at the place the LORD will choose. Be careful to do everything they direct you to do.
- 11 Follow their instructions precisely: Don't leave out anything; don't add anything.
- 11 Act according to the law they teach you and the decisions they give you. Do not turn aside from what they tell you, to the right or to the left.
- 12 Anyone who presumes to override or twist the decision handed down by the priest or judge who was acting in the Presence of GOD, your God, is as good as dead--root him out, rid Israel of the evil.
- 12 The man who shows contempt for the judge or for the priest who stands ministering there to the LORD your God must be put to death. You must purge the evil from Israel.
- 13 Everyone will take notice and be impressed. That will put an end to presumptuous behavior.
- 13 All the people will hear and be afraid, and will not be contemptuous again.
- 14 When you enter the land that GOD, your God, is giving you and take it over and settle down, and then say, "I'm going to get me a king, a king like all the nations around me,"
- 14 When you enter the land the LORD your God is giving you and have taken possession of it and settled in it, and you say, "Let us set a king over us like all the nations around us,"
- 15 make sure you get yourself a king whom GOD, your God, chooses. Choose your king from among your kinsmen; don't take a foreigner--only a kinsman.
- 15 be sure to appoint over you the king the LORD your God chooses. He must be from among your own brothers. Do not place a foreigner over you, one who is not a brother Israelite.
- 16 And make sure he doesn't build up a war machine, amassing military horses and chariots. He must not send people to Egypt to get more horses, because GOD told you, "You'll never go back there again!"

- 16 The king, moreover, must not acquire great numbers of horses for himself or make the people return to Egypt to get more of them, for the LORD has told you, "You are not to go back that way again."
- 17 And make sure he doesn't build up a harem, collecting wives who will divert him from the straight and narrow. And make sure he doesn't pile up a lot of silver and gold.
- 17 He must not take many wives, or his heart will be led astray. He must not accumulate large amounts of silver and gold.
- 18 This is what must be done: When he sits down on the throne of his kingdom, the first thing he must do is make himself a copy of this Revelation on a scroll, copied under the supervision of the Levitical priests.
- 18 When he takes the throne of his kingdom, he is to write for himself on a scroll a copy of this law, taken from that of the priests, who are Levites.
- 19 That scroll is to remain at his side at all times; he is to study it every day so that he may learn what it means to fear his GOD, living in reverent obedience before these rules and regulations by following them.
- 19 It is to be with him, and he is to read it all the days of his life so that he may learn to revere the LORD his God and follow carefully all the words of this law and these decrees
- 20 He must not become proud and arrogant, changing the commands at whim to suit himself or making up his own versions. If he reads and learns, he will have a long reign as king in Israel, he and his sons.
- 20 and not consider himself better than his brothers and turn from the law to the right or to the left. Then he and his descendants will reign a long time over his kingdom in Israel.

Deuteronomy 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Levitical priests--that's the entire tribe of Levi--don't get any land-inheritance with the rest of Israel. They get the Fire-Gift-Offerings of GOD--they will live on that inheritance.
- 1 The priests, who are Levites--indeed the whole tribe of Levi-- are to have no allotment or inheritance with Israel. They shall live on the offerings made to the LORD by fire, for that is their inheritance.
- 2 But they don't get land-inheritance like the rest of their kinsmen. GOD is their inheritance.
- 2 They shall have no inheritance among their brothers; the LORD is their inheritance, as he promised them.
- 3 This is what the priests get from the people from any offering of an ox or a sheep: the shoulder, the two cheeks, and the stomach.
- 3 This is the share due the priests from the people who sacrifice a bull or a sheep: the shoulder, the jowls and the inner parts.
- 4 You must also give them the firstfruits of your grain, wine, and oil and the first fleece of your sheep,
- 4 You are to give them the firstfruits of your grain, new wine and oil, and the first wool from the shearing of your sheep,
- 5 because GOD, your God, has chosen only them and their children out of all your tribes to be present and serve always in the name of GOD, your God.
- 5 for the LORD your God has chosen them and their descendants out of all your tribes to stand and minister in the LORD's name always.
- 6 If a Levite moves from any town in Israel--and he is quite free to move wherever he desires--and comes to the place GOD designates for worship,
- 6 If a Levite moves from one of your towns anywhere in Israel where he is living, and comes in all earnestness to the place the LORD will choose,
- 7 he may serve there in the name of GOD along with all his brother Levites who are present and serving in the Presence of GOD.

- 7 he may minister in the name of the LORD his God like all his fellow Levites who serve there in the presence of the LORD.
- 8 And he will get an equal share to eat, even though he has money from the sale of his parents' possessions.
- 8 He is to share equally in their benefits, even though he has received money from the sale of family possessions.
- 9 When you enter the land that GOD, your God, is giving you, don't take on the abominable ways of life of the nations there.
- 9 When you enter the land the LORD your God is giving you, do not learn to imitate the detestable ways of the nations there.
- 10 Don't you dare sacrifice your son or daughter in the fire. Don't practice divination, sorcery, fortunetelling, witchery,
- 10 Let no one be found among you who sacrifices his son or daughter in the fire, who practices divination or sorcery, interprets omens, engages in witchcraft,
- 11 casting spells, holding séances, or channeling with the dead.
- 11 or casts spells, or who is a medium or spiritist or who consults the dead.
- 12 People who do these things are an abomination to GOD. It's because of just such abominable practices that GOD, your God, is driving these nations out before you.
- 12 Anyone who does these things is detestable to the LORD, and because of these detestable practices the LORD your God will drive out those nations before you.
- 13 Be completely loyal to GOD, your God.
- 13 You must be blameless before the LORD your God.
- 14 These nations that you're about to run out of the country consort with sorcerers and witches. But not you. GOD, your God, forbids it.
- 14 The nations you will dispossess listen to those who practice sorcery or divination. But as for you, the LORD your God has not permitted you to do so.
- 15 GOD, your God, is going to raise up a prophet for you. GOD will raise him up from among your kinsmen, a prophet like me. Listen obediently to him.
- 15 The LORD your God will raise up for you a prophet like me from among your own brothers. You must listen to him.

- 16 This is what you asked GOD, your God, for at Horeb on the day you were all gathered at the mountain and said, "We can't hear any more from GOD, our God; we can't stand seeing any more fire. We'll die!"
- 16 For this is what you asked of the LORD your God at Horeb on the day of the assembly when you said, "Let us not hear the voice of the LORD our God nor see this great fire anymore, or we will die."
- 17 And GOD said to me, "They're right; they've spoken the truth.
- 17 The LORD said to me: "What they say is good.
- 18 I'll raise up for them a prophet like you from their kinsmen. I'll tell him what to say and he will pass on to them everything I command him.
- 18 I will raise up for them a prophet like you from among their brothers; I will put my words in his mouth, and he will tell them everything I command him.
- 19 And anyone who won't listen to my words spoken by him, I will personally hold responsible.
- 19 If anyone does not listen to my words that the prophet speaks in my name, I myself will call him to account.
- 20 "But any prophet who fakes it, who claims to speak in my name something I haven't commanded him to say, or speaks in the name of other gods, that prophet must die."
- 20 But a prophet who presumes to speak in my name anything I have not commanded him to say, or a prophet who speaks in the name of other gods, must be put to death."
- 21 You may be wondering among yourselves, "How can we tell the difference, whether it was GOD who spoke or not?" Here's how:
- 21 You may say to yourselves, "How can we know when a message has not been spoken by the LORD?"
- 22 If what the prophet spoke in GOD's name doesn't happen, then obviously GOD wasn't behind it; the prophet made it up. Forget about him.
- 22 If what a prophet proclaims in the name of the LORD does not take place or come true, that is a message the LORD has not spoken. That prophet has spoken presumptuously. Do not be afraid of him.

Deuteronomy 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 When GOD, your God, throws the nations out of the country that GOD, your God, is giving you and you settle down in their cities and houses,
- 1 When the LORD your God has destroyed the nations whose land he is giving you, and when you have driven them out and settled in their towns and houses,
- 2 you are to set aside three easily accessible cities in the land that GOD, your God, is giving you as your very own.
- 2 then set aside for yourselves three cities centrally located in the land the LORD your God is giving you to possess.
- 3 Divide your land into thirds, this land that GOD, your God, is giving you to possess, and build roads to the towns so that anyone who accidentally kills another can flee there.
- 3 Build roads to them and divide into three parts the land the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, so that anyone who kills a man may flee there.
- 4 This is the guideline for the murderer who flees there to take refuge: He has to have killed his neighbor without premeditation and with no history of bad blood between them.
- 4 This is the rule concerning the man who kills another and flees there to save his life--one who kills his neighbor unintentionally, without malice aforethought.
- 5 For instance, a man goes with his neighbor into the woods to cut a tree; he swings the ax, the head slips off the handle and hits his neighbor, killing him. He may then flee to one of these cities and save his life.
- 5 For instance, a man may go into the forest with his neighbor to cut wood, and as he swings his ax to fell a tree, the head may fly off and hit his neighbor and kill him. That man may flee to one of these cities and save his life.
- 6 If the city is too far away, the avenger of blood racing in hot-blooded pursuit might catch him since it's such a long distance, and kill him even though he didn't deserve it. It wasn't his fault. There was no history of hatred between them.
- 6 Otherwise, the avenger of blood might pursue him in a rage, overtake him if the distance is too great, and kill him even though he is not

deserving of death, since he did it to his neighbor without malice aforethought.

- 7 Therefore I command you: Set aside the three cities for yourselves.
- 7 This is why I command you to set aside for yourselves three cities.
- 8 When GOD, your God, enlarges your land, extending its borders as he solemnly promised your ancestors, by giving you the whole land he promised them
- 8 If the LORD your God enlarges your territory, as he promised on oath to your forefathers, and gives you the whole land he promised them,
- 9 because you are diligently living the way I'm commanding you today, namely, to love GOD, your God, and do what he tells you all your life; and when that happens, then add three more to these three cities
- 9 because you carefully follow all these laws I command you today--to love the LORD your God and to walk always in his ways-- then you are to set aside three more cities.
- 10 so that there is no chance of innocent blood being spilled in your land. GOD, your God, is giving you this land as an inheritance--you don't want to pollute it with innocent blood and bring bloodguilt upon yourselves.
- 10 Do this so that innocent blood will not be shed in your land, which the LORD your God is giving you as your inheritance, and so that you will not be guilty of bloodshed.
- 11 On the other hand, if a man with a history of hatred toward his neighbor waits in ambush, then jumps him, mauls and kills him, and then runs to one of these cities, that's a different story.
- 11 But if a man hates his neighbor and lies in wait for him, assaults and kills him, and then flees to one of these cities,
- 12 The elders of his own city are to send for him and have him brought back. They are to hand him over to the avenger of blood for execution.
- 12 the elders of his town shall send for him, bring him back from the city, and hand him over to the avenger of blood to die.
- 13 Don't feel sorry for him. Clean out the pollution of wrongful murder from Israel so that you'll be able to live well and breathe clean air.
- 13 Show him no pity. You must purge from Israel the guilt of shedding innocent blood, so that it may go well with you.

- 14 Don't move your neighbor's boundary markers, the longstanding landmarks set up by your pioneer ancestors defining their property.
- 14 Do not move your neighbor's boundary stone set up by your predecessors in the inheritance you receive in the land the LORD your God is giving you to possess.
- 15 You cannot convict anyone of a crime or sin on the word of one witness. You need two or three witnesses to make a case.
- 15 One witness is not enough to convict a man accused of any crime or offense he may have committed. A matter must be established by the testimony of two or three witnesses.
- 16 If a hostile witness stands to accuse someone of a wrong,
- 16 If a malicious witness takes the stand to accuse a man of a crime,
- 17 then both parties involved in the quarrel must stand in the Presence of GOD before the priests and judges who are in office at that time.
- 17 the two men involved in the dispute must stand in the presence of the LORD before the priests and the judges who are in office at the time.
- 18 The judges must conduct a careful investigation; if the witness turns out to be a false witness and has lied against his fellow Israelite,
- 18 The judges must make a thorough investigation, and if the witness proves to be a liar, giving false testimony against his brother,
- 19 give him the same medicine he intended for the other party. Clean the polluting evil from your company.
- 19 then do to him as he intended to do to his brother. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 20 People will hear of what you've done and be impressed; that will put a stop to this kind of evil among you.
- 20 The rest of the people will hear of this and be afraid, and never again will such an evil thing be done among you.
- 21 Don't feel sorry for the person: It's life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.
- 21 Show no pity: life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.

Deuteronomy 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 When you go to war against your enemy and see horses and chariots and soldiers far outnumbering you, do not recoil in fear of them; GOD, your God, who brought you up out of Egypt is with you.
- 1 When you go to war against your enemies and see horses and chariots and an army greater than yours, do not be afraid of them, because the LORD your God, who brought you up out of Egypt, will be with you.
- 2 When the battle is about to begin, let the priest come forward and speak to the troops.
- 2 When you are about to go into battle, the priest shall come forward and address the army.
- 3 He'll say, "Attention, Israel. In a few minutes you're going to do battle with your enemies. Don't waver in resolve. Don't fear. Don't hesitate. Don't panic.
- 3 He shall say: "Hear, O Israel, today you are going into battle against your enemies. Do not be fainthearted or afraid; do not be terrified or give way to panic before them.
- 4 GOD, your God, is right there with you, fighting with you against your enemies, fighting to win."
- 4 For the LORD your God is the one who goes with you to fight for you against your enemies to give you victory."
- 5 Then let the officers step up and speak to the troops: "Is there a man here who has built a new house but hasn't yet dedicated it? Let him go home right now lest he die in battle and another man dedicate it.
- 5 The officers shall say to the army: "Has anyone built a new house and not dedicated it? Let him go home, or he may die in battle and someone else may dedicate it.
- 6 And is there a man here who has planted a vineyard but hasn't yet enjoyed the grapes? Let him go home right now lest he die in battle and another man enjoy the grapes.
- 6 Has anyone planted a vineyard and not begun to enjoy it? Let him go home, or he may die in battle and someone else enjoy it.
- 7 Is there a man here engaged to marry who hasn't yet taken his wife? Let him go home right now lest he die in battle and another man take her."
- 7 Has anyone become pledged to a woman and not married her? Let him go home, or he may die in battle and someone else marry her."

- 8 The officers will then continue, "And is there a man here who is wavering in resolve and afraid? Let him go home right now so that he doesn't infect his fellows with his timidity and cowardly spirit."
- 8 Then the officers shall add, "Is any man afraid or fainthearted? Let him go home so that his brothers will not become disheartened too."
- 9 When the officers have finished speaking to the troops, let them appoint commanders of the troops who shall muster them by units.
- 9 When the officers have finished speaking to the army, they shall appoint commanders over it.
- 10 When you come up against a city to attack it, call out, "Peace?"
- 10 When you march up to attack a city, make its people an offer of peace.
- 11 If they answer, "Yes, peace!" and open the city to you, then everyone found there will be conscripted as forced laborers and work for you.
- 11 If they accept and open their gates, all the people in it shall be subject to forced labor and shall work for you.
- 12 But if they don't settle for peace and insist on war, then go ahead and attack.
- 12 If they refuse to make peace and they engage you in battle, lay siege to that city.
- 13 GOD, your God, will give them to you. Kill all the men with your swords.
- 13 When the LORD your God delivers it into your hand, put to the sword all the men in it.
- 14 But don't kill the women and children and animals. Everything inside the town you can take as plunder for you to use and eat--GOD, your God, gives it to you.
- 14 As for the women, the children, the livestock and everything else in the city, you may take these as plunder for yourselves. And you may use the plunder the LORD your God gives you from your enemies.
- 15 This is the way you deal with the distant towns, the towns that don't belong to the nations at hand.
- 15 This is how you are to treat all the cities that are at a distance from you and do not belong to the nations nearby.
- 16 But with the towns of the people that GOD, your God, is giving you as an inheritance, it's different: don't leave anyone alive.

- 16 However, in the cities of the nations the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, do not leave alive anything that breathes.
- 17 Consign them to holy destruction: the Hittites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, obeying the command of GOD, your God.
- 17 Completely destroy them--the Hittites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites--as the LORD your God has commanded you.
- 18 This is so there won't be any of them left to teach you to practice the abominations that they engage in with their gods and you end up sinning against GOD, your God.
- 18 Otherwise, they will teach you to follow all the detestable things they do in worshiping their gods, and you will sin against the LORD your God.
- 19 When you mount an attack on a town and the siege goes on a long time, don't start cutting down the trees, swinging your axes against them. Those trees are your future food; don't cut them down. Are trees soldiers who come against you with weapons?
- 19 When you lay siege to a city for a long time, fighting against it to capture it, do not destroy its trees by putting an ax to them, because you can eat their fruit. Do not cut them down. Are the trees of the field people, that you should besiege them?
- 20 The exception can be those trees which don't produce food; you can chop them down and use the timbers to build siege engines against the town that is resisting you until it falls.
- 20 However, you may cut down trees that you know are not fruit trees and use them to build siege works until the city at war with you falls.

Deuteronomy 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 If a dead body is found on the ground, this ground that GOD, your God, has given you, lying out in the open, and no one knows who killed him,
- 1 If a man is found slain, lying in a field in the land the LORD your God is giving you to possess, and it is not known who killed him,

- 2 your leaders and judges are to go out and measure the distance from the body to the nearest cities.
- 2 your elders and judges shall go out and measure the distance from the body to the neighboring towns.
- 3 The leaders and judges of the city that is nearest the corpse will then take a heifer that has never been used for work, never had a yoke on it.
- 3 Then the elders of the town nearest the body shall take a heifer that has never been worked and has never worn a yoke
- 4 The leaders will take the heifer to a valley with a stream, a valley that has never been plowed or planted, and there break the neck of the heifer.
- 4 and lead her down to a valley that has not been plowed or planted and where there is a flowing stream. There in the valley they are to break the heifer's neck.
- 5 The Levitical priests will then step up. GOD has chosen them to serve him in these matters by settling legal disputes and violent crimes and by pronouncing blessings in GOD's name.
- 5 The priests, the sons of Levi, shall step forward, for the LORD your God has chosen them to minister and to pronounce blessings in the name of the LORD and to decide all cases of dispute and assault.
- 6 Finally, all the leaders of that town that is nearest the body will wash their hands over the heifer that had its neck broken at the stream
- 6 Then all the elders of the town nearest the body shall wash their hands over the heifer whose neck was broken in the valley,
- 7 and say, "We didn't kill this man and we didn't see who did it.
- 7 and they shall declare: "Our hands did not shed this blood, nor did our eyes see it done.
- 8 Purify your people Israel whom you redeemed, O GOD. Clear your people Israel from any guilt in this murder." That will clear them from any responsibility in the murder.
- 8 Accept this atonement for your people Israel, whom you have redeemed, O LORD, and do not hold your people guilty of the blood of an innocent man." And the bloodshed will be atoned for.
- 9 By following these procedures you will have absolved yourselves of any part in the murder because you will have done what is right in GOD's sight.

- 9 So you will purge from yourselves the guilt of shedding innocent blood, since you have done what is right in the eyes of the LORD.
- 10 When you go to war against your enemies and GOD, your God, gives you victory and you take prisoners,
- 10 When you go to war against your enemies and the LORD your God delivers them into your hands and you take captives,
- 11 and then you notice among the prisoners of war a good-looking woman whom you find attractive and would like to marry,
- 11 if you notice among the captives a beautiful woman and are attracted to her, you may take her as your wife.
- 12 this is what you do: Take her home; have her trim her hair, cut her nails,
- 12 Bring her into your home and have her shave her head, trim her nails
- 13 and discard the clothes she was wearing when captured. She is then to stay in your home for a full month, mourning her father and mother. Then you may go to bed with her as husband and wife.
- 13 and put aside the clothes she was wearing when captured. After she has lived in your house and mourned her father and mother for a full month, then you may go to her and be her husband and she shall be your wife.
- 14 If it turns out you don't like her, you must let her go and live wherever she wishes. But you can't sell her or use her as a slave since you've humiliated her.
- 14 If you are not pleased with her, let her go wherever she wishes. You must not sell her or treat her as a slave, since you have dishonored her.
- 15 When a man has two wives, one loved and the other hated, and they both give him sons, but the firstborn is from the hated wife,
- 15 If a man has two wives, and he loves one but not the other, and both bear him sons but the firstborn is the son of the wife he does not love,
- 16 at the time he divides the inheritance with his sons he must not treat the son of the loved wife as the firstborn, cutting out the son of the hated wife, who is the actual firstborn.
- 16 when he wills his property to his sons, he must not give the rights of the firstborn to the son of the wife he loves in preference to his actual firstborn, the son of the wife he does not love.
- 17 No, he must acknowledge the inheritance rights of the real firstborn, the son of the hated wife, by giving him a double share of the inheritance:

that son is the first proof of his virility; the rights of the firstborn belong to him.

17 He must acknowledge the son of his unloved wife as the firstborn by giving him a double share of all he has. That son is the first sign of his father's strength. The right of the firstborn belongs to him.

18 When a man has a stubborn son, a real rebel who won't do a thing his mother and father tell him, and even though they discipline him he still won't obey,

18 If a man has a stubborn and rebellious son who does not obey his father and mother and will not listen to them when they discipline him,

19 his father and mother shall forcibly bring him before the leaders at the city gate

19 his father and mother shall take hold of him and bring him to the elders at the gate of his town.

20 and say to the city fathers, "This son of ours is a stubborn rebel; he won't listen to a thing we say. He's a glutton and a drunk."

20 They shall say to the elders, "This son of ours is stubborn and rebellious. He will not obey us. He is a profligate and a drunkard."

21 Then all the men of the town are to throw rocks at him until he's dead. You will have purged the evil pollution from among you. All Israel will hear what's happened and be in awe.

21 Then all the men of his town shall stone him to death. You must purge the evil from among you. All Israel will hear of it and be afraid.

22 When a man has committed a capital crime, been given the death sentence, executed and hung from a tree,

22 If a man guilty of a capital offense is put to death and his body is hung on a tree,

23 don't leave his dead body hanging overnight from the tree. Give him a decent burial that same day so that you don't desecrate your GOD-given land--a hanged man is an insult to God.

23 you must not leave his body on the tree overnight. Be sure to bury him that same day, because anyone who is hung on a tree is under God's curse. You must not desecrate the land the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance.

Deuteronomy 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 If you see your kinsman's ox or sheep wandering off loose, don't look the other way as if you didn't see it. Return it promptly.
- 1 If you see your brother's ox or sheep straying, do not ignore it but be sure to take it back to him.
- 2 If your fellow Israelite is not close by or you don't know whose it is, take the animal home with you and take care of it until your fellow asks about it. Then return it to him.
- 2 If the brother does not live near you or if you do not know who he is, take it home with you and keep it until he comes looking for it. Then give it back to him.
- 3 Do the same if it's his donkey or a piece of clothing or anything else your fellow Israelite loses. Don't look the other way as if you didn't see it.
- 3 Do the same if you find your brother's donkey or his cloak or anything he loses. Do not ignore it.
- 4 If you see your fellow's donkey or ox injured along the road, don't look the other way. Help him get it up and on its way.
- 4 If you see your brother's donkey or his ox fallen on the road, do not ignore it. Help him get it to its feet.
- 5 A woman must not wear a man's clothing, nor a man wear women's clothing. This kind of thing is an abomination to GOD, your God.
- 5 A woman must not wear men's clothing, nor a man wear women's clothing, for the LORD your God detests anyone who does this.
- 6 When you come across a bird's nest alongside the road, whether in a tree or on the ground, and the mother is sitting on the young or on the eggs, don't take the mother with the young.
- 6 If you come across a bird's nest beside the road, either in a tree or on the ground, and the mother is sitting on the young or on the eggs, do not take the mother with the young.
- 7 You may take the babies, but let the mother go so that you will live a good and long life.
- 7 You may take the young, but be sure to let the mother go, so that it may go well with you and you may have a long life.

- 8 When you build a new house, make a parapet around your roof to make it safe so that someone doesn't fall off and die and your family become responsible for the death.
- 8 When you build a new house, make a parapet around your roof so that you may not bring the guilt of bloodshed on your house if someone falls from the roof.
- 9 Don't plant two kinds of seed in your vineyard. If you do, you will forfeit what you've sown, the total production of the vineyard.
- 9 Do not plant two kinds of seed in your vineyard; if you do, not only the crops you plant but also the fruit of the vineyard will be defiled.
- 10 Don't plow with an ox and a donkey yoked together.
- 10 Do not plow with an ox and a donkey yoked together.
- 11 Don't wear clothes of mixed fabrics, wool and linen together.
- 11 Do not wear clothes of wool and linen woven together.
- 12 Make tassels on the four corners of the cloak you use to cover yourself.
- 12 Make tassels on the four corners of the cloak you wear.
- 13 If a man marries a woman, sleeps with her, and then turns on her,
- 13 If a man takes a wife and, after lying with her, dislikes her
- 14 calling her a slut, giving her a bad name, saying, "I married this woman, but when I slept with her I discovered she wasn't a virgin,"
- 14 and slanders her and gives her a bad name, saying, "I married this woman, but when I approached her, I did not find proof of her virginity,"
- 15 then the father and mother of the girl are to take her with the proof of her virginity to the town leaders at the gate.
- 15 then the girl's father and mother shall bring proof that she was a virgin to the town elders at the gate.
- 16 The father is to tell the leaders, "I gave my daughter to this man as wife and he turned on her, rejecting her.
- 16 The girl's father will say to the elders, "I gave my daughter in marriage to this man, but he dislikes her.
- 17 And now he has slanderously accused her, claiming that she wasn't a virgin. But look at this, here is the proof of my daughter's virginity." And then he is to spread out her blood-stained wedding garment before the leaders for their examination.
- 17 Now he has slandered her and said, 'I did not find your daughter to be a virgin.' But here is the proof of my daughter's virginity." Then her

- parents shall display the cloth before the elders of the town,
- 18 The town leaders then are to take the husband, whip him,
- 18 and the elders shall take the man and punish him.
- 19 fine him a hundred pieces of silver, and give it to the father of the girl.
- The man gave a virgin girl of Israel a bad name. He has to keep her as his wife and can never divorce her.
- 19 They shall fine him a hundred shekels of silver and give them to the girl's father, because this man has given an Israelite virgin a bad name. She shall continue to be his wife; he must not divorce her as long as he lives.
- 20 But if it turns out that the accusation is true and there is no evidence of the girl's virginity,
- 20 If, however, the charge is true and no proof of the girl's virginity can be found,
- 21 the men of the town are to take her to the door of her father's house and stone her to death. She acted disgracefully in Israel. She lived like a whore while still in her parents' home. Purge the evil from among you.
- 21 she shall be brought to the door of her father's house and there the men of her town shall stone her to death. She has done a disgraceful thing in Israel by being promiscuous while still in her father's house. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 22 If a man is found sleeping with another man's wife, both must die. Purge that evil from Israel.
- 22 If a man is found sleeping with another man's wife, both the man who slept with her and the woman must die. You must purge the evil from Israel.
- 23 If a man comes upon a virgin in town, a girl who is engaged to another man, and sleeps with her,
- 23 If a man happens to meet in a town a virgin pledged to be married and he sleeps with her,
- 24 take both of them to the town gate and stone them until they die--the girl because she didn't yell out for help in the town and the man because he raped her, violating the fiancée of his neighbor. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 24 you shall take both of them to the gate of that town and stone them to death--the girl because she was in a town and did not scream for help,

- and the man because he violated another man's wife. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 25 But if it was out in the country that the man found the engaged girl and grabbed and raped her, only the man is to die, the man who raped her.
- 25 But if out in the country a man happens to meet a girl pledged to be married and rapes her, only the man who has done this shall die.
- 26 Don't do anything to the girl; she did nothing wrong. This is similar to the case of a man who comes across his neighbor out in the country and murders him;
- 26 Do nothing to the girl; she has committed no sin deserving death. This case is like that of someone who attacks and murders his neighbor,
- 27 when the engaged girl yelled out for help, there was no one around to hear or help her.
- 27 for the man found the girl out in the country, and though the betrothed girl screamed, there was no one to rescue her.
- 28 When a man comes upon a virgin who has never been engaged and grabs and rapes her and they are found out,
- 28 If a man happens to meet a virgin who is not pledged to be married and rapes her and they are discovered,
- 29 the man who raped her has to give her father fifty pieces of silver. He has to marry her because he took advantage of her. And he can never divorce her.
- 29 he shall pay the girl's father fifty shekels of silver. He must marry the girl, for he has violated her. He can never divorce her as long as he lives.
- 30 A man may not marry his father's ex-wife--that would violate his father's rights.
- 30 A man is not to marry his father's wife; he must not dishonor his father's bed.

Deuteronomy 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 No eunuch is to enter the congregation of GOD.
- 1 No one who has been emasculated by crushing or cutting may enter the assembly of the LORD.

- 2 No bastard is to enter the congregation of GOD, even to the tenth generation, nor any of his children.
- 2 No one born of a forbidden marriage nor any of his descendants may enter the assembly of the LORD, even down to the tenth generation.
- 3 No Ammonite or Moabite is to enter the congregation of GOD, even to the tenth generation, nor any of his children, ever.
- 3 No Ammonite or Moabite or any of his descendants may enter the assembly of the LORD, even down to the tenth generation.
- 4 Those nations didn't treat you with hospitality on your travels out of Egypt, and on top of that they also hired Balaam son of Beor from Pethor in Mesopotamia to curse you.
- 4 For they did not come to meet you with bread and water on your way when you came out of Egypt, and they hired Balaam son of Beor from Pethor in Aram Naharaim to pronounce a curse on you.
- 5 GOD, your God, refused to listen to Balaam but turned the curse into a blessing--how GOD, your God, loves you!
- 5 However, the LORD your God would not listen to Balaam but turned the curse into a blessing for you, because the LORD your God loves you.
- 6 Don't even try to get along with them or do anything for them, ever.
- 6 Do not seek a treaty of friendship with them as long as you live.
- 7 But don't spurn an Edomite; he's your kin. And don't spurn an Egyptian; you were a foreigner in his land.
- 7 Do not abhor an Edomite, for he is your brother. Do not abhor an Egyptian, because you lived as an alien in his country.
- 8 Children born to Edomites and Egyptians may enter the congregation of GOD in the third generation.
- 8 The third generation of children born to them may enter the assembly of the LORD.
- 9 When you are camped out, at war with your enemies, be careful to keep yourself from anything ritually defiling.
- 9 When you are encamped against your enemies, keep away from everything impure.
- 10 If one of your men has become ritually unclean because of a nocturnal emission, he must go outside the camp and stay there
- 10 If one of your men is unclean because of a nocturnal emission, he is to go outside the camp and stay there.

- 11 until evening when he can wash himself, returning to the camp at sunset.
- 11 But as evening approaches he is to wash himself, and at sunset he may return to the camp.
- 12 Mark out an area outside the camp where you can go to relieve yourselves.
- 12 Designate a place outside the camp where you can go to relieve yourself.
- 13 Along with your weapons have a stick with you. After you relieve yourself, dig a hole with the stick and cover your excrement.
- 13 As part of your equipment have something to dig with, and when you relieve yourself, dig a hole and cover up your excrement.
- 14 GOD, your God, strolls through your camp; he's present to deliver you and give you victory over your enemies. Keep your camp holy; don't permit anything indecent or offensive in GOD's eyes.
- 14 For the LORD your God moves about in your camp to protect you and to deliver your enemies to you. Your camp must be holy, so that he will not see among you anything indecent and turn away from you.
- 15 Don't return a runaway slave to his master; he's come to you for refuge.
- 15 If a slave has taken refuge with you, do not hand him over to his master.
- 16 Let him live wherever he wishes within the protective gates of your city. Don't take advantage of him.
- 16 Let him live among you wherever he likes and in whatever town he chooses. Do not oppress him.
- 17 No daughter of Israel is to become a sacred prostitute; and no son of Israel is to become a sacred prostitute.
- 17 No Israelite man or woman is to become a shrine prostitute.
- 18 And don't bring the fee of a sacred whore or the earnings of a priest-pimp to the house of GOD, your God, to pay for any vow--they are both an abomination to GOD, your God.
- 18 You must not bring the earnings of a female prostitute or of a male prostitute into the house of the LORD your God to pay any vow, because the LORD your God detests them both.
- 19 Don't charge interest to your kinsmen on any loan: not for money or food or clothing or anything else that could earn interest.

- 19 Do not charge your brother interest, whether on money or food or anything else that may earn interest.
- 20 You may charge foreigners interest, but you may not charge your brothers interest; that way GOD, your God, will bless all the work that you take up and the land that you are entering to possess.
- 20 You may charge a foreigner interest, but not a brother Israelite, so that the LORD your God may bless you in everything you put your hand to in the land you are entering to possess.
- 21 When you make a vow to GOD, your God, don't put off keeping it; GOD, your God, expects you to keep it and if you don't you're guilty.
- 21 If you make a vow to the LORD your God, do not be slow to pay it, for the LORD your God will certainly demand it of you and you will be guilty of sin.
- 22 But if you don't make a vow in the first place, there's no sin.
- 22 But if you refrain from making a vow, you will not be guilty.
- 23 If you say you're going to do something, do it. Keep the vow you willingly vowed to GOD, your God. You promised it, so do it.
- 23 Whatever your lips utter you must be sure to do, because you made your vow freely to the LORD your God with your own mouth.
- 24 When you enter your neighbor's vineyard, you may eat all the grapes you want until you're full, but you may not put any in your bucket or bag.
- 24 If you enter your neighbor's vineyard, you may eat all the grapes you want, but do not put any in your basket.
- 25 And when you walk through the ripe grain of your neighbor, you may pick the heads of grain, but you may not swing your sickle there.
- 25 If you enter your neighbor's grainfield, you may pick kernels with your hands, but you must not put a sickle to his standing grain.

Deuteronomy 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 If a man marries a woman and then it happens that he no longer likes her because he has found something wrong with her, he may give her divorce papers, put them in her hand, and send her off.

- 1 If a man marries a woman who becomes displeasing to him because he finds something indecent about her, and he writes her a certificate of divorce, gives it to her and sends her from his house,
- 2 After she leaves, if she becomes another man's wife
- 2 and if after she leaves his house she becomes the wife of another man,
- 3 and he also comes to hate her and this second husband also gives her divorce papers, puts them in her hand, and sends her off, or if he should die,
- 3 and her second husband dislikes her and writes her a certificate of divorce, gives it to her and sends her from his house, or if he dies,
- 4 then the first husband who divorced her can't marry her again. She has made herself ritually unclean, and her remarriage would be an abomination in the Presence of GOD and defile the land with sin, this land that GOD, your God, is giving you as an inheritance.
- 4 then her first husband, who divorced her, is not allowed to marry her again after she has been defiled. That would be detestable in the eyes of the LORD. Do not bring sin upon the land the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance.
- 5 When a man takes a new wife, he is not to go out with the army or be given any business or work duties. He gets one year off simply to be at home making his wife happy.
- 5 If a man has recently married, he must not be sent to war or have any other duty laid on him. For one year he is to be free to stay at home and bring happiness to the wife he has married.
- 6 Don't seize a handmill or an upper millstone as collateral for a loan. You'd be seizing someone's very life.
- 6 Do not take a pair of millstones--not even the upper one-- as security for a debt, because that would be taking a man's livelihood as security.
- 7 If a man is caught kidnapping one of his kinsmen, someone of the People of Israel, to enslave or sell him, the kidnapper must die. Purge that evil from among you.
- 7 If a man is caught kidnapping one of his brother Israelites and treats him as a slave or sells him, the kidnapper must die. You must purge the evil from among you.
- 8 Warning! If a serious skin disease breaks out, follow exactly the rules set down by the Levitical priests. Follow them precisely as I commanded

them.

- 8 In cases of leprous diseases be very careful to do exactly as the priests, who are Levites, instruct you. You must follow carefully what I have commanded them.
- 9 Don't forget what GOD, your God, did to Miriam on your way out of Egypt.
- 9 Remember what the LORD your God did to Miriam along the way after you came out of Egypt.
- 10 When you make a loan of any kind to your neighbor, don't enter his house to claim his pledge.
- 10 When you make a loan of any kind to your neighbor, do not go into his house to get what he is offering as a pledge.
- 11 Wait outside. Let the man to whom you made the pledge bring the pledge to you outside.
- 11 Stay outside and let the man to whom you are making the loan bring the pledge out to you.
- 12 And if he is destitute, don't use his cloak as a bedroll;
- 12 If the man is poor, do not go to sleep with his pledge in your possession.
- 13 return it to him at nightfall so that he can sleep in his cloak and bless you. In the sight of GOD, your God, that will be viewed as a righteous act.
- 13 Return his cloak to him by sunset so that he may sleep in it. Then he will thank you, and it will be regarded as a righteous act in the sight of the LORD your God.
- 14 Don't abuse a laborer who is destitute and needy, whether he is a fellow Israelite living in your land and in your city.
- 14 Do not take advantage of a hired man who is poor and needy, whether he is a brother Israelite or an alien living in one of your towns.
- 15 Pay him at the end of each workday; he's living from hand to mouth and needs it now. If you hold back his pay, he'll protest to GOD and you'll have sin on your books.
- 15 Pay him his wages each day before sunset, because he is poor and is counting on it. Otherwise he may cry to the LORD against you, and you will be guilty of sin.
- 16 Parents shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their parents. Each person shall be put to death for his own sin.

- 16 Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children put to death for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin.
- 17 Make sure foreigners and orphans get their just rights. Don't take the cloak of a widow as security for a loan.
- 17 Do not deprive the alien or the fatherless of justice, or take the cloak of the widow as a pledge.
- 18 Don't ever forget that you were once slaves in Egypt and GOD, your God, got you out of there. I command you: Do what I'm telling you.
- 18 Remember that you were slaves in Egypt and the LORD your God redeemed you from there. That is why I command you to do this.
- 19 When you harvest your grain and forget a sheaf back in the field, don't go back and get it; leave it for the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow so that GOD, your God, will bless you in all your work.
- 19 When you are harvesting in your field and you overlook a sheaf, do not go back to get it. Leave it for the alien, the fatherless and the widow, so that the LORD your God may bless you in all the work of your hands.
- 20 When you shake the olives off your trees, don't go back over the branches and strip them bare--what's left is for the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow.
- 20 When you beat the olives from your trees, do not go over the branches a second time. Leave what remains for the alien, the fatherless and the widow.
- 21 And when you cut the grapes in your vineyard, don't take every last grape--leave a few for the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow.
- 21 When you harvest the grapes in your vineyard, do not go over the vines again. Leave what remains for the alien, the fatherless and the widow.
- 22 Don't ever forget that you were a slave in Egypt. I command you: Do what I'm telling you.
- 22 Remember that you were slaves in Egypt. That is why I command you to do this.

Deuteronomy 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 When men have a legal dispute, let them go to court; the judges will decide between them, declaring one innocent and the other guilty.
- 1 When men have a dispute, they are to take it to court and the judges will decide the case, acquitting the innocent and condemning the guilty.
- 2 If the guilty one deserves punishment, the judge will have him prostrate himself before him and lashed as many times as his crime deserves,
- 2 If the guilty man deserves to be beaten, the judge shall make him lie down and have him flogged in his presence with the number of lashes his crime deserves,
- 3 but not more than forty. If you hit him more than forty times, you will degrade him to something less than human.
- 3 but he must not give him more than forty lashes. If he is flogged more than that, your brother will be degraded in your eyes.
- 4 Don't muzzle an ox while it is threshing.
- 4 Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain.
- 5 When brothers are living together and one of them dies without having had a son, the widow of the dead brother shall not marry a stranger from outside the family; her husband's brother is to come to her and marry her and do the brother-in-law's duty by her.
- 5 If brothers are living together and one of them dies without a son, his widow must not marry outside the family. Her husband's brother shall take her and marry her and fulfill the duty of a brother-in-law to her.
- 6 The first son that she bears shall be named after her dead husband so his name won't die out in Israel.
- 6 The first son she bears shall carry on the name of the dead brother so that his name will not be blotted out from Israel.
- 7 But if the brother doesn't want to marry his sister-in-law, she is to go to the leaders at the city gate and say, "My brother-in-law refuses to keep his brother's name alive in Israel; he won't agree to do the brother-in-law's duty by me."
- 7 However, if a man does not want to marry his brother's wife, she shall go to the elders at the town gate and say, "My husband's brother refuses to carry on his brother's name in Israel. He will not fulfill the duty of a brother-in-law to me."
- 8 Then the leaders will call for the brother and confront him. If he stands there defiant and says, "I don't want her,"

- 8 Then the elders of his town shall summon him and talk to him. If he persists in saying, "I do not want to marry her,"
- 9 his sister-in-law is to pull his sandal off his foot, spit in his face, and say, "This is what happens to the man who refuses to build up the family of his brother--
- 9 his brother's widow shall go up to him in the presence of the elders, take off one of his sandals, spit in his face and say, "This is what is done to the man who will not build up his brother's family line."
- 10 his name in Israel will be Family-No-Sandal."
- 10 That man's line shall be known in Israel as The Family of the Unsandaled.
- 11 When two men are in a fight and the wife of the one man, trying to rescue her husband, grabs the genitals of the man hitting him,
- 11 If two men are fighting and the wife of one of them comes to rescue her husband from his assailant, and she reaches out and seizes him by his private parts,
- 12 you are to cut off her hand. Show no pity.
- 12 you shall cut off her hand. Show her no pity.
- 13 Don't carry around with you two weights, one heavy and the other light,
- 13 Do not have two differing weights in your bag--one heavy, one light.
- 14 and don't keep two measures at hand, one large and the other small.
- 14 Do not have two differing measures in your house--one large, one small.
- 15 Use only one weight, a true and honest weight, and one measure, a true and honest measure, so that you will live a long time on the land that GOD, your God, is giving you.
- 15 You must have accurate and honest weights and measures, so that you may live long in the land the LORD your God is giving you.
- 16 Dishonest weights and measures are an abomination to GOD, your God--all this corruption in business deals!
- 16 For the LORD your God detests anyone who does these things, anyone who deals dishonestly.
- 17 Don't forget what Amalek did to you on the road after you left Egypt,
- 17 Remember what the Amalekites did to you along the way when you came out of Egypt.
- 18 how he attacked you when you were tired, barely able to put one foot in front of another, mercilessly cut off your stragglers, and had no regard

for God.

18 When you were weary and worn out, they met you on your journey and cut off all who were lagging behind; they had no fear of God.

19 When GOD, your God, gives you rest from all the enemies that surround you in the inheritance-land GOD, your God, is giving you to possess, you are to wipe the name of Amalek from off the Earth. Don't forget!

19 When the LORD your God gives you rest from all the enemies around you in the land he is giving you to possess as an inheritance, you shall blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven. Do not forget!

Deuteronomy 26

MSG

NIV

1 Once you enter the land that GOD, your God, is giving you as an inheritance and take it over and settle down,

1 When you have entered the land the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance and have taken possession of it and settled in it,

2 you are to take some of all the firstfruits of what you grow in the land that GOD, your God, is giving you, put them in a basket and go to the place GOD, your God, sets apart for you to worship him.

2 take some of the firstfruits of all that you produce from the soil of the land the LORD your God is giving you and put them in a basket. Then go to the place the LORD your God will choose as a dwelling for his Name

3 At that time, go to the priest who is there and say, "I announce to GOD, your God, today that I have entered the land that GOD promised our ancestors that he'd give to us."

3 and say to the priest in office at the time, "I declare today to the LORD your God that I have come to the land the LORD swore to our forefathers to give us."

4 The priest will take the basket from you and place it on the Altar of GOD, your God.

4 The priest shall take the basket from your hands and set it down in front of the altar of the LORD your God.

- 5 And there in the Presence of GOD, your God, you will recite, A wandering Aramean was my father, he went down to Egypt and sojourned there, he and just a handful of his brothers at first, but soon they became a great nation, mighty and many.
- 5 Then you shall declare before the LORD your God: "My father was a wandering Aramean, and he went down into Egypt with a few people and lived there and became a great nation, powerful and numerous.
- 6 The Egyptians abused and battered us, in a cruel and savage slavery.
- 6 But the Egyptians mistreated us and made us suffer, putting us to hard labor.
- 7 We cried out to GOD, the God-of-Our-Fathers: He listened to our voice, he saw our destitution, our trouble, our cruel plight.
- 7 Then we cried out to the LORD, the God of our fathers, and the LORD heard our voice and saw our misery, toil and oppression.
- 8 And GOD took us out of Egypt with his strong hand and long arm, terrible and great, with signs and miracle-wonders.
- 8 So the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm, with great terror and with miraculous signs and wonders.
- 9 And he brought us to this place, gave us this land flowing with milk and honey.
- 9 He brought us to this place and gave us this land, a land flowing with milk and honey;
- 10 So here I am. I've brought the firstfruits of what I've grown on this ground you gave me, O GOD. Then place it in the Presence of GOD, your God. Prostrate yourselves in the Presence of GOD, your God.
- 10 and now I bring the firstfruits of the soil that you, O LORD, have given me." Place the basket before the LORD your God and bow down before him.
- 11 And rejoice! Celebrate all the good things that GOD, your God, has given you and your family; you and the Levite and the foreigner who lives with you.
- 11 And you and the Levites and the aliens among you shall rejoice in all the good things the LORD your God has given to you and your household.

- 12 Every third year, the year of the tithe, give a tenth of your produce to the Levite, the foreigner, the orphan, and the widow so that they may eat their fill in your cities.
- 12 When you have finished setting aside a tenth of all your produce in the third year, the year of the tithe, you shall give it to the Levite, the alien, the fatherless and the widow, so that they may eat in your towns and be satisfied.
- 13 And then, in the Presence of GOD, your God, say this: I have brought the sacred share, I've given it to the Levite, foreigner, orphan, and widow. What you commanded, I've done. I haven't detoured around your commands, I haven't forgotten a single one.
- 13 Then say to the LORD your God: "I have removed from my house the sacred portion and have given it to the Levite, the alien, the fatherless and the widow, according to all you commanded. I have not turned aside from your commands nor have I forgotten any of them.
- 14 I haven't eaten from the sacred share while mourning, I haven't removed any of it while ritually unclean, I haven't used it in funeral feasts. I have listened obediently to the Voice of GOD, my God, I have lived the way you commanded me.
- 14 I have not eaten any of the sacred portion while I was in mourning, nor have I removed any of it while I was unclean, nor have I offered any of it to the dead. I have obeyed the LORD my God; I have done everything you commanded me.
- 15 Look down from your holy house in Heaven! Bless your people Israel and the ground you gave us, just as you promised our ancestors you would, this land flowing with milk and honey.
- 15 Look down from heaven, your holy dwelling place, and bless your people Israel and the land you have given us as you promised on oath to our forefathers, a land flowing with milk and honey."
- 16 This very day GOD, your God, commands you to follow these rules and regulations, to live them out with everything you have in you.
- 16 The LORD your God commands you this day to follow these decrees and laws; carefully observe them with all your heart and with all your soul.

- 17 You've renewed your vows today that GOD is your God, that you'll live the way he shows you; do what he tells you in the rules, regulations, and commandments; and listen obediently to him.
- 17 You have declared this day that the LORD is your God and that you will walk in his ways, that you will keep his decrees, commands and laws, and that you will obey him.
- 18 And today GOD has reaffirmed that you are dearly held treasure just as he promised, a people entrusted with keeping his commandments,
- 18 And the LORD has declared this day that you are his people, his treasured possession as he promised, and that you are to keep all his commands.
- 19 a people set high above all other nations that he's made, high in praise, fame, and honor: you're a people holy to GOD, your God. That's what he has promised.
- 19 He has declared that he will set you in praise, fame and honor high above all the nations he has made and that you will be a people holy to the LORD your God, as he promised.

Deuteronomy 27

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses commanded the leaders of Israel and charged the people: Keep every commandment that I command you today.
- 1 Moses and the elders of Israel commanded the people: "Keep all these commands that I give you today.
- 2 On the day you cross the Jordan into the land that GOD, your God, is giving you, erect large stones and coat them with plaster.
- 2 When you have crossed the Jordan into the land the LORD your God is giving you, set up some large stones and coat them with plaster.
- 3 As soon as you cross over the river, write on the stones all the words of this Revelation so that you'll enter the land that GOD, your God, is giving you, that land flowing with milk and honey that GOD, the God-of-Your-Fathers, promised you.
- 3 Write on them all the words of this law when you have crossed over to enter the land the LORD your God is giving you, a land flowing with

milk and honey, just as the LORD, the God of your fathers, promised you.

- 4 So when you've crossed the Jordan, erect these stones on Mount Ebal. Then coat them with plaster.
- 4 And when you have crossed the Jordan, set up these stones on Mount Ebal, as I command you today, and coat them with plaster.
- 5 Build an Altar of stones for GOD, your God, there on the mountain. Don't use an iron tool on the stones;
- 5 Build there an altar to the LORD your God, an altar of stones. Do not use any iron tool upon them.
- 6 build the Altar to GOD, your God, with uncut stones and offer your Whole-Burnt-Offerings on it to GOD, your God.
- 6 Build the altar of the LORD your God with fieldstones and offer burnt offerings on it to the LORD your God.
- 7 When you sacrifice your Peace-Offerings you will also eat them there, rejoicing in the Presence of GOD, your God.
- 7 Sacrifice fellowship offerings there, eating them and rejoicing in the presence of the LORD your God.
- 8 Write all the words of this Revelation on the stones. Incise them sharply.
- 8 And you shall write very clearly all the words of this law on these stones you have set up."
- 9 Moses and the Levitical priests addressed all Israel: Quiet. Listen obediently, Israel. This very day you have become the people of GOD, your God.
- 9 Then Moses and the priests, who are Levites, said to all Israel, "Be silent, O Israel, and listen! You have now become the people of the LORD your God.
- 10 Listen to the Voice of GOD, your God. Keep his commandments and regulations that I'm commanding you today.
- 10 Obey the LORD your God and follow his commands and decrees that I give you today."
- 11 That day Moses commanded:
- 11 On the same day Moses commanded the people:
- 12 After you've crossed the Jordan, these tribes will stand on Mount Gerizim to bless the people: Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Joseph, and Benjamin.

- 12 When you have crossed the Jordan, these tribes shall stand on Mount Gerizim to bless the people: Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Joseph and Benjamin.
- 13 And these will stand on Mount Ebal for the curse: Reuben, Gad, Asher, Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali.
- 13 And these tribes shall stand on Mount Ebal to pronounce curses: Reuben, Gad, Asher, Zebulun, Dan and Naphtali.
- 14 The Levites, acting as spokesmen and speaking loudly, will address Israel:
- 14 The Levites shall recite to all the people of Israel in a loud voice:
- 15 GOD's curse on anyone who carves or casts a god-image--an abomination to GOD made by a craftsman--and sets it up in secret. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 15 Cursed is the man who carves an image or casts an idol-- a thing detestable to the LORD, the work of the craftsman's hands-- and sets it up in secret. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 16 GOD's curse on anyone who demeans a parent. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 16 Cursed is the man who dishonors his father or his mother. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 17 GOD's curse on anyone who moves his neighbor's boundary marker. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 17 Cursed is the man who moves his neighbor's boundary stone. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 18 GOD's curse on anyone who misdirects a blind man on the road. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 18 Cursed is the man who leads the blind astray on the road. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 19 GOD's curse on anyone who interferes with justice due the foreigner, orphan, or widow. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 19 Cursed is the man who withholds justice from the alien, the fatherless or the widow. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 20 GOD's curse on anyone who has sex with his father's wife; he has violated the woman who belongs to his father. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.

- 20 Cursed is the man who sleeps with his father's wife, for he dishonors his father's bed. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 21 GOD's curse on anyone who has sex with an animal. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 21 Cursed is the man who has sexual relations with any animal. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 22 GOD's curse on anyone who has sex with his sister, the daughter of his father or mother. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 22 Cursed is the man who sleeps with his sister, the daughter of his father or the daughter of his mother. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 23 GOD's curse on anyone who has sex with his mother-in-law. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 23 Cursed is the man who sleeps with his mother-in-law. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 24 GOD's curse on anyone who kills his neighbor in secret. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 24 Cursed is the man who kills his neighbor secretly. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 25 GOD's curse on anyone who takes a bribe to kill an innocent person. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 25 Cursed is the man who accepts a bribe to kill an innocent person. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"
- 26 GOD's curse on whoever does not give substance to the words of this Revelation by living them. All respond: Yes. Absolutely.
- 26 Cursed is the man who does not uphold the words of this law by carrying them out. Then all the people shall say, "Amen!"

Deuteronomy 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 If you listen obediently to the Voice of GOD, your God, and heartily obey all his commandments that I command you today, GOD, your God, will place you on high, high above all the nations of the world.
- 1 If you fully obey the LORD your God and carefully follow all his commands I give you today, the LORD your God will set you high

above all the nations on earth.

- 2 All these blessings will come down on you and spread out beyond you because you have responded to the Voice of GOD, your God:
- 2 All these blessings will come upon you and accompany you if you obey the LORD your God:
- 3 GOD's blessing inside the city, GOD's blessing in the country;
- 3 You will be blessed in the city and blessed in the country.
- 4 GOD's blessing on your children, the crops of your land, the young of your livestock, the calves of your herds, the lambs of your flocks.
- 4 The fruit of your womb will be blessed, and the crops of your land and the young of your livestock--the calves of your herds and the lambs of your flocks.
- 5 GOD's blessing on your basket and bread bowl;
- 5 Your basket and your kneading trough will be blessed.
- 6 GOD's blessing in your coming in, GOD's blessing in your going out.
- 6 You will be blessed when you come in and blessed when you go out.
- 7 GOD will defeat your enemies who attack you. They'll come at you on one road and run away on seven roads.
- 7 The LORD will grant that the enemies who rise up against you will be defeated before you. They will come at you from one direction but flee from you in seven.
- 8 GOD will order a blessing on your barns and workplaces; he'll bless you in the land that GOD, your God, is giving you.
- 8 The LORD will send a blessing on your barns and on everything you put your hand to. The LORD your God will bless you in the land he is giving you.
- 9 GOD will form you as a people holy to him, just as he promised you, if you keep the commandments of GOD, your God, and live the way he has shown you.
- 9 The LORD will establish you as his holy people, as he promised you on oath, if you keep the commands of the LORD your God and walk in his ways.
- 10 All the peoples on Earth will see you living under the Name of GOD and hold you in respectful awe.
- 10 Then all the peoples on earth will see that you are called by the name of the LORD, and they will fear you.

- 11 GOD will lavish you with good things: children from your womb, offspring from your animals, and crops from your land, the land that GOD promised your ancestors that he would give you.
- 11 The LORD will grant you abundant prosperity--in the fruit of your womb, the young of your livestock and the crops of your ground--in the land he swore to your forefathers to give you.
- 12 GOD will throw open the doors of his sky vaults and pour rain on your land on schedule and bless the work you take in hand. You will lend to many nations but you yourself won't have to take out a loan.
- 12 The LORD will open the heavens, the storehouse of his bounty, to send rain on your land in season and to bless all the work of your hands. You will lend to many nations but will borrow from none.
- 13 GOD will make you the head, not the tail; you'll always be the top dog, never the bottom dog, as you obediently listen to and diligently keep the commands of GOD, your God, that I am commanding you today.
- 13 The LORD will make you the head, not the tail. If you pay attention to the commands of the LORD your God that I give you this day and carefully follow them, you will always be at the top, never at the bottom.
- 14 Don't swerve an inch to the right or left from the words that I command you today by going off following and worshiping other gods.
- 14 Do not turn aside from any of the commands I give you today, to the right or to the left, following other gods and serving them.
- 15 Here's what will happen if you don't obediently listen to the Voice of GOD, your God, and diligently keep all the commandments and guidelines that I'm commanding you today. All these curses will come down hard on you:
- 15 However, if you do not obey the LORD your God and do not carefully follow all his commands and decrees I am giving you today, all these curses will come upon you and overtake you:
- 16 GOD's curse in the city, GOD's curse in the country;
- 16 You will be cursed in the city and cursed in the country.
- 17 GOD's curse on your basket and bread bowl;
- 17 Your basket and your kneading trough will be cursed.
- 18 GOD's curse on your children, the crops of your land, the young of your livestock, the calves of your herds, the lambs of your flocks.

- 18 The fruit of your womb will be cursed, and the crops of your land, and the calves of your herds and the lambs of your flocks.
- 19 GOD's curse in your coming in, GOD's curse in your going out.
- 19 You will be cursed when you come in and cursed when you go out.
- 20 GOD will send The Curse, The Confusion, The Contrariness down on everything you try to do until you've been destroyed and there's nothing left of you--all because of your evil pursuits that led you to abandon me.
- 20 The LORD will send on you curses, confusion and rebuke in everything you put your hand to, until you are destroyed and come to sudden ruin because of the evil you have done in forsaking him.
- 21 GOD will infect you with The Disease, wiping you right off the land that you're going in to possess.
- 21 The LORD will plague you with diseases until he has destroyed you from the land you are entering to possess.
- 22 GOD will set consumption and fever and rash and seizures and dehydration and blight and jaundice on you. They'll hunt you down until they kill you.
- 22 The LORD will strike you with wasting disease, with fever and inflammation, with scorching heat and drought, with blight and mildew, which will plague you until you perish.
- 23 The sky over your head will become an iron roof, the ground under your feet, a slab of concrete.
- 23 The sky over your head will be bronze, the ground beneath you iron.
- 24 From out of the skies GOD will rain ash and dust down on you until you suffocate.
- 24 The LORD will turn the rain of your country into dust and powder; it will come down from the skies until you are destroyed.
- 25 GOD will defeat you by enemy attack. You'll come at your enemies on one road and run away on seven roads. All the kingdoms of Earth will see you as a horror.
- 25 The LORD will cause you to be defeated before your enemies. You will come at them from one direction but flee from them in seven, and you will become a thing of horror to all the kingdoms on earth.
- 26 Carrion birds and animals will boldly feast on your dead body with no one to chase them away.

- 26 Your carcasses will be food for all the birds of the air and the beasts of the earth, and there will be no one to frighten them away.
- 27 GOD will hit you hard with the boils of Egypt, hemorrhoids, scabs, and an incurable itch.
- 27 The LORD will afflict you with the boils of Egypt and with tumors, festering sores and the itch, from which you cannot be cured.
- 28 He'll make you go crazy and blind and senile.
- 28 The LORD will afflict you with madness, blindness and confusion of mind.
- 29 You'll grope around in the middle of the day like a blind person feeling his way through a lifetime of darkness; you'll never get to where you're going. Not a day will go by that you're not abused and robbed. And no one is going to help you.
- 29 At midday you will grope about like a blind man in the dark. You will be unsuccessful in everything you do; day after day you will be oppressed and robbed, with no one to rescue you.
- 30 You'll get engaged to a woman and another man will take her for his mistress; you'll build a house and never live in it; you'll plant a garden and never eat so much as a carrot;
- 30 You will be pledged to be married to a woman, but another will take her and ravish her. You will build a house, but you will not live in it. You will plant a vineyard, but you will not even begin to enjoy its fruit.
- 31 you'll watch your ox get butchered and not get a single steak from it; your donkey will be stolen from in front of you and you'll never see it again; your sheep will be sent off to your enemies and no one will lift a hand to help you.
- 31 Your ox will be slaughtered before your eyes, but you will eat none of it. Your donkey will be forcibly taken from you and will not be returned. Your sheep will be given to your enemies, and no one will rescue them.
- 32 Your sons and daughters will be shipped off to foreigners; you'll wear your eyes out looking vainly for them, helpless to do a thing.
- 32 Your sons and daughters will be given to another nation, and you will wear out your eyes watching for them day after day, powerless to lift a hand.
- 33 Your crops and everything you work for will be eaten and used by foreigners; you'll spend the rest of your lives abused and knocked

around.

- 33 A people that you do not know will eat what your land and labor produce, and you will have nothing but cruel oppression all your days.
- 34 What you see will drive you crazy.
- 34 The sights you see will drive you mad.
- 35 GOD will hit you with painful boils on your knees and legs and no healing or relief from head to foot.
- 35 The LORD will afflict your knees and legs with painful boils that cannot be cured, spreading from the soles of your feet to the top of your head.
- 36 GOD will lead you and the king you set over you to a country neither you nor your ancestors have heard of; there you'll worship other gods, no-gods of wood and stone.
- 36 The LORD will drive you and the king you set over you to a nation unknown to you or your fathers. There you will worship other gods, gods of wood and stone.
- 37 Among all the peoples where GOD will take you, you'll be treated as a lesson or a proverb--a horror!
- 37 You will become a thing of horror and an object of scorn and ridicule to all the nations where the LORD will drive you.
- 38 You'll plant sacks and sacks of seed in the field but get almost nothing--the grasshoppers will devour it.
- 38 You will sow much seed in the field but you will harvest little, because locusts will devour it.
- 39 You'll plant and hoe and prune vineyards but won't drink or put up any wine--the worms will devour them.
- 39 You will plant vineyards and cultivate them but you will not drink the wine or gather the grapes, because worms will eat them.
- 40 You'll have groves of olive trees everywhere, but you'll have no oil to rub on your face or hands--the olives will have fallen off.
- 40 You will have olive trees throughout your country but you will not use the oil, because the olives will drop off.
- 41 You'll have sons and daughters but they won't be yours for long--they'll go off to captivity.
- 41 You will have sons and daughters but you will not keep them, because they will go into captivity.

- 42 Locusts will take over all your trees and crops.
- 42 Swarms of locusts will take over all your trees and the crops of your land.
- 43 The foreigner who lives among you will climb the ladder, higher and higher, while you go deeper and deeper into the hole.
- 43 The alien who lives among you will rise above you higher and higher, but you will sink lower and lower.
- 44 He'll lend to you; you won't lend to him. He'll be the head; you'll be the tail.
- 44 He will lend to you, but you will not lend to him. He will be the head, but you will be the tail.
- 45 All these curses are going to come on you. They're going to hunt you down and get you until there's nothing left of you because you didn't obediently listen to the Voice of GOD, your God, and diligently keep his commandments and guidelines that I commanded you.
- 45 All these curses will come upon you. They will pursue you and overtake you until you are destroyed, because you did not obey the LORD your God and observe the commands and decrees he gave you.
- 46 The curses will serve as signposts, warnings to your children ever after.
- 46 They will be a sign and a wonder to you and your descendants forever.
- 47 Because you didn't serve GOD, your God, out of the joy and goodness of your heart in the great abundance,
- 47 Because you did not serve the LORD your God joyfully and gladly in the time of prosperity,
- 48 you'll have to serve your enemies whom GOD will send against you. Life will be famine and drought, rags and wretchedness; then he'll put an iron yoke on your neck until he's destroyed you.
- 48 therefore in hunger and thirst, in nakedness and dire poverty, you will serve the enemies the LORD sends against you. He will put an iron yoke on your neck until he has destroyed you.
- 49 Yes, GOD will raise up a faraway nation against you, swooping down on you like an eagle, a nation whose language you can't understand,
- 49 The LORD will bring a nation against you from far away, from the ends of the earth, like an eagle swooping down, a nation whose language you will not understand,
- 50 a mean-faced people, cruel to grandmothers and babies alike.

50 a fierce-looking nation without respect for the old or pity for the young.
51 They'll ravage the young of your animals and the crops from your fields until you're destroyed. They'll leave nothing behind: no grain, no wine, no oil, no calves, no lambs--and finally, no you.
51 They will devour the young of your livestock and the crops of your land until you are destroyed. They will leave you no grain, new wine or oil, nor any calves of your herds or lambs of your flocks until you are ruined.
52 They'll lay siege to you while you're huddled behind your town gates. They'll knock those high, proud walls flat, those walls behind which you felt so safe. They'll lay siege to your fortified cities all over the country, this country that GOD, your God, has given you.
52 They will lay siege to all the cities throughout your land until the high fortified walls in which you trust fall down. They will besiege all the cities throughout the land the LORD your God is giving you.
53 And you'll end up cannibalizing your own sons and daughters that GOD, your God, has given you. When the suffering from the siege gets extreme, you're going to eat your own babies.
53 Because of the suffering that your enemy will inflict on you during the siege, you will eat the fruit of the womb, the flesh of the sons and daughters the LORD your God has given you.
54 The most gentle and caring man among you will turn hard, his eye evil, against his own brother, his cherished wife, and even the rest of his children who are still alive,
54 Even the most gentle and sensitive man among you will have no compassion on his own brother or the wife he loves or his surviving children,
55 refusing to share with them a scrap of meat from the cannibal child-stew he is eating. He's lost everything, even his humanity, in the suffering of the siege that your enemy mounts against your fortified towns.
55 and he will not give to one of them any of the flesh of his children that he is eating. It will be all he has left because of the suffering your enemy will inflict on you during the siege of all your cities.
56 And the most gentle and caring woman among you, a woman who wouldn't step on a wildflower, will turn hard, her eye evil, against her cherished husband, against her son, against her daughter,

56 The most gentle and sensitive woman among you--so sensitive and gentle that she would not venture to touch the ground with the sole of her foot--will begrudge the husband she loves and her own son or daughter
57 against even the afterbirth of her newborn infants; she plans to eat them in secret--she does eat them!--because she has lost everything, even her humanity, in the suffering of the siege that your enemy mounts against your fortified towns.
57 the afterbirth from her womb and the children she bears. For she intends to eat them secretly during the siege and in the distress that your enemy will inflict on you in your cities.
58 If you don't diligently keep all the words of this Revelation written in this book, living in holy awe before This Name glorious and terrible, GOD, your God,
58 If you do not carefully follow all the words of this law, which are written in this book, and do not revere this glorious and awesome name--the LORD your God--
59 then GOD will pound you with catastrophes, you and your children, huge interminable catastrophes, hideous interminable illnesses.
59 the LORD will send fearful plagues on you and your descendants, harsh and prolonged disasters, and severe and lingering illnesses.
60 He'll bring back and stick you with every old Egyptian malady that once terrorized you.
60 He will bring upon you all the diseases of Egypt that you dreaded, and they will cling to you.
61 And yes, every disease and catastrophe imaginable--things not even written in the Book of this Revelation--GOD will bring on you until you're destroyed.
61 The LORD will also bring on you every kind of sickness and disaster not recorded in this Book of the Law, until you are destroyed.
62 Because you didn't listen obediently to the Voice of GOD, your God, you'll be left with a few pitiful stragglers in place of the dazzling stars-in-the-heavens multitude you had become.
62 You who were as numerous as the stars in the sky will be left but few in number, because you did not obey the LORD your God.
63 And this is how things will end up: Just as GOD once enjoyed you, took pleasure in making life good for you, giving you many children, so GOD

- will enjoy getting rid of you, clearing you off the Earth. He'll weed you out of the very soil that you are entering in to possess.
- 63 Just as it pleased the LORD to make you prosper and increase in number, so it will please him to ruin and destroy you. You will be uprooted from the land you are entering to possess.
- 64 He'll scatter you to the four winds, from one end of the Earth to the other. You'll worship all kinds of other gods, gods neither you nor your parents ever heard of, wood and stone no-gods.
- 64 Then the LORD will scatter you among all nations, from one end of the earth to the other. There you will worship other gods-- gods of wood and stone, which neither you nor your fathers have known.
- 65 But you won't find a home there, you'll not be able to settle down. GOD will give you a restless heart, longing eyes, a homesick soul.
- 65 Among those nations you will find no repose, no resting place for the sole of your foot. There the LORD will give you an anxious mind, eyes weary with longing, and a despairing heart.
- 66 You will live in constant jeopardy, terrified of every shadow, never knowing what you'll meet around the next corner.
- 66 You will live in constant suspense, filled with dread both night and day, never sure of your life.
- 67 In the morning you'll say, "I wish it were evening." In the evening you'll say, "I wish it were morning." Afraid, terrorized at what's coming next, afraid of the unknown, because of the sights you've witnessed.
- 67 In the morning you will say, "If only it were evening!" and in the evening, "If only it were morning!"--because of the terror that will fill your hearts and the sights that your eyes will see.
- 68 GOD will ship you back to Egypt by a road I promised you'd never see again. There you'll offer yourselves for sale, both men and women, as slaves to your enemies. And not a buyer to be found.
- 68 The LORD will send you back in ships to Egypt on a journey I said you should never make again. There you will offer yourselves for sale to your enemies as male and female slaves, but no one will buy you.

Deuteronomy 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the terms of the Covenant that GOD commanded Moses to make with the People of Israel in the land of Moab, renewing the Covenant he made with them at Horeb.
- 1 These are the terms of the covenant the LORD commanded Moses to make with the Israelites in Moab, in addition to the covenant he had made with them at Horeb.
- 2 Moses called all Israel together and said, You've seen with your own eyes everything that GOD did in Egypt to Pharaoh and his servants, and to the land itself--
- 2 Moses summoned all the Israelites and said to them: Your eyes have seen all that the LORD did in Egypt to Pharaoh, to all his officials and to all his land.
- 3 the massive trials to which you were eyewitnesses, the great signs and miracle-wonders.
- 3 With your own eyes you saw those great trials, those miraculous signs and great wonders.
- 4 But GOD didn't give you an understanding heart or perceptive eyes or attentive ears until right now, this very day.
- 4 But to this day the LORD has not given you a mind that understands or eyes that see or ears that hear.
- 5 I took you through the wilderness for forty years and through all that time the clothes on your backs didn't wear out, the sandals on your feet didn't wear out,
- 5 During the forty years that I led you through the desert, your clothes did not wear out, nor did the sandals on your feet.
- 6 and you lived well without bread and wine and beer, proving to you that I am in fact GOD, your God.
- 6 You ate no bread and drank no wine or other fermented drink. I did this so that you might know that I am the LORD your God.
- 7 When you arrived here in this place, Sihon king of Heshbon and Og king of Bashan met us primed for war but we beat them.
- 7 When you reached this place, Sihon king of Heshbon and Og king of Bashan came out to fight against us, but we defeated them.
- 8 We took their land and gave it as an inheritance to the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh.

- 8 We took their land and gave it as an inheritance to the Reubenites, the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- 9 Diligently keep the words of this Covenant. Do what they say so that you will live well and wisely in every detail.
- 9 Carefully follow the terms of this covenant, so that you may prosper in everything you do.
- 10 You are all standing here today in the Presence of GOD, your God--the heads of your tribes, your leaders, your officials, all Israel:
- 10 All of you are standing today in the presence of the LORD your God--your leaders and chief men, your elders and officials, and all the other men of Israel,
- 11 your babies, your wives, the resident foreigners in your camps who fetch your firewood and water--
- 11 together with your children and your wives, and the aliens living in your camps who chop your wood and carry your water.
- 12 ready to cross over into the solemnly sworn Covenant that GOD, your God, is making with you today,
- 12 You are standing here in order to enter into a covenant with the LORD your God, a covenant the LORD is making with you this day and sealing with an oath,
- 13 the Covenant that this day confirms that you are his people and he is GOD, your God, just as he promised you and your ancestors Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.
- 13 to confirm you this day as his people, that he may be your God as he promised you and as he swore to your fathers, Abraham, Isaac and Jacob.
- 14 I'm not making this Covenant and its oath with you alone.
- 14 I am making this covenant, with its oath, not only with you
- 15 I am making it with you who are standing here today in the Presence of GOD, our God, yes, but also with those who are not here today.
- 15 who are standing here with us today in the presence of the LORD our God but also with those who are not here today.
- 16 You know the conditions in which we lived in Egypt and how we crisscrossed through nations in our travels.
- 16 You yourselves know how we lived in Egypt and how we passed through the countries on the way here.

- 17 You got an eyeful of their obscenities, their wood and stone, silver and gold junk-gods.
- 17 You saw among them their detestable images and idols of wood and stone, of silver and gold.
- 18 Don't let down your guard lest even now, today, someone--man or woman, clan or tribe--gets sidetracked from GOD, our God, and gets involved with the no-gods of the nations; lest some poisonous weed sprout and spread among you,
- 18 Make sure there is no man or woman, clan or tribe among you today whose heart turns away from the LORD our God to go and worship the gods of those nations; make sure there is no root among you that produces such bitter poison.
- 19 a person who hears the words of the Covenant-oath but exempts himself, thinking, "I'll live just the way I please, thank you," and ends up ruining life for everybody.
- 19 When such a person hears the words of this oath, he invokes a blessing on himself and therefore thinks, "I will be safe, even though I persist in going my own way." This will bring disaster on the watered land as well as the dry.
- 20 GOD won't let him off the hook. GOD's anger and jealousy will erupt like a volcano against that person. The curses written in this book will bury him. GOD will delete his name from the records.
- 20 The LORD will never be willing to forgive him; his wrath and zeal will burn against that man. All the curses written in this book will fall upon him, and the LORD will blot out his name from under heaven.
- 21 GOD will separate him out from all the tribes of Israel for special punishment, according to all the curses of the Covenant written in this Book of Revelation.
- 21 The LORD will single him out from all the tribes of Israel for disaster, according to all the curses of the covenant written in this Book of the Law.
- 22 The next generation, your children who come after you and the foreigner who comes from a far country, will be appalled when they see the widespread devastation, how GOD made the whole land sick.
- 22 Your children who follow you in later generations and foreigners who come from distant lands will see the calamities that have fallen on the

- land and the diseases with which the LORD has afflicted it.
- 23 They'll see a fire-blackened wasteland of brimstone and salt flats, nothing planted, nothing growing, not so much as a blade of grass anywhere--like the overthrow of Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim, which GOD overthrew in fiery rage.
- 23 The whole land will be a burning waste of salt and sulfur--nothing planted, nothing sprouting, no vegetation growing on it. It will be like the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim, which the LORD overthrew in fierce anger.
- 24 All the nations will ask, "Why did GOD do this to this country? What on earth could have made him this angry?"
- 24 All the nations will ask: "Why has the LORD done this to this land? Why this fierce, burning anger?"
- 25 Your children will answer, "Because they abandoned the Covenant of the GOD of their ancestors that he made with them after he got them out of Egypt;
- 25 And the answer will be: "It is because this people abandoned the covenant of the LORD, the God of their fathers, the covenant he made with them when he brought them out of Egypt.
- 26 they went off and worshiped other gods, submitted to gods they'd never heard of before, gods they had no business dealing with.
- 26 They went off and worshiped other gods and bowed down to them, gods they did not know, gods he had not given them.
- 27 So GOD's anger erupted against that land and all the curses written in this book came down on it.
- 27 Therefore the LORD's anger burned against this land, so that he brought on it all the curses written in this book.
- 28 GOD, furiously angry, pulled them, roots and all, out of their land and dumped them in another country, as you can see."
- 28 In furious anger and in great wrath the LORD uprooted them from their land and thrust them into another land, as it is now."
- 29 GOD, our God, will take care of the hidden things but the revealed things are our business. It's up to us and our children to attend to all the terms in this Revelation.
- 29 The secret things belong to the LORD our God, but the things revealed belong to us and to our children forever, that we may follow all the

words of this law.

Deuteronomy 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 Here's what will happen. While you're out among the nations where GOD has dispersed you and the blessings and curses come in just the way I have set them before you, and you and your children take them seriously
- 1 When all these blessings and curses I have set before you come upon you and you take them to heart wherever the LORD your God disperses you among the nations,
- 2 and come back to GOD, your God, and obey him with your whole heart and soul according to everything that I command you today,
- 2 and when you and your children return to the LORD your God and obey him with all your heart and with all your soul according to everything I command you today,
- 3 GOD, your God, will restore everything you lost; he'll have compassion on you; he'll come back and pick up the pieces from all the places where you were scattered.
- 3 then the LORD your God will restore your fortunes and have compassion on you and gather you again from all the nations where he scattered you.
- 4 No matter how far away you end up, GOD, your God, will get you out of there
- 4 Even if you have been banished to the most distant land under the heavens, from there the LORD your God will gather you and bring you back.
- 5 and bring you back to the land your ancestors once possessed. It will be yours again. He will give you a good life and make you more numerous than your ancestors.
- 5 He will bring you to the land that belonged to your fathers, and you will take possession of it. He will make you more prosperous and numerous than your fathers.
- 6 GOD, your God, will cut away the thick calluses on your heart and your children's hearts, freeing you to love GOD, your God, with your whole heart and soul and live, really live.

- 6 The LORD your God will circumcise your hearts and the hearts of your descendants, so that you may love him with all your heart and with all your soul, and live.
- 7 GOD, your God, will put all these curses on your enemies who hated you and were out to get you.
- 7 The LORD your God will put all these curses on your enemies who hate and persecute you.
- 8 And you will make a new start, listening obediently to GOD, keeping all his commandments that I'm commanding you today.
- 8 You will again obey the LORD and follow all his commands I am giving you today.
- 9 GOD, your God, will outdo himself in making things go well for you: you'll have babies, get calves, grow crops, and enjoy an all-around good life. Yes, GOD will start enjoying you again, making things go well for you just as he enjoyed doing it for your ancestors.
- 9 Then the LORD your God will make you most prosperous in all the work of your hands and in the fruit of your womb, the young of your livestock and the crops of your land. The LORD will again delight in you and make you prosperous, just as he delighted in your fathers,
- 10 But only if you listen obediently to GOD, your God, and keep the commandments and regulations written in this Book of Revelation. Nothing halfhearted here; you must return to GOD, your God, totally, heart and soul, holding nothing back.
- 10 if you obey the LORD your God and keep his commands and decrees that are written in this Book of the Law and turn to the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul.
- 11 This commandment that I'm commanding you today isn't too much for you, it's not out of your reach.
- 11 Now what I am commanding you today is not too difficult for you or beyond your reach.
- 12 It's not on a high mountain--you don't have to get mountaineers to climb the peak and bring it down to your level and explain it before you can live it.
- 12 It is not up in heaven, so that you have to ask, "Who will ascend into heaven to get it and proclaim it to us so we may obey it?"

- 13 And it's not across the ocean--you don't have to send sailors out to get it, bring it back, and then explain it before you can live it.
- 13 Nor is it beyond the sea, so that you have to ask, "Who will cross the sea to get it and proclaim it to us so we may obey it?"
- 14 No. The word is right here and now--as near as the tongue in your mouth, as near as the heart in your chest. Just do it!
- 14 No, the word is very near you; it is in your mouth and in your heart so you may obey it.
- 15 Look at what I've done for you today: I've placed in front of you Life and Good, Death and Evil.
- 15 See, I set before you today life and prosperity, death and destruction.
- 16 And I command you today: Love GOD, your God. Walk in his ways. Keep his commandments, regulations, and rules so that you will live, really live, live exuberantly, blessed by GOD, your God, in the land you are about to enter and possess.
- 16 For I command you today to love the LORD your God, to walk in his ways, and to keep his commands, decrees and laws; then you will live and increase, and the LORD your God will bless you in the land you are entering to possess.
- 17 But I warn you: If you have a change of heart, refuse to listen obediently, and willfully go off to serve and worship other gods,
- 17 But if your heart turns away and you are not obedient, and if you are drawn away to bow down to other gods and worship them,
- 18 you will most certainly die. You won't last long in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to enter and possess.
- 18 I declare to you this day that you will certainly be destroyed. You will not live long in the land you are crossing the Jordan to enter and possess.
- 19 I call Heaven and Earth to witness against you today: I place before you Life and Death, Blessing and Curse. Choose life so that you and your children will live.
- 19 This day I call heaven and earth as witnesses against you that I have set before you life and death, blessings and curses. Now choose life, so that you and your children may live
- 20 And love GOD, your God, listening obediently to him, firmly embracing him. Oh yes, he is life itself, a long life settled on the soil that

GOD, your God, promised to give your ancestors, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.

- 20 and that you may love the LORD your God, listen to his voice, and hold fast to him. For the LORD is your life, and he will give you many years in the land he swore to give to your fathers, Abraham, Isaac and Jacob.

Deuteronomy 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses went on and addressed these words to all Israel.
- 1 Then Moses went out and spoke these words to all Israel:
- 2 He said, "I'm 120 years old today. I can't get about as I used to. And GOD told me, 'You're not going to cross this Jordan River.'
- 2 I am now a hundred and twenty years old and I am no longer able to lead you. The LORD has said to me, 'You shall not cross the Jordan.'
- 3 "GOD, your God, will cross the river ahead of you and destroy the nations in your path so that you may dispossess them. (And Joshua will cross the river before you, as GOD said he would.)
- 3 The LORD your God himself will cross over ahead of you. He will destroy these nations before you, and you will take possession of their land. Joshua also will cross over ahead of you, as the LORD said.
- 4 GOD will give the nations the same treatment he gave the kings of the Amorites, Sihon and Og, and their land; he'll destroy them.
- 4 And the LORD will do to them what he did to Sihon and Og, the kings of the Amorites, whom he destroyed along with their land.
- 5 GOD will hand the nations over to you, and you'll treat them exactly as I have commanded you.
- 5 The LORD will deliver them to you, and you must do to them all that I have commanded you.
- 6 "Be strong. Take courage. Don't be intimidated. Don't give them a second thought because GOD, your God, is striding ahead of you. He's right there with you. He won't let you down; he won't leave you."
- 6 Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid or terrified because of them, for the LORD your God goes with you; he will never leave you nor forsake you."

- 7 Then Moses summoned Joshua. He said to him with all Israel watching, "Be strong. Take courage. You will enter the land with this people, this land that GOD promised their ancestors that he'd give them. You will make them the proud possessors of it.
- 7 Then Moses summoned Joshua and said to him in the presence of all Israel, "Be strong and courageous, for you must go with this people into the land that the LORD swore to their forefathers to give them, and you must divide it among them as their inheritance.
- 8 GOD is striding ahead of you. He's right there with you. He won't let you down; he won't leave you. Don't be intimidated. Don't worry."
- 8 The LORD himself goes before you and will be with you; he will never leave you nor forsake you. Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged."
- 9 Moses wrote out this Revelation and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi, who carried the Chest of the Covenant of GOD, and to all the leaders of Israel.
- 9 So Moses wrote down this law and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi, who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and to all the elders of Israel.
- 10 And he gave these orders: "At the end of every seven years, the Year-All-Debts-Are-Canceled, during the pilgrim Festival of Booths
- 10 Then Moses commanded them: "At the end of every seven years, in the year for canceling debts, during the Feast of Tabernacles,
- 11 when everyone in Israel comes to appear in the Presence of GOD, your God, at the place he designates, read out this Revelation to all Israel, with everyone listening.
- 11 when all Israel comes to appear before the LORD your God at the place he will choose, you shall read this law before them in their hearing.
- 12 Gather the people together--men, women, children, and the foreigners living among you--so they can listen well, so they may learn to live in holy awe before GOD, your God, and diligently keep everything in this Revelation.
- 12 Assemble the people--men, women and children, and the aliens living in your towns--so they can listen and learn to fear the LORD your God and follow carefully all the words of this law.
- 13 And do this so that their children, who don't yet know all this, will also listen and learn to live in holy awe before GOD, your God, for as long as

- you live on the land that you are crossing over the Jordan to possess."
- 13 Their children, who do not know this law, must hear it and learn to fear the LORD your God as long as you live in the land you are crossing the Jordan to possess."
- 14 GOD spoke to Moses: "You are about to die. So call Joshua. Meet me in the Tent of Meeting so that I can commission him." So Moses and Joshua went and stationed themselves in the Tent of Meeting.
- 14 The LORD said to Moses, "Now the day of your death is near. Call Joshua and present yourselves at the Tent of Meeting, where I will commission him." So Moses and Joshua came and presented themselves at the Tent of Meeting.
- 15 GOD appeared in the Tent in a Pillar of Cloud. The Cloud was near the entrance of the Tent of Meeting.
- 15 Then the LORD appeared at the Tent in a pillar of cloud, and the cloud stood over the entrance to the Tent.
- 16 GOD spoke to Moses: "You're about to die and be buried with your ancestors. You'll no sooner be in the grave than this people will be up and whoring after the foreign gods of this country that they are entering. They will abandon me and violate my Covenant that I've made with them.
- 16 And the LORD said to Moses: "You are going to rest with your fathers, and these people will soon prostitute themselves to the foreign gods of the land they are entering. They will forsake me and break the covenant I made with them.
- 17 I'll get angry, oh so angry! I'll walk off and leave them on their own, won't so much as look back at them. Then many calamities and disasters will devastate them because they are defenseless. They'll say, 'Isn't it because our God wasn't here that all this evil has come upon us?'
- 17 On that day I will become angry with them and forsake them; I will hide my face from them, and they will be destroyed. Many disasters and difficulties will come upon them, and on that day they will ask, 'Have not these disasters come upon us because our God is not with us?'
- 18 But I'll stay out of their lives, keep looking the other way because of all their evil: they took up with other gods!
- 18 And I will certainly hide my face on that day because of all their wickedness in turning to other gods.

- 19 "But for right now, copy down this song and teach the People of Israel to sing it by heart. They'll have it then as my witness against them.
- 19 Now write down for yourselves this song and teach it to the Israelites and have them sing it, so that it may be a witness for me against them.
- 20 When I bring them into the land that I promised to their ancestors, a land flowing with milk and honey, and they eat and become full and get fat and then begin fooling around with other gods and worshiping them,
- 20 When I have brought them into the land flowing with milk and honey, the land I promised on oath to their forefathers, and when they eat their fill and thrive, they will turn to other gods and worship them, rejecting me and breaking my covenant.
- 21 and then things start falling apart, many terrible things happening, this song will be there with them as a witness to who they are and what went wrong. Their children won't forget this song; they'll be singing it. Don't think I don't know what they are already scheming to do, and they're not even in the land yet, this land I promised them."
- 21 And when many disasters and difficulties come upon them, this song will testify against them, because it will not be forgotten by their descendants. I know what they are disposed to do, even before I bring them into the land I promised them on oath."
- 22 So Moses wrote down this song that very day and taught it to the People of Israel.
- 22 So Moses wrote down this song that day and taught it to the Israelites.
- 23 Then GOD commanded Joshua son of Nun saying, "Be strong. Take courage. You will lead the People of Israel into the land I promised to give them. And I'll be right there with you."
- 23 The LORD gave this command to Joshua son of Nun: "Be strong and courageous, for you will bring the Israelites into the land I promised them on oath, and I myself will be with you."
- 24 After Moses had finished writing down the words of this Revelation in a book, right down to the last word,
- 24 After Moses finished writing in a book the words of this law from beginning to end,
- 25 he ordered the Levites who were responsible for carrying the Chest of the Covenant of GOD, saying,

- 25 he gave this command to the Levites who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD:
- 26 "Take this Book of Revelation and place it alongside the Chest of the Covenant of GOD, your God. Keep it there as a witness.
- 26 Take this Book of the Law and place it beside the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God. There it will remain as a witness against you.
- 27 "I know what rebels you are, how stubborn and willful you can be. Even today, while I'm still alive and present with you, you're rebellious against GOD. How much worse when I've died!
- 27 For I know how rebellious and stiff-necked you are. If you have been rebellious against the LORD while I am still alive and with you, how much more will you rebel after I die!
- 28 So gather the leaders of the tribes and the officials here. I have something I need to say directly to them with Heaven and Earth as witnesses.
- 28 Assemble before me all the elders of your tribes and all your officials, so that I can speak these words in their hearing and call heaven and earth to testify against them.
- 29 I know that after I die you're going to make a mess of things, abandoning the way I commanded, inviting all kinds of evil consequences in the days ahead. You're determined to do evil in defiance of GOD--I know you are--deliberately provoking his anger by what you do."
- 29 For I know that after my death you are sure to become utterly corrupt and to turn from the way I have commanded you. In days to come, disaster will fall upon you because you will do evil in the sight of the LORD and provoke him to anger by what your hands have made."
- 30 So with everyone in Israel gathered and listening, Moses taught them the words of this song, from start to finish.
- 30 And Moses recited the words of this song from beginning to end in the hearing of the whole assembly of Israel:

Deuteronomy 32

MSG

NIV

- 1 Listen, Heavens, I have something to tell you. Attention, Earth, I've got a mouth full of words.
- 1 Listen, O heavens, and I will speak; hear, O earth, the words of my mouth.
- 2 My teaching, let it fall like a gentle rain, my words arrive like morning dew, Like a sprinkling rain on new grass, like spring showers on the garden.
- 2 Let my teaching fall like rain and my words descend like dew, like showers on new grass, like abundant rain on tender plants.
- 3 For it's GOD's Name I'm preaching-- respond to the greatness of our God!
- 3 I will proclaim the name of the LORD. Oh, praise the greatness of our God!
- 4 The Rock: His works are perfect, and the way he works is fair and just; A God you can depend upon, no exceptions, a straight-arrow God.
- 4 He is the Rock, his works are perfect, and all his ways are just. A faithful God who does no wrong, upright and just is he.
- 5 His messed-up, mixed-up children, his non-children, throw mud at him but none of it sticks.
- 5 They have acted corruptly toward him; to their shame they are no longer his children, but a warped and crooked generation.
- 6 Don't you realize it is GOD you are treating like this? This is crazy; don't you have any sense of reverence? Isn't this your father who created you, who made you and gave you a place on Earth?
- 6 Is this the way you repay the LORD, O foolish and unwise people? Is he not your Father, your Creator, who made you and formed you?
- 7 Read up on what happened before you were born; dig into the past, understand your roots. Ask your parents what it was like before you were born; ask the old-ones, they'll tell you a thing or two.
- 7 Remember the days of old; consider the generations long past. Ask your father and he will tell you, your elders, and they will explain to you.
- 8 When the High God gave the nations their stake, gave them their place on Earth, He put each of the peoples within boundaries under the care of divine guardians.
- 8 When the Most High gave the nations their inheritance, when he divided all mankind, he set up boundaries for the peoples according to the

number of the sons of Israel.

- 9 But GOD himself took charge of his people, took Jacob on as his personal concern.
- 9 For the LORD's portion is his people, Jacob his allotted inheritance.
- 10 He found him out in the wilderness, in an empty, windswept wasteland. He threw his arms around him, lavished attention on him, guarding him as the apple of his eye.
- 10 In a desert land he found him, in a barren and howling waste. He shielded him and cared for him; he guarded him as the apple of his eye,
- 11 He was like an eagle hovering over its nest, overshadowing its young, Then spreading its wings, lifting them into the air, teaching them to fly.
- 11 like an eagle that stirs up its nest and hovers over its young, that spreads its wings to catch them and carries them on its pinions.
- 12 GOD alone led him; there was not a foreign god in sight.
- 12 The LORD alone led him; no foreign god was with him.
- 13 GOD lifted him on to the hilltops, so he could feast on the crops in the fields. He fed him honey from the rock, oil from granite crags,
- 13 He made him ride on the heights of the land and fed him with the fruit of the fields. He nourished him with honey from the rock, and with oil from the flinty crag,
- 14 Curds of cattle and the milk of sheep, the choice cuts of lambs and goats, Fine Bashan rams, high-quality wheat, and the blood of grapes: you drank good wine!
- 14 with curds and milk from herd and flock and with fattened lambs and goats, with choice rams of Bashan and the finest kernels of wheat. You drank the foaming blood of the grape.
- 15 Jeshurun put on weight and bucked; you got fat, became obese, a tub of lard. He abandoned the God who made him, he mocked the Rock of his salvation.
- 15 Jeshurun grew fat and kicked; filled with food, he became heavy and sleek. He abandoned the God who made him and rejected the Rock his Savior.
- 16 They made him jealous with their foreign newfangled gods, and with obscenities they vexed him no end.
- 16 They made him jealous with their foreign gods and angered him with their detestable idols.

- 17 They sacrificed to no-god demons, gods they knew nothing about, The latest in gods, fresh from the market, gods your ancestors would never call "gods."
- 17 They sacrificed to demons, which are not God-- gods they had not known, gods that recently appeared, gods your fathers did not fear.
- 18 You walked out on the Rock who gave you your life, forgot the birth-God who brought you into the world.
- 18 You deserted the Rock, who fathered you; you forgot the God who gave you birth.
- 19 GOD saw it and turned on his heel, angered and hurt by his sons and daughters.
- 19 The LORD saw this and rejected them because he was angered by his sons and daughters.
- 20 He said, "From now on I'm looking the other way. Wait and see what happens to them. Oh, they're a turned-around, upside-down generation! Who knows what they'll do from one moment to the next?"
- 20 I will hide my face from them, he said, "and see what their end will be; for they are a perverse generation, children who are unfaithful.
- 21 They've goaded me with their no-gods, infuriated me with their hot-air gods; I'm going to goad them with a no-people, with a hollow nation incense them.
- 21 They made me jealous by what is no god and angered me with their worthless idols. I will make them envious by those who are not a people; I will make them angry by a nation that has no understanding.
- 22 My anger started a fire, a wildfire burning deep down in Sheol, Then shooting up and devouring the Earth and its crops, setting all the mountains, from bottom to top, on fire.
- 22 For a fire has been kindled by my wrath, one that burns to the realm of death below. It will devour the earth and its harvests and set afire the foundations of the mountains.
- 23 I'll pile catastrophes on them, I'll shoot my arrows at them:
- 23 I will heap calamities upon them and spend my arrows against them.
- 24 Starvation, blistering heat, killing disease; I'll send snarling wild animals to attack from the forest and venomous creatures to strike from the dust.

24 I will send wasting famine against them, consuming pestilence and deadly plague; I will send against them the fangs of wild beasts, the venom of vipers that glide in the dust.

25 Killing in the streets, terror in the houses, Young men and virgins alike struck down, and yes, breast-feeding babies and gray-haired old men."

25 In the street the sword will make them childless; in their homes terror will reign. Young men and young women will perish, infants and gray-haired men.

26 I could have said, "I'll hack them to pieces, wipe out all trace of them from the Earth,"

26 I said I would scatter them and blot out their memory from mankind,

27 Except that I feared the enemy would grab the chance to take credit for all of it, Crowing, "Look what we did! GOD had nothing to do with this."

27 but I dreaded the taunt of the enemy, lest the adversary misunderstand and say, 'Our hand has triumphed; the LORD has not done all this.' "

28 They are a nation of ninnies, they don't know enough to come in out of the rain.

28 They are a nation without sense, there is no discernment in them.

29 If they had any sense at all, they'd know this; they would see what's coming down the road.

29 If only they were wise and would understand this and discern what their end will be!

30 How could one soldier chase a thousand enemies off, or two men run off two thousand, Unless their Rock had sold them, unless GOD had given them away?

30 How could one man chase a thousand, or two put ten thousand to flight, unless their Rock had sold them, unless the LORD had given them up?

31 For their rock is nothing compared to our Rock; even our enemies say that.

31 For their rock is not like our Rock, as even our enemies concede.

32 They're a vine that comes right out of Sodom, who they are is rooted in Gomorrah; Their grapes are poison grapes, their grape-clusters bitter.

32 Their vine comes from the vine of Sodom and from the fields of Gomorrah. Their grapes are filled with poison, and their clusters with bitterness.

33 Their wine is rattlesnake venom, mixed with lethal cobra poison.
33 Their wine is the venom of serpents, the deadly poison of cobras.
34 Don't you realize that I have my shelves well stocked, locked behind iron doors?
34 Have I not kept this in reserve and sealed it in my vaults?
35 I'm in charge of vengeance and payback, just waiting for them to slip up; And the day of their doom is just around the corner, sudden and swift and sure.
35 It is mine to avenge; I will repay. In due time their foot will slip; their day of disaster is near and their doom rushes upon them."
36 Yes, GOD will judge his people, but oh how compassionately he'll do it. When he sees their weakened plight and there is no one left, slave or free,
36 The LORD will judge his people and have compassion on his servants when he sees their strength is gone and no one is left, slave or free.
37 He'll say, "So where are their gods, the rock in which they sought refuge,
37 He will say: "Now where are their gods, the rock they took refuge in,
38 The gods who feasted on the fat of their sacrifices and drank the wine of their drink-offerings? Let them show their stuff and help you, let them give you a hand!
38 the gods who ate the fat of their sacrifices and drank the wine of their drink offerings? Let them rise up to help you! Let them give you shelter!
39 "Do you see it now? Do you see that I'm the one? Do you see that there's no other god beside me? I bring death and I give life, I wound and I heal-- there is no getting away from or around me!
39 See now that I myself am He! There is no god besides me. I put to death and I bring to life, I have wounded and I will heal, and no one can deliver out of my hand.
40 I raise my hand in solemn oath; I say, 'I'm always around. By that very life I promise:
40 I lift my hand to heaven and declare: As surely as I live forever,
41 When I sharpen my lightning sword and execute judgment, I take vengeance on my enemies and pay back those who hate me.
41 when I sharpen my flashing sword and my hand grasps it in judgment, I will take vengeance on my adversaries and repay those who hate me.

- 42 I'll make my arrows drunk with blood, my sword will gorge itself on flesh, Feasting on slain and captive alike, the proud and vain enemy corpses."
- 42 I will make my arrows drunk with blood, while my sword devours flesh: the blood of the slain and the captives, the heads of the enemy leaders."
- 43 Celebrate, nations, join the praise of his people. He avenges the deaths of his servants, Pays back his enemies with vengeance, and cleanses his land for his people.
- 43 Rejoice, O nations, with his people, for he will avenge the blood of his servants; he will take vengeance on his enemies and make atonement for his land and people.
- 44 Moses came and recited all the words of this song in the hearing of the people, he and Joshua son of Nun.
- 44 Moses came with Joshua son of Nun and spoke all the words of this song in the hearing of the people.
- 45 When Moses had finished saying all these words to all Israel,
- 45 When Moses finished reciting all these words to all Israel,
- 46 he said, "Take to heart all these words to which I give witness today and urgently command your children to put them into practice, every single word of this Revelation.
- 46 he said to them, "Take to heart all the words I have solemnly declared to you this day, so that you may command your children to obey carefully all the words of this law.
- 47 Yes. This is no small matter for you; it's your life. In keeping this word you'll have a good and long life in this land that you're crossing the Jordan to possess."
- 47 They are not just idle words for you--they are your life. By them you will live long in the land you are crossing the Jordan to possess."
- 48 That same day GOD spoke to Moses:
- 48 On that same day the LORD told Moses,
- 49 "Climb the Abarim Mountains to Mount Nebo in the land of Moab, overlooking Jericho, and view the land of Canaan that I'm giving the People of Israel to have and hold.
- 49 Go up into the Abarim Range to Mount Nebo in Moab, across from Jericho, and view Canaan, the land I am giving the Israelites as their own possession.

- 50 Die on the mountain that you climb and join your people in the ground, just as your brother Aaron died on Mount Hor and joined his people.
- 50 There on the mountain that you have climbed you will die and be gathered to your people, just as your brother Aaron died on Mount Hor and was gathered to his people.
- 51 "This is because you broke faith with me in the company of the People of Israel at the Waters of Meribah Kadesh in the Wilderness of Zin--you didn't honor my Holy Presence in the company of the People of Israel.
- 51 This is because both of you broke faith with me in the presence of the Israelites at the waters of Meribah Kadesh in the Desert of Zin and because you did not uphold my holiness among the Israelites.
- 52 You'll look at the land spread out before you but you won't enter it, this land that I am giving to the People of Israel."
- 52 Therefore, you will see the land only from a distance; you will not enter the land I am giving to the people of Israel."

Deuteronomy 33

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses, man of God, blessed the People of Israel with this blessing before his death.
- 1 This is the blessing that Moses the man of God pronounced on the Israelites before his death.
- 2 He said, GOD came down from Sinai, he dawned from Seir upon them; He radiated light from Mount Paran, coming with ten thousand holy angels And tongues of fire streaming from his right hand.
- 2 He said: "The LORD came from Sinai and dawned over them from Seir; he shone forth from Mount Paran. He came with myriads of holy ones from the south, from his mountain slopes.
- 3 Oh, how you love the people, all his holy ones are palmed in your left hand. They sit at your feet, honoring your teaching,
- 3 Surely it is you who love the people; all the holy ones are in your hand. At your feet they all bow down, and from you receive instruction,
- 4 The Revelation commanded by Moses, as the assembly of Jacob's inheritance.

- 4 the law that Moses gave us, the possession of the assembly of Jacob.
- 5 Thus GOD became king in Jeshurun as the leaders and tribes of Israel gathered.
- 5 He was king over Jeshurun when the leaders of the people assembled, along with the tribes of Israel.
- 6 Reuben: "Let Reuben live and not die, but just barely, in diminishing numbers."
- 6 Let Reuben live and not die, nor his men be few.
- 7 Judah: "Listen, GOD, to the Voice of Judah, bring him to his people; Strengthen his grip, be his helper against his foes."
- 7 And this he said about Judah: "Hear, O LORD, the cry of Judah; bring him to his people. With his own hands he defends his cause. Oh, be his help against his foes!"
- 8 Levi: "Let your Thummim and Urim belong to your loyal saint; The one you tested at Massah, whom you fought with at the Waters of Meribah,
- 8 About Levi he said: "Your Thummim and Urim belong to the man you favored. You tested him at Massah; you contended with him at the waters of Meribah.
- 9 Who said of his father and mother, 'I no longer recognize them.' He turned his back on his brothers and neglected his children, Because he was guarding your sayings and watching over your Covenant.
- 9 He said of his father and mother, 'I have no regard for them.' He did not recognize his brothers or acknowledge his own children, but he watched over your word and guarded your covenant.
- 10 Let him teach your rules to Jacob and your Revelation to Israel, Let him keep the incense rising to your nostrils and the Whole-Burnt-Offerings on your Altar.
- 10 He teaches your precepts to Jacob and your law to Israel. He offers incense before you and whole burnt offerings on your altar.
- 11 GOD bless his commitment, stamp your seal of approval on what he does; Disable the loins of those who defy him, make sure we've heard the last from those who hate him."
- 11 Bless all his skills, O LORD, and be pleased with the work of his hands. Smite the loins of those who rise up against him; strike his foes till they rise no more."

- 12 Benjamin: "GOD's beloved; GOD's permanent residence. Encircled by GOD all day long, within whom GOD is at home."
- 12 About Benjamin he said: "Let the beloved of the LORD rest secure in him, for he shields him all day long, and the one the LORD loves rests between his shoulders."
- 13 Joseph: "Blessed by GOD be his land: The best fresh dew from high heaven, and fountains springing from the depths;
- 13 About Joseph he said: "May the LORD bless his land with the precious dew from heaven above and with the deep waters that lie below;
- 14 The best radiance streaming from the sun and the best the moon has to offer;
- 14 with the best the sun brings forth and the finest the moon can yield;
- 15 Beauty pouring off the tops of the mountains and the best from the everlasting hills;
- 15 with the choicest gifts of the ancient mountains and the fruitfulness of the everlasting hills;
- 16 The best of Earth's exuberant gifts, the smile of the Burning-Bush Dweller. All this on the head of Joseph, on the brow of the consecrated one among his brothers.
- 16 with the best gifts of the earth and its fullness and the favor of him who dwelt in the burning bush. Let all these rest on the head of Joseph, on the brow of the prince among his brothers.
- 17 In splendor he's like a firstborn bull, his horns the horns of a wild ox; He'll gore the nations with those horns, push them all to the ends of the Earth. Ephraim by the ten thousands will do this, Manasseh by the thousands will do this."
- 17 In majesty he is like a firstborn bull; his horns are the horns of a wild ox. With them he will gore the nations, even those at the ends of the earth. Such are the ten thousands of Ephraim; such are the thousands of Manasseh."
- 18 Zebulun and Issachar: "Celebrate, Zebulun, as you go out, and Issachar, as you stay home.
- 18 About Zebulun he said: "Rejoice, Zebulun, in your going out, and you, Issachar, in your tents.
- 19 They'll invite people to the Mountain and offer sacrifices of right worship, For they will have hauled riches in from the sea and gleaned

- treasures from the beaches."
- 19 They will summon peoples to the mountain and there offer sacrifices of righteousness; they will feast on the abundance of the seas, on the treasures hidden in the sand."
- 20 Gad: "Blessed is he who makes Gad large. Gad roams like a lion, tears off an arm, rips open a skull.
- 20 About Gad he said: "Blessed is he who enlarges Gad's domain! Gad lives there like a lion, tearing at arm or head.
- 21 He took one look and grabbed the best place for himself, the portion just made for someone in charge. He took his place at the head, carried out GOD's right ways and his rules for life in Israel."
- 21 He chose the best land for himself; the leader's portion was kept for him. When the heads of the people assembled, he carried out the LORD's righteous will, and his judgments concerning Israel."
- 22 Dan: "Dan is a lion's cub leaping out of Bashan."
- 22 About Dan he said: "Dan is a lion's cub, springing out of Bashan."
- 23 Naphtali: "Naphtali brims with blessings, spills over with GOD's blessings As he takes possession of the sea and southland."
- 23 About Naphtali he said: "Naphtali is abounding with the favor of the LORD and is full of his blessing; he will inherit southward to the lake."
- 24 Asher: "Asher, best blessed of the sons! May he be the favorite of his brothers, his feet massaged in oil.
- 24 About Asher he said: "Most blessed of sons is Asher; let him be favored by his brothers, and let him bathe his feet in oil.
- 25 Safe behind iron-clad doors and gates, your strength like iron as long as you live."
- 25 The bolts of your gates will be iron and bronze, and your strength will equal your days.
- 26 There is none like God, Jeshurun, riding to your rescue through the skies, his dignity haloed by clouds.
- 26 There is no one like the God of Jeshurun, who rides on the heavens to help you and on the clouds in his majesty.
- 27 The ancient God is home on a foundation of everlasting arms. He drove out the enemy before you and commanded, "Destroy!"
- 27 The eternal God is your refuge, and underneath are the everlasting arms. He will drive out your enemy before you, saying, 'Destroy him!'

- 28 Israel lived securely, the fountain of Jacob undisturbed In grain and wine country and, oh yes, his heavens drip dew.
- 28 So Israel will live in safety alone; Jacob's spring is secure in a land of grain and new wine, where the heavens drop dew.
- 29 Lucky Israel! Who has it as good as you? A people saved by GOD! The Shield who defends you, the Sword who brings triumph. Your enemies will come crawling on their bellies and you'll march on their backs.
- 29 Blessed are you, O Israel! Who is like you, a people saved by the LORD? He is your shield and helper and your glorious sword. Your enemies will cower before you, and you will trample down their high places. "

Deuteronomy 34

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses climbed from the Plains of Moab to Mount Nebo, the peak of Pisgah facing Jericho. GOD showed him all the land from Gilead to Dan,
- 1 Then Moses climbed Mount Nebo from the plains of Moab to the top of Pisgah, across from Jericho. There the LORD showed him the whole land--from Gilead to Dan,
- 2 all Naphtali, Ephraim, and Manasseh; all Judah reaching to the Mediterranean Sea;
- 2 all of Naphtali, the territory of Ephraim and Manasseh, all the land of Judah as far as the western sea,
- 3 the Negev and the plains which encircle Jericho, City of Palms, as far south as Zoar.
- 3 the Negev and the whole region from the Valley of Jericho, the City of Palms, as far as Zoar.
- 4 Then and there GOD said to him, "This is the land I promised to your ancestors, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob with the words 'I will give it to your descendants.' I've let you see it with your own eyes. There it is. But you're not going to go in."
- 4 Then the LORD said to him, "This is the land I promised on oath to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob when I said, 'I will give it to your

descendants.' I have let you see it with your eyes, but you will not cross over into it."

5 Moses died there in the land of Moab, Moses the servant of GOD, just as GOD said.

5 And Moses the servant of the LORD died there in Moab, as the LORD had said.

6 God buried him in the valley in the land of Moab opposite Beth Peor. No one knows his burial site to this very day.

6 He buried him in Moab, in the valley opposite Beth Peor, but to this day no one knows where his grave is.

7 Moses was 120 years old when he died. His eyesight was sharp; he still walked with a spring in his step.

7 Moses was a hundred and twenty years old when he died, yet his eyes were not weak nor his strength gone.

8 The People of Israel wept for Moses in the Plains of Moab thirty days. Then the days of weeping and mourning for Moses came to an end.

8 The Israelites grieved for Moses in the plains of Moab thirty days, until the time of weeping and mourning was over.

9 Joshua son of Nun was filled with the spirit of wisdom because Moses had laid his hands on him. The People of Israel listened obediently to him and did the same as when GOD had commanded Moses.

9 Now Joshua son of Nun was filled with the spirit of wisdom because Moses had laid his hands on him. So the Israelites listened to him and did what the LORD had commanded Moses.

10 No prophet has risen since in Israel like Moses, whom GOD knew face-to-face.

10 Since then, no prophet has risen in Israel like Moses, whom the LORD knew face to face,

11 Never since has there been anything like the signs and miracle-wonders that GOD sent him to do in Egypt, to Pharaoh, to all his servants, and to all his land--

11 who did all those miraculous signs and wonders the LORD sent him to do in Egypt--to Pharaoh and to all his officials and to his whole land.

12 nothing to compare with that all-powerful hand of his and all the great and terrible things Moses did as every eye in Israel watched.

12 For no one has ever shown the mighty power or performed the awesome deeds that Moses did in the sight of all Israel.